

Hummus

INGREDIENTS Serves 4

1 ¼ cups/225g/8oz dried chick peas, soaked overnight

1 bouquet garni

1 small onion, sliced

2 cloves garlic, crushed juice of 2 lemons

4 tbsp/60ml/2oz tahini paste

3 tbsp/45ml olive oil

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 tomato, sliced

sprig of parsley

METHOD

1-Drain the chick peas and place in a large saucepan with plenty of water, the bouquet garni and onion. Bring to the boil then simmer gently for 1 ¾ -2 hours, or until tender.

2-Drain, reserving a little of the cooking liquid. Discard the onion and bouquet garni.

3-Place the garlic, lemon juice, tahini, olive oil and seasoning in a food processor or blender. Add the cooked chick peas and process to a smooth paste.

4-Add a little of the reserved cooking liquid if the paste is too thick, and stir rapidly. Arrange the hummus in a dish, edge with halved tomato slices and garnish with parsley. Serve with warmed pitta bread.

Guacamole

INGREDIENTS

Serves 2-4

2 large ripe avocados

2 large ripe tomatoes

1 bunch spring onions

1-2 tbsp/15-30ml olive oil

1-2 tbsp/15-30ml lemon juice

salt and freshly ground black pepper

2 green chillies

METHOD

1-Remove the flesh from the avocados and mash. Skin the tomatoes, remove the seeds and chop finely. Chop the spring onions.

2-Mix vegetables together with olive oil and lemon juice and season to taste. Garnish with chopped green chillies and serve, chilled, as a dip or with hot pitta bread

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the lids at a jaunty angle. If keeping to serve later, brush them with olive oil and black

INGREDIENTS

Serves 6 - 8

3 aubergines

4 cloves garlic

2 tbsp/30ml tahini

1/2 tsp/2 1/2g cumin seeds

1/2 tsp/2 1/2 g chilli powder

juice of 3 lemons salt to taste chopped parsley olives

1-Grill aubergines until the skin blackens.

2-Cool slightly in a paper bag and peel off most of the charred skin.

3-Mash the softened aubergine with the remaining ingredients and blend until fully combined.

Garnish with parsley and olives and serve warm with pitta bread. -

Stuffed Tomatoes INGREDIENTS Serves 4

8 English (small) tomatoes, or 3 beef (large) tomatoes

4 hard-boiled eggs, cooled and peeled

6 tbsp/90ml mayonnaise

1 tsp/5 ml garlic paste

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 tbsp/15ml parsley, chopped

1 tbsp/15ml white breadcrumbs for the beef (large) tomatoes

METHOD

1-Skin the tomatoes, first by cutting out the core with a sharp knife and making a incision on the other end of the tomato. Then place in a pan of boiling water for 10 seconds, remove and plunge into a bowl of iced or very cold water (this latter step is to stop the tomatoes from cooking and going mushy).

2-Slice the tops off the tomatoes, and just enough of their bases to remove the rounded ends so that the tomatoes will sit squarely on the plate. Keep the tops if using small tomatoes, but not for the large tomatoes.

3-Remove the seeds and inside, either with a teaspoon or small, sharp knife. Mash the eggs with the mayonnaise, garlic paste, salt, pepper and parsley.

4-Fill the tomatoes, firmly pressing the filling down. With small tomatoes, replace the lids at a jaunty angle. If keeping to serve later, brush them with olive oil and black pepper to prevent from drying out. Cover with plastic film and keep.

NOTE

For large tomatoes, the filling must be very firm, so it can be sliced. If you make your own mayonnaise, thicken it by using more egg yolks. If you use shop-bought mayonnaise, add enough white breadcrumbs until the mixture is the consistency of mashed potatoes. Season well, to taste. Fill the tomatoes, pressing down firmly until level. Refrigerate for 1 hour, then slice with a sharp carving knife into rings. Sprinkle with chopped parsley.

Courgette Moulds

INGREDIENTS

serves 4

1 lb/450g courgettes, sliced

1 onion, chopped

2 tbsp/30ml lemon juice

2 tsp/10 ml fresh coriander leaves, chopped

4oz/100g fromage blanc

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 sachet agar-agar

2/3 cup/150ml/ ¼ pt natural low fat yoghurt

5 tbsp/75ml/3fl oz skimmed milk

1 egg yolk

1 tsp/5ml curry paste

1-Place the courgettes and onions in a saucepan with 2x15mlsp/2tbsp water and the lemon juice. Cover and cook over a gentle heat for 8-10 minutes, or until softened.

2-Cool slightly and puree in a food processor or blender. Add the coriander leaves, cheese and seasoning and puree until smooth. Leave until lukewarm.

3-Sprinkle the agar-agar over 2 tbsp/30ml water in a cup. Stand in a saucepan of hot water and stir to dissolve. Add to the puree and pour into four 2/3 cup/150ml/ ¼ pt ramekin dishes. Chill for 1-1 1/2 hours until set.

4-Meanwhile mix the yoghurt, milk, egg yolk and curry paste together and heat gently until slightly thickened. Do not boil. Leave to cool.

5-Pour the sauce across the base of a serving dish, loosen the moulds and turn out on to the dish. Garnish the tops of the moulds with chervil and serve.

Mozzarella and Avocado Bees

INGREDIENTS

Serves 2

1 ripe avocado

4oz/100g Mozzarella cheese

1 tbsp/15ml olive oil

1 tbsp/15ml tarragon vinegar

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Cut the avocado in half and remove the stone. With a palette knife carefully remove the skin from each half of the avocado. Lay the avocado halves flat-side downwards and cut horizontally into ¼ in / 1 cm slices.

2-Cut semi-circular slices from the Mozzarella, with 4 extra semi-circles for wings.

3-Arrange the cheese slices between the avocado slices to form the striped body of the bee, and arrange the wings at the sides. Mix the oil and vinegar together and season well. Pour over the bees and serve.

Vegetables in Agar-agar

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

2 ½ cups/600ml/20fl oz dissolved agar- agar or other vegetable gelatine

1 cup/100g/4oz peeled and diced carrot

1 cup/100g/4oz trimmed and sliced green beans

1 tbsp/15ml walnut oil

1 cup/100g/4oz sliced button mushrooms

1 tbsp/15ml stuffed olives, sliced

2/3 cup/150ml/ ¼ pt thick mayonnaise

1-In water dissolve enough agar-agar or equivalent vegetable gelatine, following directions on the packet, to make 2 1/2 cups/ 600ml/20fl oz. Allow it to cool. Chill a mould. Wet the mould and when the aspic is almost set, line the mould with it. Place in the fridge to set.

2-Meanwhile cook the carrot and green beans in salted water until tender. Refresh in cold water. Heat the walnut oil in a pan and gently sauté the mushrooms. Allow to cool.

3-Mix the vegetables together with the olives, mayonnaise and the remaining aspic and fill the mould. Chill until set.

4-Dip the mould into hot water and turn out onto a plate. Cut into wedges and serve each wedge with a crisp lettuce leaf and a triangle of wholemeal toast.

Stuffed aubergines

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-8

4 aubergines olive oil

1 large onion, chopped

2-3 cloves garlic, crushed

4 large tomatoes, skinned and chopped

2 tbsp/10g fresh herbs, chopped

salt and freshly ground black pepper

4oz/100g Mozzarella cheese

4 tbsp/60ml brown breadcrumbs a little butter

1-Preheat the oven to 400oF/200oC/Gas 6. Wash the aubergines. Cut in half lengthwise and score the cut surface deeply with a knife. Sprinkle with salt and leave, cut surface down, for 30 minutes.

2-Meanwhile heat 1-2 tbsp/15-30ml oil in a pan and fry the onion and garlic until translucent. Transfer to a bowl and mix in the tomatoes and chopped herbs.

3-Add more oil to the pan. Rinse the aubergines and pat dry. Place them cut surface down in the pan and cook gently for about 15 minutes. They absorb a lot of oil, so you will need to keep adding a little more.

4-Scoop some of the flesh out of the aubergines, mash and mix it with the rest of the filling. Season well. Pile the filling onto the aubergines and top with thinly sliced Mozzarella.

5-Sprinkle with breadcrunibs and dot with butter. Place aubergines in a greased ovenproof dish and bake for 20 minutes until the cheese has melted and the breadcrumbs are crispy.

GUACAMOLE

This is quite a fiery version, although nowhere near as hot as you would be served in Mexico.

Ingredients:

Serves 4.

2 ripe Avocados, peeled and stoned

2 tomatoes, peeled, seeded and finely chopped.

6 Spring Onion, finely chopped.

1-2 fresh Chilli, seeded and finely chopped.

30 ml/2 tbsp fresh lime or lemon juice

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh Coriander,

Salt and freshly ground Black Pepper

Coriander sprigs, to garnish.

1- Put the Avocado halves into a large bowl and mash them roughly with a large fork.

2- Add the remaining ingredients. Mix well and season with salt and pepper. Serve garnished with fresh Coriander

Butter Bean, Watercress and Herb Dip

This is a refreshing dip that is especially good served with fresh vegetable crudites and breadsticks.

Ingredients.

Serves 4-6

225 g/8 oz/ 1 cup plain cottage cheese.

400 gr/ 14 oz can butter bean, rinsed and drained

1 bunch Spring Onion, chopped

50 gr/ 2 oz watercress, chopped

600 ml/ 4 tbsp Mayonnaise

45 ml/ 3 tbsp chopped fresh Mix Herbs

Salt and ground black pepper

Watercress sprigs, to garnish

Vegetable crudités and breadsticks, to serve

1-Put the cottage cheese, butter beans, spring onions, watercress, mayonnaise and herbs in a blender or food processor and blend until fairly smooth.

2- Season with salt and pepper and spoon the mixture into a dish

3-Cover and chill for several hours before serving.

4-Transfer to a serving dish (or individual dishes) and garnish with watercress sprigs. Serve with vegetable crudites and breadsticks.

COOK'S TIP

Try using other canned beans such as cannellini beans or chickpeas in place of the butter beans.

SAFFRON DIP

Serve this mild dip with fresh vegetable crudites - it is particularly good with florets of cauliflower.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

Small pinch of Saffron strands

200 g/7 oz fromage frais

10 fresh Chives

10 fresh Basil leaves

Salt and freshly ground Black Pepper

Vegetable crudités, to serve

1-Pour 15ml/ 1 tbsp boiling water into a small heatproof bowl and add the saffron strands. Leave to infused saffron for about 3-4 minutes, stirring occasionally.

2-Beat the fromage frais until smooth, then stir in the infused Saffron liquid.

3-Use a pair of scissors to snip the chives into the dip. Tear the basil leaves into small pieces and stir them in.

4-Season with salt and pepper. Serve immediately with vegetable crudites.

VARIATION

Leave out the saffron and add a squeeze of lemon or lime juice instead. Alternatively, substitute the saffron strands with ready-ground saffron powder.

SPICED CARROT DIP

This is a delicious dip with a sweet and spicy flavour. Serve wheat crackers or fiery tortilla chips as accompaniments for dipping.

Ingredients

Serves 4

1 onion

3 carrots, plus extra to garnish

grated rind and juice of 2 oranges

15 ml/ 1 tbsp hot curry paste

150 ml/ 1/4 pint/ 2/3 cup natural yogurt handful of fresh basil leaves

15-30 ml/ 1-2 tbsp fresh lemon juice, to taste red Tabasco sauce, to taste

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Finely chop the onion. Peel and grate the carrots. Place the onion, carrots, orange rind and juice, and curry paste in a small saucepan. Bring to the boil, cover and simmer gently for 10 minutes, until tender.

2-Process the mixture in a 2blender or food processor until smooth. Leave to cool completely.

3-Stir in the yogurt, then tear the basil leaves roughly into small pieces and stir them into the carrot mixture.

4-Add the lemon juice and Tabasco and season with salt and pepper. Serve within a few hours at room temperature. Garnish with grated carrot.

DIP WITH CRISPY BREAD

This delectable Middle Eastern dish is flavoured with tahini (sesame seed paste), which gives it a subtle hint of spice.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

2 small aubergines

1 garlic clove, crushed

60 ml/4 tbsp tahini (sesame seed paste)

25 g/l oz/1/4 cup ground almonds juice of 1/2 lemon

2.5 ml/ 1/2 tsp ground cumin

30 ml/2 tbsp fresh mint leaves

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

salt and freshly ground black pepper

Lebanese,flatbread

4 pitta breads

45 ml/3 tbsp toasted sesame seeds

STARTERS

45 ml/3 tbsp fresh Thyme leaves, chopped

45 ml/3 tbsp poppy seeds

150 ml/ 1/4 pint/ 2/3 cup olive oil

1-Start by making Lebanese flatbread. Split the pitta breads through the middle and carefully open them out. Mix the sesame seeds, chopped thyme and poppy seeds in mortar. Crush them lightly with a pestle to release the flavour.

2-Stir the Olive oil. Spread the mixture lightly over the cut sides of the pitta bread. Grill until golden brown and crisp. When completely cool, break into pieces and set aside.

3-Grill the aubergines, turning them frequently, until the skin is blackened and blistered. Remove the skin, chop the flesh roughly and leave to drain in a colander. Wait for 30 minutes, then squeeze out as much liquid from the aubergines as possible.

4-Place the flesh in a blender or food processor. Add the garlic, tahini, almonds, lemon juice and cumin. Season, and process to a smooth paste. Chop half the mint and stir in.

5-Spoon into a bowl, scatter the remaining mint leaves on top and drizzle with olive oil. Serve with the Lebanese flatbread.

Chick-pea Falafel with Coriander Dip

Little balli of spicy chick-pea puree deep-fried until crisp, are served with a zesty coriander-flavoured mayonnaise.

Ingredients.

Serve 4

400 g/ 14 oz can chick-peas, drained

6 spring Oions, finely chopped

1 egg

2.5 ml/ 1/2 tsp ground turmeric

1 garlic clove, crushed

5 ml/ 1 tsp ground Cumin

60 ml/ 4 tbsp chopped fresh Coriander oil for deep-frying

1 smail fresh red Chilli, seeded and finely chopped

45 ml/3 tbsp Mayonnaise

Salt and freshly ground Black Pepper

Sprig of fresh Coriander, to garnish

1-Put the chick-peas into a food processor or blender. Add the spring onions and process to a smooth puree.

Add the egg, ground turmeric, garlic, cumin and about 15 ml/ 1 tbsp of the chopped coriander.

Process briefly to mix, then season with salt and pepper.

2-Working with clean, wet hands, shape the chick-pea mixture into about 16 small balls.

3-Heat the oil for deep-frying to 180oC/350oF or until a cube of bread, when added to the oil, browns in 30-45 seconds. Deep-fry the falafel in batches for 2-3 minutes or until golden. Drain the falafel on kitchen paper. Place in a serving bowl and keep warm.

4-Stir the remaining chopped coriander and the chilli into the mayonnaise. Garnish with the coriander sprig and serve alongside the falafel.

MARINATED VEGETABLE ANTIPASTO

This colourful selection of fresh vegetables and herbs makes a great starter when served with fresh crusty bread.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

For the peppers

3 red peppers

3 yellow peppers

4 garlic cloves, sliced handful of fresh basil

120 ml/4 fl oz//2 cup olive oil

salt and freshly ground black pepper

For the mushrooms

450 g/1 lb open cap mushrooms, thickly sliced

60 ml/4 tbsp olive oil

1 large garlic clove, crushed

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh rosemary

250 ml/ 8 fl oz/1 cup dry white wine fresh rosemary sprigs, to garnish

For the olive

1 dried red chilli, crushed grated rind of 1 lemon

120 ml/4 fl oz//2 cup olive oil

225 g/8 oz/1 1/3 cups Italian black olives

30 ml/2 tbsp chopped fresh flat leaf parsley basil leaves, to garnish

1 lemon wedge, to serve

1-Place the peppers under a hot grill. Cook until they are black and blistered all over. Remove from the heat and place in a large plastic bag to cool.

2-When the peppers are cool, remove their skins, halve the flesh and remove the seeds. Cut into strips lengthways and place them in a bowl with the sliced garlic and basil leaves. Season and then cover with oil and marinate for 3-4 hours, tossing occasionally Garnish with basil leaves.

3-Place the mushrooms in a large bowl. Heat the oil in a pan and add the garlic, rosemary and wine. Bring to the boil, then simmer for 3 minutes. Season. Pour over the mushrooms.

4-Mix well and leave to cool, stirring occasionally. Cover and marinate overnight. Serve at room temperature, garnished with rosemary sprigs.

5-Place the chilli and lemon rind in a small pan with the oil. Heat gently for about 3 minutes. Add the olives and heat for 1 minute more. Tip the olive mixture into a bowl and leave to cool. Marinate overnight. Before serving, sprinkle with parsley and garnish with basil leaves. Serve with the lemon wedge.

Spicy Potato Wedges with Chilli Dip

The spicy crust on these potato wedges makes them irresistible, especially when served with a zesty chilli dip.

Ingredients:

Serves 2

2 baking potatoes, about 225 g/8 oz each

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

2 garlic cloves, crushed

5 ml/ 1 tsp ground allspice

5 ml/1 tsp ground coriander

15 ml/1 tbsp paprika

salt and freshly ground black pepper

For the dip

15 ml/1 tbsp olive oil

1 small onion, finely chopped

1 garlic clove, crushed

200 g/7 oz can chopped tomatoes

1 fresh red chilli, seeded and finely chopped

15 ml/1 tbsp balsamic vinegar

15 ml/1 tbsp chopped fresh coriander, plus extra to garnish

1-Preheat the oven to 200oC/400oF/Gas 6. Wash the potatoes, cut in half, then into 8 wedges.

2-Place the potato wedges in a saucepan of cold water. Bring to the boil, then lower the heat and simmer gently for 10 minutes, or until the potatoes have softened slightly. Drain well and pat dry on kitchen paper.

3-Mix the oil, garlic, allspice, coriander and paprika in a roasting tin. Season with salt and pepper. Add the potatoes and shake to coat thoroughly. Roast for 20 minutes, turning occasionally.

4-Meanwhile, make the chilli dip. Heat the oil in a saucepan, add the onion and garlic and cook for 5-10 minutes until soft and golden. Add the tomatoes with their juice and stir in the chilli and vinegar.

5-Cook gently for 10 minutes, until the mixture has reduced and thickened. Season with salt and pepper. Stir in the fresh coriander and serve hot, with the potato wedges. Garnish with salt freshly ground black pepper and fresh coriander

Potted Stilton with Herbs and Melba Toast

This starter is a great time saver, as the Potted Stilton can be made the day before, and the Melba toast will in an airtight container for up to two day.

Ingredients:

Serves 8

225 g/8 oz/ 1 cup blue Stilton or other blue cheese

115 g/4 oz//2 cup cream cheese

15 ml/ 1 tbsp port

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh parsley

15 ml/1 tbsp snipped fresh chives, plus extra to garnish

50 g/2 oz/ 1/2 cup finely chopped walnuts salt and freshly ground black pepper

for the Melba toast

12 thin slice of white bread

1-Put the Stilton or blue cheese cream cheese and port into a blender or food processor and process until smooth.

2-Stir in the remaining ingredients and then season with salt and pepper.

3-Spoon into individual ramekin dishes and level the tops. Cover with clear film and chill until firm. Sprinkle with snipped chives just before serving.

4-To make the Melba toast preheat the oven to 180oC/350oF/Gas 4. Toast the d on both sides.

5-While the toast is still hot, cut 5off the crusts and cut each slice horizontally in two. While the bread is still warm, place it in a single layer on baking trays and bake for 10- 1 5 minutes, until golden brown and crisp. Continue with the remaining slices in the same way. Serve warm with the potted Stilton.

Mushroom and Bean Pate

A light and tasty pate, delicious served on wholemeal bread or toast

Ingredients:

Serves 12

450 g/lb mushrooms, sliced

1 onion, chopped

2 garlic cloves, crushed

1 red pepper, seeded and diced

30 ml/2 tbsp vegetable stock

30 ml/2 tbsp dry white wine

400 g/14 oz can red kidney beans, rinsed and drained

1 egg, beaten

50 g/2 oz/1 cup fresh wholemeal breadcrumbs

15 ml/1 tbsp chopped fresh thyme

15 ml/1 tbsp chopped fresh rosemary

salt and freshly ground black pepper lettuce and tomatoes, to garnish

1-Preheat the oven to 180°C/350°F/Gas 4. Lightly grease and line a non-stick 900 g/ 2 lb loaf tin. Put the mushrooms, onion, garlic, red pepper, stock and wine in a saucepan. Cover and cook for about 10 minutes, stirring occasionally.

2-Set aside to cool slightly, then puree the mixture with the kidney beans in a blender or food processor until smooth.

3-Transfer the mixture to a bowl, add the egg, breadcrumbs and herbs and mix thoroughly. Season with salt and pepper.

4-Spoon the mixture into the prepared tin and level the surface. Bake for 45-60 minutes, until lightly set and browned on top. Place on a wire rack and allow the pate to cool completely in the tin. Once cool, cover and refrigerate for several hours. Turn out of the tin and serve in slices, garnished with lettuce and tomato.

Garlic Mushrooms with a Parsley Crust

These garlic mushrooms are perfect for dinner parties, or you could serve them in larger portions as a light supper dish with a green salad.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

350 g/ 12 oz large mushrooms, stems removed

3 garlic cloves, crushed

175 g/ 6 oz/ $\frac{3}{4}$ cup butter, softened

50 g/2 oz / 1 cup fresh white breadcrumbs

50 g /2 oz/ 1 cup fresh parsley, chopped

1 egg, beaten

salt and cayenne pepper

8 cherry tomatoes, to garnish

1-Preheat the oven to 190°C/375°F/ Gas 5. Arrange the mushrooms cup side uppermost on a baking tray. Mix together the garlic and butter in a small bowl and divide 115 g/4 oz/ 1/2 cup of the butter between all the mushrooms.

2-Heat the remaining butter in a frying pan and lightly fry the breadcrumbs until golden brown. Place the chopped parsley in a bowl, add the breadcrumbs, season with salt and cayenne pepper and mix well.

3-Stir in the egg and use the mixture to fill the mushroom caps. Bake for 10- 15 minutes until the topping has browned and the mushrooms have softened. Garnish with quartered tomatoes.

COOK'S TIP

If you are planning ahead, stuffed mushrooms can be prepared up to 12 hours in advance and kept in the fridge before baking.

Asparagus Rolls with Herb Butter Sauce

For a taste sensation, try tender asparagus spears wrapped in cri SP filo pastry. The buttery herb sauce makes the perfect accompaniment.

Ingredients:

Serves 2

4 sheets of filo pastry

50 g/2 oz/1/4 cup butter, melted

16 young asparagus spears, trimmed

For the sauce

2 shallots, finely chopped

1 bay leaf

150 ml/1/4 pint/1/3 cup dry white wine

175 g/6 oz butter, softened

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh herbs Salt and freshly ground black pepper chopped chives, to garnish

1-Preheat the oven to 200oC/400oF/Gas 6. Cut the filo sheets in half. Brush a half sheet with melted butter. Fold one corner of the sheet down to the bottom edge to give a wedge shape.

2-Lay 4 asparagus spears on top at the longest edge, and roll up toward the shortest edge. Using the remaining filo and asparagus spears, make three more rolls in the same way.

3-Lay the rolls on a greased baking sheet. Brush with the remaining melted butter. Bake in the oven for 8 minutes until golden brown.

4-Meanwhile, put the shallots, bay leaf and wine into a pan. Cover, and cook over a high heat until the wine is reduced to 45-60 ml/3-4 tbsp.

5-Strain the wine mixture into a bowl. Whisk in the butter, a bowl. Whisk in the butter, a little at a time until the sauce is smooth and glossy.

6-Stir in the herbs and add salt and pepper to taste. Return to the pan and keep the sauce warm. Serve the rolls on individual plates with a salad garnish, if desired. Serve the sauce separately, sprinkled with a scattering of chopped chives

Fried Mozzarella

These crispy cheese slices make an unusual and tasty starter. They must be cooked just before serving.

Ingredients

Serves 2-3

300 g/ 11 oz/1 3/4 cups mozzarella cheese

oil for deep frying

2 eggs flour seasoned with salt and freshly ground black pepper

plain dry breadcrumbs

flat leaf parsley, to garnish

1-Cut the mozzarella into slices about 1 cm/1/2 in thick. Gently pat off any excess moisture with kitchen paper.

2-Heat the oil to 185oC/360oF or until a small piece of bread sizzles as soon as it is dropped in. While the oil is heating, beat the eggs in a shallow bowl. Spread some seasoned flour on one plate and some breadcrumbs on another.

3-Press the cheese slices into the flour, coating them evenly with a thin layer of flour. Shake off any excess. Dip them into the egg, then once into the breadcrumbs. Dip them once more into the egg, then again into the breadcrumbs.

4-Fry immediately in the hot oil until golden brown. (You may have to do this in two batches but do not let the breaded cheese wait for too long or the breadcrumb coating will separate from the cheese while it is being fried.) Drain on kitchen paper and serve hot, garnished with parsley.

STARTERS

Greek Cheese and Potato Patties

Delicious little fried morsels of potato and feta cheese, flavoured with dill and lemon juice.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

500 g/ 1 1/4 lb potatoes

115 g/4 oz feta cheese

4 spring onions, chopped

45 ml/3 tbsp chopped fresh dill

15 ml/ 1 tbsp lemon juice

1 egg, beaten

flour for dredging

45 ml/3 tbsp olive oil

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Boil the potatoes in their skins in lightly salted water until soft. Drain, then peel while still warm. Place in a bowl and mash. Crumble the feta cheese into the potatoes and add the spring onions, dill, lemon juice and egg. Season with salt and pepper (the cheese is salty, so taste before you add salt). Stir well.

2-Cover the mixture and chill until firm. Divide the mixture into walnut-size balls, then flatten them slightly. Dredge with the flour. Heat the oil in a frying pan and fry the patties until golden brown on each side. Drain on kitchen paper and serve at once.

Cheese-stuffed Pears

These pears, with their scrumptious creamy topping, make a sublime dish when served with a simple salad.

Ingredients: Serves 4

50 g/2 oz//4cup ricotta cheese

50 g/2 oz/ ¼ cup doicelatte cheese

15 m/ 1 tbsp honey

½ celery stick, finely sliced

8 green olives, pitted and roughly chopped

4 dates, stoned and cut into thin strips pinch of paprika

4 ripe pears

150 ml@/4pint//3cup apple juice

1-Preheat the oven to 200oC/400oF/Gas 6. Place the ricotta in a bowl and crumble in the dolcelatte. Add the rest of the ingredients except for the pears and apple juice and mix well.

2-Halve the pears lengthways and use a melon baller to remove the cores. Place in an ovenproof dish and divide the filling equally between them.

3-Pour in the apple juice and cover the dish with foil. Bake for 20 minutes or until the pears are tender.

4-Remove the foil and place the dish under a hot grill for 3 minutes. Serve immediately.

COOK'S TIP

Choose ripe pears in season such as Conference, William or Cornice.

Mushroom Croustades

The rich mushroom flavour of this filling is heightened by the addition Of mushroom ketchup.

Ingredients:

Serves 2-4

1 short French stick, about 25 cm/10 in

10 ml/2 tsp olive oil

250 g/9 oz open cup mushrooms, quartered

10 ml/2 tsp mushroom ketchup

10 ml/2 tsp lemon juice

30 ml/2 tbsp skimmed milk

30 ml/2 tbsp snipped fresh chives salt and freshly ground black pepper snipped fresh chives, to garnish

1-Preheat the oven to 200oC/400oF/Gas 6. Cut the French bread in half lengthways. Cut a scoop out of the soft middle of each half, leaving a thick border all the way round.

2-Brush the bread with oil, place 2on a baking sheet and bake for about 6-8 minutes, until golden and crisp.

3-Place the mushrooms in a small saucepan with the mushroom ketchup, lemon juice and milk. Simmer for about 5 minutes, or until most of the liquid is evaporated.

4-Remove from the heat, then add the chives and season with salt and pepper. Spoon into the bread croustades and serve hot, garnished with snipped chives.

Tomato Pesto Toasties

The flavour of pesto is so powerful that it can be used in very small amounts to good effect, as in these tasty snacks.

Ingredients:

Serves 2

2 thick slices crusty bread

45 ml/3 tbsp cream cheese or fromage frais

10 ml/2 tsp red or green pesto

1 beef tomato

1 red onion

salt and freshly ground black pepper

chopped basil, to garnish

1-Toast the bread slices until golden brown on both sides. Leave to cool.

2-Mix together the cheese and pesto in a small bowl until well blended, then spread thickly on the toasted bread.

3-Using a large sharp knife, cut the beef tomato and red onion crossways into thin slices.

4-Arrange the tomato and onion slices, overlapping, on the toast and season with salt and pepper. Transfer to a grill rack and heat through under a hot grill. Serve, garnished with chopped basil.

COOK'S TIP

Almost any type of crusty bread can be used for this recipe, but Italian olive oil bread and French bread will give the best flavour.

New Spring Vegetable Salad

This chunky salad make a satisfying meal. Use other spring vegetables, if you like.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

675 g/ 1 ½ lb small new potatoes, halved

400g/14oz can broad beans, drained

115 g/4 oz cherry tomatoes

75 g/3 oz/½ cup walnut halves

30 ml/2 tbsp white wine vinegar

15 ml/1 tbsp wholegrain mustard

60 ml/ 4 tbsp olive oil pinch of sugar

225 g/8 oz young asparagus spears, trimmed

6 spring onions, trimmed

salt and freshly ground black pepper baby spinach leaves, to serve

1-Put the potatoes in a saucepan. Cover with cold water and bring to the boil. Cook for 10-12 minutes, until tender. Meanwhile, put the broad beans in a bowl. Cut the tomatoes in half and add them to the bowl with the walnuts.

2-Put the white wine vinegar, mustard, olive oil and sugar into a jar. Season with salt and pepper. Close the jar tightly and shake well.

3-Add the asparagus to the potatoes and cook for 3 minutes more. Drain the cooked vegetables well. Cool under cold running water and drain again.

4-Add the asparagus, potatoes and spring onions to the bowl containing the broad bean mixture. Pour the dressing over the salad and toss well. Serve on a bed of baby spinach leaves. Thickly slice the potatoes and cut the spring onions in half.

Fresh Spinach and Avocado Salad

Young, tender spinach leaves make a change from lettuce and are delicious served with avocado, cherry tomatoes and radishes in a tofu sauce.

Ingredients:

Serves 2-3

1 large avocado

Juice of 1 lime

225 g/8 oz fresh baby spinach leaves

115 g/4 oz cherry tomatoes

4 spring onions, sliced

1/2 cucumber

50 g/2 oz radishes, sliced

For the dressing

115 g/4 oz soft silken tofu

45 ml/3 tbsp milk

10 ml/2 tsp prepared mustard

2.5 ml/1/2tsp white wine vinegar Pinch of cayenne, plus extra to serve Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Cut the avocado in half, remove the stone, and strip off the skin. Cut the flesh into slices. Transfer to a plate, drizzle over the lime juice, and set aside.

2-Wash and dry the spinach leaves. Put them in a mixing bowl.

3-Cut the larger cherry tomatoes in half, and add all the tomatoes to the mixing bowl, with the spring onions. Cut the cucumber into chunks, and add to the bowl with the sliced radishes.

4-Make the dressing. Put the tofu, milk, mustard, wine vinegar and cayenne in a food processor or blender. Add salt and pepper to taste. Process for 30 seconds until smooth. Scrape the dressing into a bowl, and add a little extra milk if you like a thinner dressing. Sprinkle with a little extra cayenne, and garnish with radish roses and herb sprigs.

COOK'S TIP

Use soft, silken tofu rather than the firm block variety. It can be found in most supermarkets in long-life cartons.

Sweet and Sour Peppers with Pasta Bows

A zesty dressing makes this simple pasta salad really special.

Ingredients:

Serves 4-6

1 each red, yellow and orange pepper

1 garlic clove, crushed

30 ml/2 tbsp capers

30 ml/2 tbsp raisins

5 ml/1 tsp wholegrain mustard

Grated rind and juice of 1 lime

5 ml/1 tsp runny honey

30 ml/2 tbsp chopped fresh coriander

225 g/8 oz pasta bows

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Shavings of Parmesan cheese, to serve (optional)

1-Quarter the peppers and remove the stalks and seeds. Put into boiling water and cook for 10-15 minutes, until tender. Drain and rinse under cold water. Peel away the skins and seeds and cut the flesh lengthways into strips.

2-Put the garlic, capers, raisins, mustard, lime rind and juice, honey and coriander into a bowl. Season with salt and pepper and whisk together.

3-Cook the pasta in a large pan of boiling salted water for 10-12 minutes, until tender. Drain thoroughly.

4-Return the pasta to the pan, add the peppers and dressing. Heat gently and toss to mix. Transfer to a warm serving bowl. Serve with a few shavings of Parmesan cheese, if using.

Bulgur Wheat and Broad Bean Salad

This appetizing salad is ideal served with fresh crusty wholemeal bread and home-made chutney or pickle.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

350 g/ 12 oz/2 cups bulgur wheat

225 g/8 oz frozen broad beans

115 g/4 oz/1 cup frozen petit pois

225 g/8 oz cherry tomatoes, halved

1 Spanish onion, chopped

1 red pepper, seeded and chopped

50 g/2 oz mangetouts, chopped

50 g/2 oz watercress

15 ml/1 tbsp chopped fresh parsley

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh basil

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh thyme

French dressing

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Soak and cook the bulgur wheat according to the package instructions. Drain thoroughly and put into a serving bowl.

2-Meanwhile, cook the broad beans and petit pois in boiling water for 3 minutes. Drain and add to the prepared bulgur wheat.

3-Add the cherry tomatoes, onion, pepper, mangetouts and watercress to the bulgur wheat mixture. Toss well together in the bowl until all the ingredients are well-combined.

4-Add the chopped fresh parsley, basil and thyme and French dressing to taste. Season with salt and pepper and toss the ingredients together. Serve immediately or cover and chill in the refrigerator before serving.

COOK'S TIP

Use cooked couscous, boiled town rice or wholewheat pasta in place of the bulgur wheat.

Sweet and Sour Artichoke Salad

Agrodolce is a sweet and sour sauce which works perfectly in this salad.

Ingredients: Serves 4

6 small globe artichokes

Juice of 1 lemon

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

2 medium onions, roughly chopped

175 g/6 oz/1 cup fresh or frozen broad beans (shelled weight)

175 g/6 oz/1 1/2 cups fresh or frozen peas (shelled weight)

salt and freshly ground black pepper fresh mint leaves, to garnish

For the salsa agrodolce

120 ml/4 fl oz//2 cup white wine vinegar

15 ml/ 1 tbsp caster sugar

handful fresh mint leaves, roughly torn

1-Peel the outer leaves from the artichokes and cut into quarters. Place them in a bowl of water with the lemon juice.

2-Heat the oil in a large saucepan and cook the onions until golden. Add the beans and stir.

3-Drain the artichokes and add them to the pan. Pour in about 300 ml/1 1/2 pint/ 1 1/4 cups of water and cover. Simmer gently for 10-15 minutes.

4-Add the peas, season with salt and pepper and cook for a further 5 minutes, stirring from time to time, until the vegetables are tender.

5-Strain the vegetables through a sieve and place them in a bowl. Leave to cool, then cover and chill in the refrigerator.

6-To make the salsa, mix all the ingredients in a pan. Heat gently until the sugar has dissolved. Simmer for 5 minutes. Leave to cool. Drizzle over the salad. Garnish with mint leaves.

Spanish Asparagus and Orange Salad

Complicated salad dressings are rarely found in Spain - they simply rely on the wonderful flavour of a good quality olive oil

Ingredients:

Serves 4

225 g/8 oz asparagus, trimmed and cut into 5 cm/2 in pieces

2 large oranges

2 tomatoes, cut into eighths

50 g/2 oz romaine lettuce leaves, shredded

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

2.5 ml/ 1/2tsp sherry vinegar

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Cook the asparagus in boiling salted water for 3-4 minutes, until just tender. Drain and refresh under cold water.

2-Grate the rind from half an 2orange and reserve. Peel both the oranges and cut into segments. Squeeze out the juice from the membrane and reserve the juice.

3-Put the asparagus, orange segments, tomatoes and lettuce into a salad bowl. Mix together the oil and vinegar and add 15 ml/ 1 tbsp of the reserved orange juice and 2.5 ml/ 1 tsp of the rind. Season the dressing with salt and pepper. Just before serving, pour the dressing over the salad and mix gently to coat.

COOK'S TIP

Cos or Little Gem lettuce can be used in place of romaine.

Grilled Goat's Cheese Salad

Here is the salad and cheese course on one plate - or serve it as a quick and satisfying starter or light lunch. The fresh tangy flavour of goat's cheese contrasts with the mild salad leaves.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

2 firm round whole goat's cheeses, such as Crottin de Chavignol (about 65-115 g/2 1/2-4 oz each)

4 slices French bread

Olive oil, for drizzling

175 g/6 oz mixed salad leaves, including soft and bitter varieties

Snipped fresh chives, to garnish

For the dressing

1/2 clove garlic

5 ml/ 1 tsp Dijon mustard

5 ml/1 tsp white wine vinegar

5 ml/ 1 tsp dry white wine

45 ml/3 tbsp olive oil

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-To make the dressing, rub a large salad bowl with the cut side of the garlic clove. Combine the mustard, vinegar, wine, salt and pepper in a bowl. Whisk in the oil, 15 ml/ 1 tbsp at a time, to form a thick vinaigrette.

2-Cut the goat's cheeses in half crossways using a sharp knife.

3-Preheat the grill to hot. Arrange the bread slices on a baking sheet and toast on one side. Turn over and place a piece of cheese, cut side up, on each slice. Drizzle with oil and grill until the cheese is lightly browned.

4-Add the leaves and the dressing to the salad bowl and toss to coat the leaves thoroughly. Divide the salad among four plates, top each with a goat's cheese crouton and serve, garnished with chives.

Tomato and Feta Cheese Salad

Sweet sun-ripened tomatoes are rarely more delicious than when served with feta cheese and olive oil. This salad, popular in Greece and Turkey, is enjoyed as a light meal with pieces of crispy bread.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

900 g/2 lb tomatoes

200 g/7 oz feta cheese

120 ml/4 fl oz/ 1/2 cup olive oil, preferably Greek

12 black olives

4 sprigs of fresh basil freshly ground black pepper

1-Remove the tough cores from the tomatoes with a small sharp knife.

2-Slice the tomatoes thickly and arrange in a shallow dish.

3-Crumble the cheese over the tomatoes, sprinkle with olive oil, then strew with olives and fresh basil. Season with black pepper and serve at room temperature.

COOK'S TIP

Feta cheese has a strong flavour and can be salty. The least salty variety is imported from Greece and Turkey and is available from specialist delicatessens.

STARTERS

Rocket, Pear and Parmesan Salad

For a sophisticated start to an elaborate meal, try this simple salad of honey-rich pears, fresh

Parmesan and aromatic leaves of rocket.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

3 ripe pears, Williams or Packhams

10ml/2tsp lemon juice

45 ml/3 tbsp hazelnut or walnut oil

115 g/4 oz rocket

75 g/3 oz Parmesan cheese

freshly ground black pepper open-textured bread, to serve

1-Peel and core the pears and slice thickly. Moisten with lemon juice to keep the flesh white.

2-Combine the nut oil with the pears. Add the rocket leaves and toss.

3-Turn the salad out on to 4 small plates and top with shavings of Parmesan cheese. Season with freshly ground black pepper and serve with open- textured bread.

COOK'S TIP

If you are unable to buy rocket easily, you can grow your own from early spring to late summer.

Tomato, Spring Onion and Coriander Salad

Known as Cachumbar, this salad relish is most commonly served with Indian curries. There are many versions, and this one will leave your mouth feeling cool and fresh after a spicy meal

Ingredients:

Serves 4

3 ripe tomatoes

2 spring onions, chopped

1.5 ml/ 1/4 tsp caster sugar

45 ml/3 tbsp chopped fresh coriander

Salt.

1-Remove the tough cores from the tomatoes with a small sharp knife.

2-Halve the tomatoes, remove the seeds and dice the flesh.

3-Combine the tomatoes with the spring onions, sugar, chopped coriander and salt. Serve at room temperature

COOK'S TIP

This refreshing salad also makes a fine filler for pitta bread with hummus.

Artichoke Pasta Salad

Broccoli and black olives add colour to this delicious salad.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

105 ml/7 tbsp olive oil

1 red pepper, quartered, seeded, and thinly sliced

1 onion, halved and thinly sliced

5 ml/ 1 tsp dried thyme

45 ml/3 tbsp sherry vinegar

450g / 1 lb pasta shapes, such as penne or fusilli

2 x 175g/6oz jars marinated artichoke hearts, drained and thinly sliced

150g/5oz cooked broccoli, chopped

20-25 salt-cured black olives, stoned and chopped

30ml/2 tbsp chopped fresh parsley salt and ground black pepper

1-Heat 30ml/2 tbsp of the olive oil in a non-stick frying pan Add the red pepper and onion and cook over a low heat until just soft, about 8-10 minutes, stirring from time to time.

2-Stir in the thyme, 1.5ml/'/4 tsp salt and the vinegar. Cook, stirring, for a further 30 seconds, then set aside.

3-Cook the pasta in plenty of boiling salted water according to the instructions on the packet

until al dente. Drain, rinse with hot water, then drain again. Transfer to a large bowl. Add 30ml/2 tbsp of the oil and toss well to coat thoroughly.

4-Add the artichokes, broccoli, olives, parsley, onion mixture and remaining oil to the pasta. Season with salt and pepper. Stir to blend. Leave to stand for at least 1 hour before serving or chill overnight. Serve the salad at room temperature.

Title: Grilled Vegetable Terrine

Serves: 6

Ingredients:

- 2 Large red peppers, quartered, cored and seeded
- 2 Large yellow peppers, quartered, cored and seeded
- 1 Large aubergine, sliced lengthways
- 2 Large courgettes, sliced lengthways
- 90 ml/6 tbsp olive oil
- 1 Large red onion, thinly sliced
- 75 g /3 oz ½ cup
- 15 ml /1 tbsp tomato puree
- 15 ml /1 tbsp red wine vinegar
- 400 ml /14 fl oz 1 2/3 cups tomato juice
- 15 g /1/2 oz/2 tbsp vegetarian gelatine fresh basil leaves, to garnish

for the dressing:

- 90 ml / 6 tbsp olive oil
- 30 ml / 2 tbsp red wine vinegar
- salt and freshly ground black pepper

Directions:

1. Place the peppers skin side up under a hot grill and cook until blackened. Put in a bowl.

Cover

2. Arrange the aubergine and courgette slices on separate baking sheets. Brush them with oil and cook under the grill.
3. Heat the remaining olive oil in a frying pan. Add the onion, raisins, tomato puree and red wine vinegar. Cook until soft.

4. Line a 1.75 litre/3 pint / 7 ½ cup terrine with clear film

5. Pour half the tomato juice into a sauce pan. Sprinkle with the gelatine. Dissolve over a low heat.

6. Layer the red peppers in the terrine, and cover with some of the tomato juice and gelatine.

Add the aubergine, courgettes, yellow peppers and onion mixture.

7. Pour tomato juice over each layer of vegetables and finish with another layer of red peppers.

8. Add the remaining tomato juice to any left in the pan and pour into the terrine. Give the terrine a sharp tap, to disperse the juice. Cover and chill in the refrigerator until set.

9. To make the dressing, whisk together the oil and vinegar. Season with salt and pepper.

10. Turn out the terrine and remove the clear film. Serve in thick slices, drizzle with dressing.

Garnish with basil leaves.

Title: Wild Mushroom Soup

Serves: 4

Ingredients:

25g/1oz/2 cups dried porcini mushrooms.

30ml/2 tbsp butter

2 leeks, thinly sliced

2 shallots, roughly chopped

225 g/8 oz fresh wild mushrooms

about 1.2 liters/ 2 pints/ 5 cups vegetable stock.

2.5 ml/1/2 tsp dried thyme

150 ml/1/4 pint/1 cup double cream

salt and freshly ground black pepper sprigs of fresh thyme, to garnish

Directions:

1- Put the dried porcini in a bowl, add 250 ml/8 fl oz/1 cup warm water and leave to soak for 20-30 minutes. Lift out of the liquid and squeeze over the bowl to remove as much of the soaking liquid as possible. Strain all the liquid and reserve to use later. Finely chop the porcini

2- Heat the oil and butter in a large saucepan until foaming. Add the sliced leeks, chopped shallots and garlic and cook gently for about 5 minutes, stirring frequently, until softened but not coloured

3- Chop or slice the fresh mushrooms and add to the pan. Stir over a medium heat for a few minutes until they begin to soften. Pour in the stock and bring to the boil. Add the porcini soaking liquid, dried thyme and salt and pepper. Lower the heat, half cover the pan and simmer gently for 30 minutes, stirring occasionally.

4- Pour about three-quarters of the soup into a blender or food processor and process until smooth. Return the processed soup to the soup remaining in the pan, stir in the cream and heat through. Check the consistency and add more stock if necessary. Season with salt and pepper. Serve hot, garnished with thyme sprigs

COOK'S TIP: Porcini are ceps. Italian cooks would make this soup with a combination of fresh and dried ceps, but if fresh ceps are difficult to obtain, you can use other wild mushrooms such as chanterelles

Title: Tomato And Fresh Basil Soup

Serves: 4-6

Ingredients.

150 ml/ 1 tbsp Olive Oil

25 gr/ 1 oz/ 2 tbsp Butter

1 medium Onion, finely chopped

900 gr/ 2 lbs ripe Italian Pump Tomatoes, roughly chopped

About 750 ml/ 1 ¼ pints/ 3 cups vegetable stock.

120 ml/ 4 fl oz/ ½ cup Dry White Wine

300 ml/ 2 tbsp sun-dried Tomato Paste

300 ml/ 2 tbsp shredded fresh Basil

150 ml/ ¼ pint/ 2/3 cup Double Cream Salt and freshly ground black pepper Whole Basil leaves, to garnish.

Directions:

1-Heat the Oil and Butter in a large saucepan until foaming. Add the Onion and cook gently for about 5 minutes, stirring, until the onion is softened but not brown.

2-Stir in the chopped tomatoes and garlic, then add the stock, white wine and sun-dried tomato paste, with salt and pepper to taste. Bring to the boil, then lower the heat, half cover the pan and simmer gently for 20 minutes stirring occasionally to stop the tomatoes sticking to the base of the pan.

3-Process the soup with the shredded basil in a blender or food processor, then press through a sieve into a clean pan

4-Add the double cream and heat through, stirring. Do not, allow the soup to approach boiling point. Check the consistency and add more stock if necessary then season with salt and pepper. Pour into heated bowls and garnish with basil. Serve at once.

Title: Cream of Courgette Soup

Serves: 4-6

Ingredients:

30 ml/2 tbsp Olive oil

15 g/ ½ oz/ 1 tbsp Butter.

1 medium Onion, roughly chopped

900 g/2 lb courgettes, trimmed and sliced

5 ml/ 1 tsp dried Oregano

about 600 /1 pint/2 1/2 cup vegetable stock

Directions:

1- Heat the oil and butter in a large saucepan until foaming. Add the onion and cook gently for about 5 minutes, stirring frequently, until softened but not brown.

2-Add the courgettes and 2oregano with salt and pepper to taste. Cook over a medium heat for 10 minutes, stirring frequently. Pour in the stock and bring to the boil, stirring

3-Lower the heat, half cover the and simmer gently, stirring occasionally, for about 30 minutes. Stir in the diced dolcelatte until melted.

4-Process the soup in a blender or food processor until smooth, then press through a sieve, into a clean pan.

5-Add two-thirds of the cream, 5and stir over a low heat until hot, but not boiling. Add more vegetable stock or water if the soup is too thick. Season with salt and pepper. Pour into heated bowls. Swirl in the remaining cream. Serve, garnished with oregano, extra cheese, cream and pepper.

COOK'S T I P To save time, trim off and discard the courgettes, cut them into thirds, then chop in a food processor fitted with a metal blade.

Title: Garlic, Chick-pea and Spinach Soup

Serves: 4

Ingredients:

30 ml/2 tbsp Olive oil

4 Garlic Cloves, crushed

1 onion, roughly chopped

10 ml/2 tsp ground Cumin

10 ml/2 tsp ground Coriander

1.2 litres/2 pints/5 cups Vegetable Stock

350 g/ 1 2 oz potatoes, peeled and finely chopped

425 g/15 oz can chick-peas, drained

15 ml/1 tbsp cornflour

150 ml/1/4 pint/2/3 cup double cream

30 ml/2 tbsp light Tahini (sesame seed paste)

200 g/7 oz spinach, shredded cayenne pepper

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Directions:

1-Heat the oil in a large saucepan and cook the garlic and onion for 5 minutes, or until they are softened and golden brown.

2-Stir in the cumin and coriander and cook for a further minute.

3-Pour in the stock and add the chopped potatoes to the pan. Bring to the boil and simmer for 10 minutes. Add the chick-peas and simmer for a further minutes, or until the potatoes and chick-peas are just tender

4-Blend together the cornflour, cream, tahini and plenty of seasoning. Stir into the soup with the spinach. Bring to the boil, and simmer for a further 2 minutes. Season with cayenne pepper, salt and black pepper Serve immediately, sprinkled with a little cayenne pepper

Title: Classic French Onion Soup

Serves: 4

Ingredients:

4 large onions

30 ml/2 tbsp sunflower or olive oil, or 15 ml/1 tbsp of each

25 g/1 oz/2 tbsp butter

900 ml/1 1/2 pints/3 3/4 cups vegetable stock

4 slices French bread

40-50 g/1 1/2-2 oz Gruyere or Cheddar cheese, grated

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Directions:

1-Peel and quarter the onions slowly and carefully, the onions and slice or chop them into

5 mm/ 1/4 in pieces. Heat the oil and butter in a deep saucepan, preferably with a medium-size base so that the onions form a thick layer.

2-Fry the onions briskly for a few minutes, stirring constantly.

3-Reduce the heat and cook gently for 45-60 minutes. At first, the onions need to be stirred only occasionally but as they begin to colour, stir frequently. The colour of the onions gradually turns golden and then more rapidly to brown, so take care to stir constantly at this stage so that they do not burn on the base

4-When the onions are a rich mahogany brown, add the vegetable stock and a little seasoning. Simmer, partially covered, for 30 minutes, then season with salt and pepper.

5-Preheat the grill and toast the French bread. Spoon the soup into four ovenproof serving dishes and place a piece of bread in each. Sprinkle with the cheese and grill for a few minutes until golden. Season with plenty of freshly ground black pepper.

Title: White Bean Soup

Serves: 6

Ingredients:

350 g/ 12 oz/1 1/2 cups dried cannellini or other white beans

1 bay leaf

75 ml/5 tbsp Olive oil

1 medium Onion, finely chopped

1 Carrot, finely chopped

1 stick Celery, finely chopped

3 medium Tomatoes, peeled and finely chopped

2 cloves Garlic, finely chopped

5 ml/ 1 tsp fresh thyme leaves or 2.5 ml/ 1/2 tsp dried thyme

750 ml/1 1/4 pints/3 cups boiling water Salt and freshly ground black pepper Olive oil, to serve

Directions:

1-Pick over the beans carefully, discarding any stones or other particles. Rinse thoroughly in cold water to ensure that they are clean. Soak in a large bowl of cold water overnight. Drain the beans and place them in a large saucepan of water, bring to the boil and cook for 20 minutes. Drain. Return the beans to the pan, cover with cold water and bring to the boil again. Add the bay leaf and cook until the beans are tender for approximately 1-2 hours. Drain again. Remove the Bay leaf.

2-Puree about three-quarters of the beans in a food processor or pass through a food mill, adding a little water if necessary, to create a smooth paste.

3-Heat the oil in a large saucepan. Stir in the onion and cook until it softens. Add the carrot and celery, and cook for 5 minutes more.

4-Stir in the tomatoes, garlic and thyme. Cook for 6-8 minutes more, stirring often.

5-Pour in the boiling water. Stir in the beans and the bean puree. Season with salt and pepper. Simmer for 10-15 minutes. Serve in individual soup bowls, sprinkled with a little olive oil.

COOK'S TIP

Other types of canned cooked beans, such as canneuni or borlotti, may be substituted in this recipe. Simply drain the beans and omit Step 1.

Title: Asparagus Soup

Serves: 4

Ingredients:

450 g/lb young Asparagus

40g/1 1/2oz/3 tbsp Butter

6 Shallots, sliced

15 g/ 1/2oz/ 1 tbsp plain Flour

600 ml/ 1 pint/2 1/2cups Vegetable stock or water

15 ml/ 1 tbsp lemon juice

250 ml/8 fl oz/1 cup milk

120 ml/4 fl oz/1/2cup single Cream

10 ml/2 tsp chopped fresh Chervil salt and freshly ground black pepper

Directions:

1-Cut 4 cm/ 1 1/2 in off the tops of half the asparagus and set aside for a garnish. Slice the remaining asparagus.

2-Melt 25 g/1 oz/2 tbsp of the butter in a large saucepan and fry the sliced shallots for 2-3 minutes until soft.

3-Add the asparagus and fry over low heat for about 1 minute.

4-Stir in the flour and cook for 1 minute. Stir in the stock or water and lemon juice and season with salt and pepper. Bring to the boil, half cover the pan, then simmer for 15-20 minutes, until the asparagus is very tender.

5-Cool slightly and then process the soup in a food processor or blender until smooth. Press the pureed asparagus through a sieve into a clean saucepan. Add the milk by pouring and stirring it through the sieve with the asparagus so as to extract the maximum amount of asparagus puree.

6-Melt the remaining butter and fry the reserved asparagus tips gently for 3-4 minutes to soften.

7-Heat the soup gently for 3-4 minutes. Stir in the cream and the asparagus tips. Continue to heat gently and serve sprinkled with chopped fresh chervil.

Title: Chilled Vegetable - Avocado Soup

1-15 oz can spicy chili beans, undrained

12 oz canned vegetable juice

1/4 cup lime juice

1 large tomato, chopped

1 medium avocado, cut into cubes

1/2 cup chopped celery

1 tablespoon chopped parsley

1/2 teaspoon chili powder

2 tablespoons nonfat sour cream

Combine all ingredients, except sour cream in a large bowl. Mix well, cover and refrigerate for one hour. Serve with a dollop of sour cream. As prepared, 1 1/4 cups equals 264 calories, 11g fat. From Shape magazine.

You can also: Substitute black beans for chili beans, V-8 in glass instead of a can, and Tabasco for chili powder. Omit the avocado if you are watching the fat grams. Add 1 tablespoon of fresh chopped cilantro. Adjust for taste. Refreshing on hot days, an excellent filler food for snacking.

Chunky Vegetable Soup

2 teaspoons vegetable oil

1 cup chopped onion

2 garlic cloves, minced

7 cups water

1 tablespoon dried basil

3/4 teaspoon salt

1/2 teaspoon dried marjoram

1/2 teaspoon pepper

1 pound red potatoes, cut in 1 inch cubes

1/2 pound small carrots, cut in one inch pieces

1 (15 oz) can cannellini or other white beans, drained

1 can whole tomatoes, undrained and chopped

1 (10 oz) package frozen lima beans

1/2 cup cooked orzo (rice shaped pasta)

1/2 cup shredded part-skim mozzarella cheese

1. Coat a large Dutch oven (big soup pot) with cooking spray, add oil, and place over medium heat until hot.

2. Add onion and garlic, sauté 5 minutes or until tender

3. Add water and next 9 ingredients (water through lima beans); bring to a boil

4. Cover, reduce heat and simmer 20 minutes. Add orzo, cook uncovered another 10 minutes

Ladle in individual bowls, sprinkle with cheese. From Cooking Light Magazine.

Leeway: Add 3 chicken boullion cubes, or use defatted chicken broth instead of water. I have substituted kidney beans for white beans, and pearl barley for orzo for a different variation that we seem to like better. If you use barley, add it when you put in the water, it requires more cooking time. You may need to simmer longer. This soup always tastes great on a cold day after a long run. It can last up to a week in an airtight container, or be frozen for three months. Soup makes an excellent meal in itself, especially when you want a light dinner.

Spiced Carrot and Celery Soup

Colourful, lively and warming - nice served with some vegan naan bread - in the

UK, the Co-op makes these. Ingredients:

1 tablespoon of olive oil

1 large onion, chopped

2 cloves of garlic, chopped

1 teaspoon of curry powder

6 medium carrots, roughly chopped

4 large sticks of celery, cut into pieces

2 pints/4 cups/1200ml of water

seasalt to taste

Fry the onion and garlic in the oil for a few minutes and then add the curry powder and stir to release the flavours. Add the carrots, celery and water and cook gently until the vegetables are tender. Whizz up in a liquidiser/blender until smooth and add salt.

Minted Noodle Soup

Although a hot dish it is nice for summer days as the mint is refreshing. This does make a large pot - it worked out well for a family of four to have over two lunches, storing it in the fridge overnight.

Ingredients:

250g/6oz (half a standard pack) of spaghetti

approx 9 or 10 cups of water/about 4 pints

4 cloves of garlic, very finely chopped

1 large onion, chopped

5 sticks of celery, diced quite small

a good handful of fresh mint (or 3 teaspoons of dried)

seasalt to taste

Break the spaghetti up into small pieces (about 6 cm./2 inches long) into a large saucepan. Cover with the water and turn up the heat to full. Bring to the boil while you prepare and add the other ingredients with the exception of the mint. Once boiling turn down to simmer for about 15 minutes until everything is cooked. Add the mint and cook for a further 2 or 3 minutes and serve sprinkled with generous amounts of chopped fresh parsley (optional but it was really good!).

Lentil, Garlic and Rosemary Soup

A cleansing and fortifying soup for the winter, combining the immune boosting properties of garlic and rosemary with the nutritious content of the lentils and carrots (zinc, iron and carotenes) . This recipe makes a large pot of soup - will feed 6 people at 2 sittings or you could freeze half for later.

Ingredients:

500g/12oz/2 cups of red lentils

approx 9 or 10 cups of water

1 whole bulb of garlic, peeled and finely chopped

either a large sprig of fresh rosemary, finely chopped or two teaspoons of dried

4 medium carrots diced quite small

seasalt to taste

Place the lentils in a large saucepan and cover with the water - bring to the boil while preparing the other ingredients. Reduce to a simmer and add the garlic, rosemary and carrots. Cook for a further 20 minutes until everything is ready and add the salt.

Yellow Split Pea Soup

A simple warming, filling soup for winter days.

Ingredients:

2 cups of dried yellow split peas, washed and soaked in water overnight

5 or 6 cups of water

1 large onion, chopped

3 carrots, chopped small

1 small turnip (or neep!) cut into small cubes

Salt and pepper to taste

Place the split peas in a large saucepan and cover well with water. Bring to the boil, reduce to a simmer and cook for about an hour or until the peas are soft and starting to go a bit mushy. Add the onion, carrots and neep and cook for a further 20 minutes until everything is tender. Season and enjoy with wholemeal bread...

Vegetable and Barley Soup

Chunky meal of a soup

Ingredients:

5 or 6 large potatoes, peeled and cubed

2 leeks cut into round slices

3 carrots, roughly chopped

5 celery sticks, cut onto chunks

1 cup of dried pearl barley

2 heads of swiss chard (or similar green leaf such as leaf beet or a couple of handfuls of spinach),
chopped

enough water to cover

Salt and pepper to taste

Very simple to prepare this one! Place all your vegetables except the chard in a large pan with the barley. Cover well with water, boil and simmer until everything is cooked. Add the chard and salt and cook for another 5 minutes.

Leek, Potato and Pea Soup

A chunky, filling winter soup. These quantities make a large pan of soup - they can easily be reduced by half if desired.

Ingredients:

2 tablespoons of sunflower oil

2 medium leeks, sliced widthways into thin round slices

2 or 3 cloves of garlic (crushed, optional)

6-8 large potatoes, cut into chunks (about 2 or 3 cm.)

2 tablespoons of white flour

1 cup of frozen peas

5 or 6 cups of water

Salt and pepper to taste

Cook the leeks and garlic, if using, in the sunflower oil for a few minutes then stir in the flour. Add one cup of water and stir well to blend. Add the potatoes and the rest of the water (you may need to adjust the quantity slightly - make sure all the vegetables are well covered). Bring to the boil, stirring occasionally to prevent sticking, and then turn down to simmer until the potatoes are just about cooked. Finally add the peas and cook for a further few minutes until tender. Season to taste.

Sweet Potato and Tomato soup

This soup is rich in vitamins A, C and E and also quite high in iron. If topped with pasta or rice it is also a good source of protein and carbohydrate.

Ingredients:

A little olive oil

1 onion

2 or 3 cloves of garlic (optional)

2 or 3 large sweet potatoes (the pink fleshed variety), peeled and roughly chopped

1 tin of tomatoes (approx. 400g/12oz)

Salt and pepper to taste

Fry the onion and garlic in the olive oil for a few moments. Add the sweet potatoes and tomatoes and simmer until the potatoes are just tender. Add the salt and pepper and liquidise until smooth. My family loves this soup with some whole-wheat pasta and fresh herbs on top, but you could also use rice or just have it on it's own with some bread.

Peppery Pumpkin Soup

This is a recipe that we almost always have at Halloween - we scrape out as much pumpkin flesh as we can before making the lantern!

Ingredients:

2 onions, chopped

A little vegetable oil or vegan margarine

The flesh of 1 pumpkin

3 to 4 cups of soya milk

seasalt to taste

freshly ground black or mixed pepper to taste (we like lots)

Fry the onion in the oil or margarine for a few minutes until soft then add the pumpkin and salt and cook for a further few minutes. Add the soya milk and bring to the boil - reduce heat and simmer gently until the pumpkin flesh is soft. Place the soup in a liquidiser and blend until smooth and frothy. Add the pepper - we find it a good idea to let everyone add their own.

Basic 'tattie' (potato) soup

This is so basic it hardly constitutes a 'recipe'! It is very simple and fairly bland - children love it.

Ingredients:

Onions (1 or 2), chopped

A little sunflower oil

Potatoes (2 lb/1 kilo/6 cups), cut into chunks Carrots (about 1 lb/450g/3 cups), cut into chunks

Turnip (8oz/200g/1 cup) - optional

Kale (or dark green cabbage) chopped

Garlic to taste, chopped

Herbs of your choice, fresh or dried (we tend to use sage)

Seasalt to taste

Fry the onion in the sunflower oil for a few minutes to seal the flavour then place all the other ingredients except the kale or cabbage in a pan and cover with water. Bring to the boil and simmer until the vegetables are cooked (15 - 20 minutes). Add the green vegetables 5 - 10 minutes before cooking is finished to prevent them being over-cooked. Mash well.

The quantities given make quite a large pan of soup - we eat half one day and store the rest in the fridge until the next day - you may wish to change the quantities to suit your needs.

Cream of Nettle soup

Don't worry - they don't sting when cooked! Nettles are very nutrient rich and of course - free! Don't gather them beside a busy road where they will have been contaminated by traffic fumes -

we pick them in our garden. If you keep cutting them from springtime you get a regular supply of fresh leaves. Though we stop using them into summer as they seem to get rather insecty!

Ingredients:

2 tablespoons of vegan margarine or oil

2 tablespoons of white flour

1 onion, roughly chopped

2 cloves garlic, chopped

Freshly picked and washed young nettles (several good handfuls - picked with gloves and caution!)

2 cups soya milk

1 cup water or stock

salt and pepper to taste

Fry the onion and garlic in the oil or marg. for a few minutes then stir in the nettles (no need to chop or remove stalks) until they soften. Stir in the flour and gradually add the soya milk and water or stock, stirring all the time. Add seasonings and liquidise. Delicious...

Tomato and Avocado soup - a cold dish.

This soup also contains vitamins A, C and E and is highly nutritious, as it is completely raw.

Ingredients:

1 large or 2 small avocados

1 tin of tomatoes

A good handful of fresh lovage

Parsley to taste

1 stick of celery

small amount of seasalt

1 cup of apple juice

1 cup of water

Place all the above in a blender and liquidise until smooth. Can be served chilled.

Carol's Minestrone Soup

Ingredients:

1 onion, chopped

1 clove of garlic, minced

1 leek, sliced

1 carrot, diced

1 pepper, diced

1 potato, diced or new potatoes, sliced

1 small can sweetcorn

1 small can black eyed beans

1 handful of pasta

2 1/2 pints/7 cups of good stock (marigold vegan powder) Adjust stock to taste may need more/less

1 heaped teaspoon of marmite mixed herbs

salt and pepper

Fry onion and garlic, add other ingredients, except beans and pasta and cook for approx 15/20

mins until veg is tender. Add beans and pasta cook for another 10/15 mins. Serve with nutritional yeast on top or with crusty bread. You can put any veg you like in it and it tastes better the next day, this makes loads by the way!

SOUPS

Fresh Tomato, Lentil and Onion Soup

This delicious wholesome soup is ideal served with thick slices of wholemeal or granary bread.

Ingredients:

Serves 4-6

10 ml/2 tsp Sunflower Oil

1 large Onion, chopped

2 sticks Celery, chopped

175 g/6 oz/3/4 cup split Red Lentils

2 large tomatoes, skinned and roughly chopped

900 ml/ 1 1/2 pints/3/4 cups Vegetable stock

10 ml/2 tsp dried Herbes de Provence Salt and freshly ground black pepper chopped Parsley, to garnish

1-Heat the oil in a large saucepan. Add the onion and celery and cook for 5 minutes, stirring occasionally. Add the lentils and cook for 1 minute.

2-Stir in the tomatoes, stock, dried herbs, salt and pepper Cover, bring to the boil and simmer for about 20 minutes, stirring occasionally.

3-When the lentils are cooked and tender, set the soup aside to cool slightly.

4-Puree in a blender or food processor until smooth. Season with salt and pepper, return to the saucepan and reheat gently until piping hot. Ladle into soup bowls to serve and garnish each with chopped parsley.

Split Pea and Courgette Soup

Rich and satisfying, this tasty and nutritious soup will warm a chilly winter's day.

Ingredients: Serves 4

175 g/6 oz/1 7/8 cups yellow split Peas

1 medium Onion, finely chopped

5 ml/1 tsp sunflower oil

2 medium Courgettes, finely diced

900 ml/ 1 1/2 pints/ 3 3/4 cups Vegetable stock

2.5 ml/1/2 tsp ground Turmeric

salt and freshly ground black pepper

crusty bread, to serve

1-Place the split peas in a bowl, cover with cold water and leave to soak for several hours or overnight. Drain, rinse in cold water and drain again.

2-Cook the onion in the oil in a covered pan, shaking occasionally, until soft. Reserve a handful of diced courgettes to use later.

3-Add the remaining courgettes to the pan. Cook for 2-3 minutes. Add the stock and turmeric and bring to the boil. Reduce the heat, cover and simmer for 30-40 minutes. Season.

4-When the soup is almost ready, bring a large saucepan of water to the boil, add the reserved diced courgettes and cook for 1 minute. Drain and add to the soup. Serve hot with warm crusty bread.

COOK'S TIP

For a quicker alternative, use red split lentils for this soup - they need no presoaking and cook very quickly. Adjust the amount of stock, if necessary.

CARROT AND CORIANDER SOUP

Nearly all root vegetables make excellent soups as they puree well and have an earthy flavour, which complements the sharper flavours of herbs and spices. Carrots are particularly versatile, and this simple soup is elegant in both flavour and appearance.

Ingredients:

Serves 4-6

450 g/lb carrots, preferably young and tender

15 ml/1 tbsp Sunflower oil

40 g/ 1 1/2 oz/3 tbsp Butter

1 Onion, chopped

1 stick celery, plus 2-3 pale leafy celery tops

2 small potatoes, peeled

1 litre/ 1 1/4 pints/4 cups Vegetable stock

10-15 ml/2-3 tsp ground Coriander

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh coriander

200 ml/7 fl oz/7/8 cup Milk

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Trim and peel the carrots and cut into chunks. Heat the oil and 25 g/ 1 oz/2 tbsp butter in a large flameproof casserole or heavy-based saucepan and fry the onion over a gentle heat for 3-4 minutes, until slightly softened.

2-Slice the celery and chop the potatoes. Add them to the onion in the pan, cook for a few minutes and then add the carrots Fry over a gentle heat for 3-4 minutes, stirring, and then cover.

3-Reduce the heat even further and sweat for about 10 minutes. Shake the pan or stir occasionally so the vegetables do not stick to the base.

4-Add the stock and bring to the boil. Half cover the pan and simmer for a further 8-10 minutes until the carrots and potatoes are tender.

5-Remove 6-8 tiny celery leaves for garnish and finely chop the remaining celery tops (about 15 ml/ 1 tbsp once chopped). Melt the remaining butter in a small saucepan and fry the ground coriander for about 1 minute, stirring constantly.

6-Reduce the heat and add the chopped celery tops and fresh coriander and fry for about 1 minute. Set aside.

7-Process the soup in a food processor or blender and pour into a clean saucepan. Stir in the milk and coriander mixture. Season, heat gently, taste and adjust seasoning. Serve garnished with the reserved celery leaves.

COOK'S TIP

For a more piquant flavour, add a little Lemon juice just before serving

Fresh Pea Soup

This soup is known in France as Potage Saint-Germain, a name which comes from a suburb of Paris where peas used to be cultivated in market gardens. If fresh peas are not available, use frozen peas, but thaw and rinse them before use.

Ingredients:

Serves 2-3

25 g/1 oz/2 tbsp Butter

2 or 3 Shallots, finely chopped

400 g/14 oz/3 cups shelled fresh peas (from about 1.3 kg/3 lb garden peas) or thawed frozen peas

45-60 ml/3-4 tbsp whipping cream (optional)

salt and freshly ground black pepper croutons, to garnish

1-Melt the butter in a heavy saucepan or flameproof casserole. Add the shallots and cook for about 3 minutes, stirring occasionally.

2-Add 500 ml/16 fl oz/2 cups water and the peas, and season with salt and pepper

3-Cover and simmer for 12 minutes for young or frozen peas and up to 18 minutes for large or older peas, stirring occasionally.

4-When the peas are tender, ladle them into a food processor or blender with a little of the cooking liquid and process until smooth.

5-Strain the soup into the saucepan or casserole, stir in the cream, if using, and heat through without boiling. Season with salt and pepper and serve hot when the peas are tender, ladle garnished with croutons.

PEA LEEK AND BROCCOLI SOUP

A delicious and nutritious soup, ideal for warming those chilly winter evenings.

Ingredients:

Serves 4-6

1 Onion, chopped

225 g/8 oz/2 cups Leeks (trimmed weight), sliced

225 g/8 oz unpeeled Potatoes, diced

900 ml/1 1/2 pints/3 1/4 cups Vegetable stock

1 Bay leaf

225 g/8 oz broccoli florets

175 g/6 oz/ 1 1/2 cups frozen peas

30-45 ml/2-3 tbsp chopped fresh Parsley salt and freshly ground black pepper parsley leaves, to garnish

1-Put the onion, leeks, potatoes, leaf in a large stock and bay saucepan and mix together. Cover, bring to the boil and simmer for 10 minutes, stirring.

2-Add the broccoli and peas, 2cover, return to the boil and simmer for a further 10 minutes, stirring occasionally.

3-Set aside to cool slightly and remove and discard the bay leaf Puree in a blender or food processor until smooth.

4-Add the parsley, season with salt and pepper and process briefly. Return to the saucepan and reheat gently until piping hot. Ladle into soup bowls and garnish with parsley leaves.

Gazpacho

This cold soup is popular all over Spain, where there are hundreds of variations. It uses tomatoes, tomato juice, green pepper and garlic, and is served with a selection of garnishes

Ingredients:

Serves 4

1.5 Kg/ 3-3 ½ lb ripe Tomatoes

1 green Pepper, seeded and roughly chopped

2 Garlic Cloves, crushed

2 slices White Bread, crusts removed

60 ml/4 tbsp Olive Oil

60 ml/4 tbsp tarragon wine vinegar

150 ml/¼ pint/⅓ cup tomato juice

Good pinch of Sugar

Salt and freshly ground Black Pepper

Ice cubes, to serve

For the garnish:

300 ml/ 2 tbsp Sunflower Oil

2-3 slices White Bread, diced.

1 small cucumber, peeled and finely diced

1 small onion, finely chopped

1 red pepper, seeded and finely diced

1 hard-boiled eggs, chopped

1-Skin and quarter the tomatoes, then remove the cores.

2-Place the pepper in a food processor and process for a few seconds. Add the tomatoes, garlic, bread, olive oil and vinegar and process again. Add the tomato juice, sugar, salt and pepper and process.

3-The mixture should be thick but not too stodgy. Continue processing until it is the right consistency. Press the liquid through a sieve into a bowl and chill for at least 2 hours but no more than 12 hours, otherwise the texture will deteriorate.

4-To prepare the bread cubes to use as a garnish, heat the oil in frying pan and fry them over a moderate heat for 4-5 min, until golden brown. Drain well on kitchen paper.

5-Place each garnish in a separate small dish, or alternative arrange them in rows on a large plate.

6-Just before serving, stir a few ice cubes into the soup and then spoon into serving bowls. Serve with the garnishes.

Cold Leek and Potato Soup

Serve this flavourful soup with a dollop of creme fraiche or soured cream to add richness to this warming broth on cold winter evenings. Sprinkle with a few snipped fresh chives.

Ingredients.

Serves 6-8

450 g/ 1 lb Potatoes, peeled and cubed

1.5 litres/2 1/2 pints/6 1/4 cups Vegetable stock

4 medium Leeks, trimmed

150 ml/ 1/4 pint/ 2/3 cup creme fraiche or soured cream

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

45 ml/3 tbsp snipped fresh chives, to garnish

1-Put the potatoes and stock in a saucepan or flameproof casserole and bring to the boil. Reduce the heat and simmer for 15-20 minutes.

2-Make a slit along the length of each leek and rinse well under cold running water. Slice thinly.

3-When the potatoes are barely tender, stir in the leeks. Season with salt and pepper and simmer for 10-15 minutes until the vegetables are soft, stirring occasionally. If the soup appears too thick, thin it down with a little more of the stock or water.

4-Puree the soup in a blender or food processor, in batches if necessary. If you would prefer a very smooth soup, pass it through a food mill or press through a coarse sieve. Stir in most of the cream, cool and then chill. To serve, ladle into chilled bowls and garnish with a swirl of cream and snipped chives.

VARIATION

To make a low-fat soup, use low-fat fromage frais instead of creme fraiche or soured cream, or simply thin the soup with a little skimmed milk.

Parmesan and Cauliflower Soup

A silky smooth, mildly cheesy soup, which isn't overpowered by the cauliflower. It makes an elegant dinner-party soup served with crisp Melba toast.

Ingredients.

Serves 6

1 large cauliflower

1.2 litres/2 pints/5 cups vegetable stock or water

175g/6oz farfalle

150ml/1/4 pint/2/3 cup single cream or milk

freshly grated nutmeg pinch of cayenne pepper

60ml/4 tbsp freshly grated Parmesan cheese

Salt and ground black pepper

For the Melba toast

3-4 slices day-old white bread

freshly grated Parmesan cheese for sprinkling

1.5 ml/1/4 tsp paprika

1-Cut the leaves and central stalk away from the cauliflower and discard. Divide the cauliflower into similar-size florets.

2-Bring the stock to the boil and add the cauliflower. Simmer for about 10 minutes or until very soft. Remove the cauliflower slotted spoon and place in a blender or food processor.

3-Add the pasta to the stock and simmer for 10 minutes until tender. Drain, reserve the pasta, and pour the liquid over the cauliflower. Add the cream or milk, nutmeg and cayenne to the cauliflower and blend until smooth.

4-Press the soup through a sieve then stir in the cooked pasta. Reheat the soup and stir in the Parmesan. Season to taste.

5-Meanwhile make the Melba toast. Preheat the oven to 180oC/350oF/Gas 4. Toast the bread lightly on both sides. Quickly cut off the crusts and split each slice in half horizontally. Scrape off any doughy bits and sprinkle with Parmesan and paprika. Place on a baking sheet and bake in the oven for about 10-15 minutes or until uniformly golden. Serve with the soup.

Italian Bean and Pasta Soup

A thick and hearty soup which followed by bread and cheese, make a substantial lunch.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

175g/6oz/1 1/2 cups dried haricot beans, soaked overnight in cold water

1.75 litres/3 pints/7 1/2 cups vegetable stock or water

115g/4oz medium pasta shells

60ml/4 tbsp olive oil, plus extra to serve

2 garlic cloves, crushed

60ml/4 tbsp chopped fresh parsley

Salt and ground black pepper

1-Drain the beans and place in a large saucepan with the stock or water. Simmer, half-covered, for 2-2 1/2 hours or until tender.

2-In a blender or food processor, process half the beans with a little of their cooking liquid, then stir into the unprocessed beans in the pan.

3-Add the pasta and simmer gently for 15 minutes until tender. (Add extra water or stock the soup seems too thick.)

4-Heat the oil in a small pan and fry the garlic until golden. Stir into the soup with the parsley and season well with salt and pepper. Ladle into individual bowls and drizzle each with a little extra olive oil, to serve.

Harvest Soup

INGREDIENTS Serves 4-6

1-2 tsp/5-10ml oil

1 onion, chopped

2 1/4 cups/350g/12oz pumpkin, peeled and diced

2 cups/250g/8oz carrots, sliced

2 potatoes

5 cups/1.1 1/2pts stock

juice of half a lemon

1 courgette, sliced (optional)

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1/3 cup/50g/2oz runner beans, sliced (optional)

basil leaves to garnish

1-Heat oil in a large saucepan and fry onion until translucent.

2-Add pumpkin, carrots and potatoes and pour over lemon juice. Sweat, covered, for 5 minutes.

3-Add stock and seasoning and simmer until potatoes are cooked. Blend or part-blend the soup.

4-If liked, add courgettes and beans and simmer for a further 4 minutes. Check seasoning.

5-Serve garnished with basil leaves. This soup can also be served sprinkled with Parmesan cheese.

Cream of Cauliflower

Ingredient:

Serves 4

1 small cauliflower

salt and freshly ground black pepper

4 tbsp/50g/2oz butter

1/4 cup/25g/1 oz plain untreated flour

6 tbsp/120ml/4fl oz single cream

1-2 egg yolks 1 tbsp/15ml chopped chives

SOUP

1-Trim the outer leaves off the cauliflower and steam it whole in boiling salted water in a pan with the lid on until tender. Allow the cauliflower to cool and reserve the water.

2-Melt the butter in a saucepan and stir in the flour. Gradually stir in the cauliflower water, made up to 3/4 cups/900ml/1 1/2 pts with fresh water.

3-Reserve some of the cauliflower florets for garnishing. Discard the tougher stalks and puree the rest in a blender. Add to the saucepan.

4-Beat the cream and egg yolks together in a bowl. Beat in some of the soup, then return to the pan. Add reserved cauliflower florets. Heat through but do not boil. Season and add chopped chives. Serve with triangles of hot toast.

Garlic Soup

INGREDIENTS Serves 4-6

5 cups/1.1 1/2pts vegetable stock

4 garlic cloves, crushed

3 level tsp/15mi paprika

3 level tsp/15mi cumin

salt and pepper

2 pieces bread, toasted oil

6 eggs (optional)

SOUP

1-Pour vegetable stock into a pan, add the garlic, paprika and cumin, and bring to the boil. Season.

2-Break the toast into cubes and put into soup bowls.

3-Place a pan on the heat, lightly oil and fry the eggs until the white forms. Tip out 1 egg into each soup bowl and pour over the boiling soup.

Cheese and Onion Soup

INGREDIENTS

serves 4-6

1-2 tbsp/15-30ml oil

2 medium onions, sliced

5 cups/1.1 l/2pts stock

250g/8oz potatoes

1 1/2 cups/175g/6oz grated cheddar cheese salt

soy sauce

SOUPS

1-Heat oil in a large saucepan and stir-fry onions until lightly browned. Add stock and bring to the boil.

2-Meanwhile, peel the potatoes and grate them into the saucepan. Turn down the heat and simmer until potatoes have cooked and soup has thickened.

3-Add the grated cheese, stirring to melt. Season to taste with salt and soy sauce. Serve with whole wheat bread and a crisp green salad.

SOUP

Butterbean and Mushroom Chowder

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-6

1 cup/100g/4oz butter beans soaked overnight in cold water

1 tsp/5ml olive oil

2 onions, chopped

2 stalks celery, sliced

8oz/225g potatoes, peeled and diced

4oz/100g button mushrooms, sliced

1/2 cup/50g/2oz sweetcorn kernels

1 ½ cups/300ml/ ½ pt skimmed milk

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

2 tbsp/30ml chopped parsley

1-Drain the beans and place in a large saucepan covered with fresh water. Boil fast for 10 minutes, then simmer for a further 35- 40 minutes, or until soft.

2-Drain the beans and reserve 2 cups/ 450ml/ ¾ pt of the stock.

3-Heat the oil in a large saucepan and gently fry the onion. Add the celery and potato and cook for 2-3 minutes, stirring from time to time. Add the reserved stock and mushrooms, bring to the boil, cover and simmer for 10 minutes.

Red-Hot Lentil Soup

INGREDIENTS

Serve: 6

3 tbsp/40g/1 ½ oz butter

1 large onion, chopped

1 clove garlic, chopped

1 slice fresh ginger root, unpeeled

1 slice lemon

1 1/8 cups/225g/8oz red lentils

7 cups/1.5l/2 ¾ pts water

Salt pinch of paprika

1 green chilli, deseeded and chopped

SOUP

1-Heat 2 tbsp/25g/1 oz butter in a pan and add the onion, garlic, ginger and lemon. Sweat with the lid on over a low heat for 5 minutes.

2-Add the lentils and the water (small red lentils do not need to be presoaked) and season with salt and paprika. Cook for about 40 minutes until lentils have thickened the soup.

3-Heat the remaining butter in a pan and quickly fry the chilli. Serve the soup with chilli topping.

Mushroom Soup INGREDIENTS Serves 6

butter or oil

1 large onion, sliced

SOUPS

6 cups/350g/12oz sliced mushrooms grated nutmeg

1 tbsp/15ml flour

2 cups/450ml/ ¾ pt vegetable stock

1 ¼ cups/300ml/ ½ pt yoghurt

2 tbsp/30ml sherry (optional)

1-Heat the butter and cook the onion until it has just softened but not browned. Add the mushrooms, stir and leave them to cook for 2 minutes. Add more butter if necessary.

2-Add the nutmeg and flour and stir well. Slowly add the stock, stirring until the mixture is smooth.

3-Bring the soup to the boil and then simmer for 5 minutes. Stir in the yoghurt and just warm it through. Add the sherry. Serve hot.

Cream of Nettle Soup INGREDIENTS serves 6

2lb/900g young nettles

2 tbsp/25g/l oz butter

1 small onion, chopped

¼ cup/25g/l oz flour

3 ¾ cups/900ml/30fl oz milk

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

2 egg yolks

SOUP

1 tbsp/15ml single cream and croutons to serve

1-Pick the young nettle leaves before the plants flower. Discard the stalks, wash the leaves and press them into a pan with only the water that is clinging to them. Cover the pan and cook until soft (5-8 minutes). Puree in a blender.

2-Heat the butter in a pan and cook the onion until soft. Stir in the flour. Stir in a little milk and cook until thick. Stir in enough of the remaining milk to make a very thin sauce. Add the milk and the sauce to the nettles. Season well.

3-Beat the egg yolks with the cream. Stir in a little of the soup, then return to the pan. Heat through and check seasoning.

4-To serve, add a swirl of cream and some cro6tons to each individual bowl.

Carrot and Coriander Soup

INGREDIENTS

serves 6-8

oil or butter

1 medium onion, sliced

9 cups/700g/l ½ lbs carrots, sliced

1 tsp/5ml ground coriander

3 ¼ cups/900ml/ ¼ pts vegetable stock

2/3 cup/150ml/ ¼ pt soured cream

salt and freshly ground black pepper parsley to garnish

SOUP

1-Heat the oil, add the onion and cook until it has just softened but not browned. Add the carrots and coriander and stir well. Leave the carrots to cook gently for 3 minutes.

2-Pour in the stock and bring the mixture to the boil, then simmer, covered, for 25 minutes.

3-Liquidize the soup, adding the soured cream. Adjust the seasoning. Serve very cold, garnished with parsley.

GAZPACHO

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-6

1 lb/450g large ripe tomatoes

1 large onion

2cloves garlic

1 green pepper

1 red pepper

½ cucumber

2 slices whole wheat bread

3 tbsp/45ml olive oil

3 tbsp/45ml wine vinegar

1 ¼ cups/300ml/ ¼ pt tomato juice

1 ¼ cups/300ml/ ½ pt water

salt and freshly ground black pepper

SOUP

1-Skin tomatoes, discard seeds and juice and chop the flesh. Peel and finely chop the onion and garlic. Remove pith and seeds from peppers and dice.

2-Peel and dice the cucumber. Cut the crusts from the bread and dice. Put vegetables and bread in a large bowl, pour over the remaining ingredients, stir and season. Chill well - overnight is best for a good tasty soup.

3-You can partly blend the soup if you wish, or blend all of it, in which case offer small bowls of chopped onions, tomatoes, peppers, cucumber and croutons as a garnish.

BROCCOLI AND ORANGE SOUP

INGREDIENTS Serves 6

1 medium onion, chopped

1 tbsp/15ml oil

1 lb/450g broccoli, chopped

SOUP

juice of 2 oranges

2 ½ cups/600ml/1 pt vegetable stock

1 ¼ cups/300ml/ ½ pt yoghurt

1 tbsp/15ml cornstarch

2 tbsp/30ml water

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-(Reserve some small pieces of broccoli for garnish, together with a little grated orange rind.)

2-Heat the oil and cook the onion until it has just softened but not browned.

3-Add the broccoli and stir round. Cook, covered, for a few minutes and then add the orange juice and stock. Bring to the boil, cover and simmer for about 20 minutes, until the broccoli is soft.

4-Puree the soup in a blender. Mix the cornstarch and water to a smooth paste and stir into the soup with salt and pepper to taste.

5-Return the soup to the heat and cook for a further five minutes. Serve, garnished with the reserved broccoli and the orange rind. Use frozen broccoli if fresh is not available. Serve cold if preferred.

Hummus or Houmous

This is a traditional Greek dish - can be used as a dip or a spread for sandwiches (fantastic combined with avocado and the naise below, in a sandwich). For a raw dish you can use sprouted chick peas in place of cooked ones.

Ingredients:

1 can (approx. 400g) of cooked chick peas (or you can soak overnight and cook 1 cup of dried chick peas)

2 Tablespoons of olive oil

1 - 2 cloves of fresh garlic

2 Tablespoons of tahini (sesame paste)

the juice of 1 lemon

a little water to blend

salt and pepper (optional)

Place all ingredients in a food processor and blend until fairly smooth - you may need to keep adding water bit by bit until you get the consistency you want.

Butterbean, Sage and Lemon Pate

Stolen from an idea by Catriona!

Ingredients:

1 tin (approx. 400g) of butterbeans (large limas)

2 teaspoons of olive oil

15 fresh sage leaves (or a teaspoon of dried)

the juice of 1 lemon

grated rind of half a lemon

Place all ingredients in a food processor and blend until smooth.

Guacamole

We have added a few bits and pieces to traditional guacamole - fantastic as a dip, sandwich filling or served on portabello mushrooms garnished with cucumber like here.

Ingredients:

2 ripe avocados

3 large tomatoes

1 - 2 cloves of fresh garlic

quarter teaspoon of chilli powder (or more if you like it hot!!)

the juice of 1 lemon

1 finely diced red pepper

1 finely diced green pepper salt and pepper (optional)

Place the avocados, tomatoes, garlic, chilli, lemon juice and seasonings in a food processor and blend until fairly smooth - stir in the peppers and there you go.

Soya 'Mayo'

Ingredients:

3 cups of soya milk

1 cup of sunflower oil a little cider vinegar

optional extras - garlic, herbs, chilli, curry powder

Place the soya milk in a liquidiser and start machine - add any of the optional extras ie. Garlic for garlic naise. Slowly add the oil while blending. Once it is all well blended add the vinegar (this will thicken the mixture instantly) and switch off the machine. This makes one very large jar, which will keep in the fridge for a few days - reduce the amounts if you wish.

Basic Tomato Sauce for pasta

Ingredients:

A little olive oil

1 onion, finely chopped

2 - 3 cloves of garlic, crushed

1 can (approx. 400g) tomatoes, chopped

2 Tablespoons of tomato puree

1 or 2 Tablespoons of oregano or mixed herbs

1 cup of veg. stock or water (or even wine, if you like, for a richer sauce)

Fry the onion and garlic in the oil for a few minutes until softened. Add the tomatoes, puree, stock or water and herbs and simmer gently for about 15 minutes.

That is the basic sauce - you can add anything you like to it. Any vegetables chopped and added with the tomatoes etc. Soya mince for a more traditional bolognese type sauce. Beans, sweetcorn, peas.

A sweet and sour sauce is easy to make also - add a can of pineapple pieces in pineapple juice and leave out the herbs. A little vinegar is added too. This is great with beans and vegan sausages chopped up.

Quick, no-cook, stir in Sauce for Pasta

Ingredients:

6 fresh tomatoes and half a cup of water OR 1 tin of tomatoes

a good handful of basil (both stalks and leaves)

a handful of parsley

2 sticks of celery, cut into chunks half a teaspoon of seasalt

dash of soy sauce (optional)

2 teaspoons cold pressed olive oil (leave this out if you want a fat free sauce)

Whizz it all up in a liquidiser or blender until fairly smooth and stir into your favourite pasta - very nice with wholewheat shells and a big salad.

Rich and Chunky Mushroom Gravy

Ingredients:

2 tablespoons sunflower oil

1 onion, finely chopped

8-10 large portabello or other flat mushrooms, cut into 3 cm cubes (roughly)

2 cups of water

seasalt to taste

1 cup of vegan gravy mix (original Bisto in the UK is vegan - use 3 teaspoons powder for 1 cup of water)

Fry the onion in the sunflower oil for a few minutes and then add the cubed mushrooms. Cook until the mushrooms soften (five minutes approx) then add the water and gravy mix - stir until thickened. This is great served on spaghetti, over rice or baked potatoes.

Hot Chocolate Sauce for Ice Cream

Perfect placed in a bowl with a scoop of vanilla ice cream (Swedish Glace or Toffuti are great)

Ingredients:

1 cup (approx) of soya milk about 50g of plain chocolate

2 teaspoons of corn flour a teaspoon of sugar

Slowly warm the soya milk in a pan. Add the chocolate and keep mixing until melted together.

Remove from heat. In a cup or small bowl blend the cornflour with a little soya milk and the sugar.

Slowly pour this into the chocolate mixture, stirring all the time until thick.

Cooling Cucumber, Mint and Yoghurt salad

A lovely accompaniment to spicy hot dishes such as curry and chilli.

Ingredients:

1 whole cucumber

a handful of fresh mint or three teaspoons of dried

1 cup of live, plain soya yoghurt such as Yofu or Sojusun

Cut the cucumber into 2cm/1 inch size cubes and mix in the mint and yoghurt. If using dried mint it is a good idea to mix it into the yoghurt at least half an hour beforehand to reconstitute it.

Salad Lucoise

A vegan version of an old favourite, replacing tuna with braised tofu and eggs with olives.

Ingredients:

1 tin of braised tofu (Marigold is good)

2 cups of cooked and cooled runner beans or long green beans

5 or 6 tomatoes

2 or 3 cups of boiled and cooled new potatoes a good handful of black olives, pitted

2 tablespoons of walnut oil

2 tablespoons of balsamic vinegar

Cut everything into fairly large chunks or sections, place in a bowl and mix. Mix the oil and vinegar together and drizzle over...mmm...

Wholegrain Rice Salad

Ingredients:

3 cups of cooked wholegrain (brown) rice

2 sticks of celery, diced

1 apple, chopped small

half a cup of cashew nuts

7 or 8 mushrooms, sliced

a handful of parsley, chopped

2 tablespoons cold pressed linseed/flax oil

2 tablespoons cider vinegar dash of soy sauce

Place all the ingredients in a large bowl and mix until well combined!

Crunchy Green Salad

Ingredients:

Half an iceberg lettuce, chopped

2 good handfuls of fresh small spinach leaves

3 or 4 spring onions, finely chopped

a quarter cucumber, diced

1 green pepper cut into small strips

2 tablespoons of olive oil

2 tablespoons cider vinegar

half a teaspoon of garlic salt

Combine all the fresh ingredients in a large bowl. In a cup or small bowl mix the oil, vinegar and garlic salt together until well blended, then stir into your salad.

New Potato Salad

Ingredients:

4 cups of cooked and cooled new potatoes (cut into chunks if large)

half a cup of vegan mayo

bunch of chives, chopped small

Combine all ingredients in a large bowl until the potatoes are well covered with the mayo and chives.

Creamy Sweetcorn Salad

Ingredients:

1 tin of sweetcorn

1 red pepper, diced

2 spring onions, finely chopped

1 avocado, chopped small

2 tablespoons vegan mayo

1 teaspoon wholegrain mustard

This makes a good filling for vol-au-vents (little puff pastry cases) and a great topping for baked potatoes. Mix the mayo and mustard together and then combine with the other ingredients.

Mega Salad!

Ingredients are entirely adjustable - any or all of the following in whatever quantity you like!

Chopped lettuce

Sliced mushrooms

Halved olives (no pits!)

Chopped tomatoes

Chopped cucumber

Chopped apple

Grated carrot

Grated red or white cabbage

Rocket leaves

Walnuts

Beetroot cut into chunks

Avocados chopped Sunflower or pumpkin seeds Cress

Sprouted grains

Mix it all together with dressing of your choice - hemp seed oil and lemon juice goes well.

Pear and Pecan Salad with Blue Cheese

Toasted pecan nuts have a special union with crisp white pears. Their robust flavours combine especially well with a rich blue cheese dressing and make this a salad to remember.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

75 g/3 oz/1/2cup shelled pecan nuts, roughly chopped

3 crisp pears

175 g/6 oz young spinach, stems removed

1 escarole or butterhead lettuce

1 radicchio

30 ml/2 tbsp ready-made blue cheese dressing salt and freshly ground black pepper

crusty bread, to serve

1-Toast the pecan nuts under a moderate grill, to bring out their flavour.

2-Cut the pears into even slices, leaving the skin intact and discarding the cores.

3-Wash the salad leaves and spin dry. Add the pears together with the toasted pecans, then toss with the dressing. Distribute between 4 large plates and season with salt and pepper. Serve with warm crusty bread.

VARIATION

If you want a lighter non-cheese dressing, combine:

5 ml/ 1 tsp of wholegrain mustard,

2.5 ml/ ½ tsp of granulated sugar,

1.5 ml/ ¼ tsp of dried tarragon,

10 ml/ 2 tsp of lemon juice and

60 ml/4 tbsp of olive oil in a jar and shake vigorously.

Orange and Walnut Salad

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

3 plump heads chicory

2 large sweet oranges, peel and pith removed, segmented

3oz/75g walnuts, chopped

MUSTARD DRESSING

2 tbsp/30ml walnut oil pinch mustard powder

1 tbsp/15ml orange juice

1 tbsp/15ml lemon juice

METHOD

1-Mix the chicory slices, oranges and half the walnuts together and place in a serving dish.

2-Sprinkle over the remaining walnuts. Whisk the walnut oil and mustard powder together, then gradually whisk in the orange and lemon juices.

3-Pour the dressing over the salad and serve immediately.

MIXED GREEN AND MUSHROOM WITH RASBERRY VINAIGRETTE

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

4 tbsp/ 60 g pine nuts

2 heads cabbage lettuce or other soft lettuce

2 heads chicory

1 small head radicchio

8 oz/ 225g stemmed small mushroom

RASPBERRY VINAIGRETTE

4 tbsp/60ml olive oil

2 tbsp/30ml raspberry vinegar

1 finely chopped shallot

1 tsp/5ml Dijon-style mustard

2 tsp/10 ml single cream

salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste

1-Pre-heat the oven to 350°F/180°C/Gas 4. Place the pine nuts in a shallow baking dish and roast them in the oven until lightly browned, about 5 minutes. Remove from oven and set aside.

2-Wash and gently dry the cabbage lettuce, chicory and radicchio. Tear the lettuce and radicchio into bite-sized pieces. Cut the chicory into thin slices. Put the greens into a large salad bowl. Add the mushrooms and toasted pine nuts.

3-In a mixing bowl combine the olive oil, vinegar, shallot, mustard, cream, salt and pepper. Whisk until the vinaigrette is smooth and well blended.

4-Pour the vinaigrette over the greens and toss well. Serve at once.

Curly Endive and Alfalfa Salad

INGREDIENTS Serves 4-6

½ small curly endive, torn into pieces

40oz/100g alfalfa sprouts

2oz/50g small button mushrooms, thinly sliced

½ red pepper, sliced

DRESSING

juice 1 lemon

2tsp/10ml olive oil

1 small onion, grated

¼ tsp/1.5g Chinese five spice powder

1-Arrange the curly endive on a large serving plate or 4 individual plates.

2-Mix the alfalfa, mushrooms and pepper together in a bowl.

3-Mix the dressing ingredients together and add to the bowl of vegetables. Toss well and arrange on top of the lettuce.

CALIFORNIA WALDORF SALAD

Ingredients:

Serves 6

3 ½ oz/ 90 g mung bean sprout or alfalfa sprout

3 tart apples, cored and diced but not peeled

1 lb/ 450g celery, chopped

½ cup/ 50g /2 oz slivered almonds

3 large mushrooms, coarsely chopped

8 fl oz/250 ml Yoghurt Mayonnaise

10 lettuce leaves

3 ½ oz/ 90 g seedless grapes, halved

1-Blanch the bean sprouts in a pan of boiling water for 45 seconds. Drain and rinse in cold water. Drain well again. Coarsely chop the bean sprouts.

2-Put the apple, celery, almonds and mushrooms in a large mixing bowl. Mix well with a wooden spoon.

3-Add the Yoghurt Mayonnaise and mix thoroughly.

4-Line a serving platter with the lettuce leaves. Mound the bean sprouts in the centre. Transfer the mixed ingredients to the platter and garnish with the halved grapes.

Classic Waldorf Salads

INGREDIENTS

Serves 2 - 4

8 stalks crisp celery

2 rosy-skinned dessert apples lemon juice

½ cup/50g/2oz walnuts

6 tbsp/90ml good mayonnaise

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-If the celery is not crisp, immerse it in ice-cold water. It will soon freshen up. Pat dry and slice.

2-Core the apples but do not peel - the pink skin will give colour contrast to the salad. Slice and sprinkle with lemon juice to prevent discolouring.

3-Toss all the ingredients in the mayonnaise and season well.

VARIATION

This salad also tastes good with blue cheese dressing. Blend the mayonnaise with 1 tbsp blue cheese before adding to the salad.

Lentil and Feta Cheese Salad

INGREDIENTS

Serves 6

2 cups/350g/12oz brown lentils

1 bay leaf

½ tsp/2.5ml dried basil

SALADS

2 garlic cloves, crushed stalk celery, finely chopped

1 small onion, chopped

3 tbsp/45ml fresh chives, chopped

1 ½ cups/175g/6oz crumbled feta cheese

6 tbsp/90ml/3fl oz virgin olive oil

3 tbsp/45ml wine vinegar

1/8 tsp/large pinch dried oregano

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Put the lentils in a bowl. Add 3 cups/750ml/ 1 ¼ pts cold water and soak the lentils for 2 hours. Drain.

2-Put the lentils in a saucepan and add enough cold water to cover them completely. Add the bay leaf, basil and 1 garlic clove. Bring to the boil and simmer, covered, for 20 minutes.

3-Add the celery and onion. Add enough additional water to cover the lentils. Cover the saucepan and simmer for 10 more minutes.

4-Drain the lentils, celery and onion and discard the bay leaf and garlic clove. Put the lentils, celery and onion in a serving bowl. Add the chives and feta cheese. Toss.

5-Put the olive oil, vinegar, oregano, remaining garlic clove, salt and pepper in a jar with a tightly fitting lid. Cover tightly and shake until well blended.

6-Pour the dressing over the lentil salad and toss. Let the salad stand for 2 hours, tossing occasionally, before serving.

Haricot Bean Salad

SALADS

INGREDIENTS Serves 4

1 cup/175g/6oz dried haricot beans, soaked overnight

2 cloves garlic, crushed

2 tbsp/30ml wine vinegar

2 tbsp/30ml olive oil

1 tsp/5ml French mustard

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 red pepper, seeded and thinly sliced

1 leek, thinly sliced

2 spring onions, green and white parts chopped separately

METHOD

1-Place the beans in a large saucepan and coker with fresh water. Bring to the boil and boil fast for 10 minutes, then cover and simmer for 40-50 minutes or until tender. Drain.

2-Combine the garlic, vinegar, olive oil, mustard and seasoning in a screw top jar, seal and shake well.

3-Pour over the hot beans and leave to cool. Stir in the pepper, leek and white parts of the spring onions and place in a serving dish.

4-Sprinkle with green chopped onions and serve.

Puffy Creamed Potatoes

This accompaniment consists of creamed potatoes incorporated into mini Yorkshire puddings. Serve them with a vegetable casserole or, for a meal on its own, serve two or three per person and accompany with salads.

Ingredients:

Makes 6

275 g / 10 oz potatoes

creamy milk and butter for mashing

5 ml/1 tsp chopped fresh parsley

5 ml/1 tsp chopped fresh tarragon

75 g/3 oz/1/3 cup plain flour

1 egg

about 120 ml/4 fl oz/V2 cup milk

oil or sunflower margarine, for baking

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Boil the potatoes until tender and mash with a little milk and butter. Stir in the chopped parsley and tarragon and season with salt and pepper. Preheat the oven to 200oC /400oF/ Gas 6.

2-Process the flour, egg, milk and a pinch of salt in a food processor or blender to make a smooth batter.

3-Place about 2.5 ml/i/2 tsp oil or a small knob of sunflower margarine in each of six ramekin dishes and place in the oven on a baking tray for 2-3 minutes, until the oil or fat is very hot.

4-Working quickly, pour a small 4amount of batter (about 20 ml/ 4 tsp) into each ramekin dish. Add a heaped tablespoon of mashed potatoes and then pour an equal amount of the remaining batter in each dish. Place in the oven and bake for 15-20 minutes, until the puddings are puffy and golden brown.

5-Using a palette knife, carefully 5ease the puddings out of the mekin dishes and arrange on a large warm serving dish. Serve at once.

Potatoes Dauphinois

Rich, creamy and satisfying, this is a really comforting dish to serve when it's cold outside.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

675 g/1 1/2 lb potatoes, peeled and thinly sliced

1 garlic clove

25 g/1 oz/2 tbsp butter

300 ml / 1/2 pint / 1 1/4 cups single cream

50 ml / 2 fl oz/ 1/4 cup milk

salt and white pepper

1-Preheat the oven to 150°C/300°F/Gas 2. Place the potato slices in a bowl of cold water to remove the excess starch. Drain and pat dry with kitchen paper.

2-Cut the garlic in half and rub the cut side around the inside of a wide shallow ovenproof dish. Butter the dish generously. Blend the cream and milk in a jug.

3-Cover the base of the dish with a layer of potatoes. Dot a little butter over the potato layer, season with salt and pepper and then pour over a little of the cream and milk mixture.

4-Continue making layers, until all the ingredients have been

used up, ending with a layer of cream. Bake in the oven for about 1 1/4 hours. If the dish browns

too quickly, cover with a lid or with a piece of foil. The potatoes are ready when they are very soft and the top is golden brown.

Spicy Potatoes and Cauliflower

This dish is simplicity itself to make and can be eaten as a main meal with Indian breads or rice, a raita such as cucumber and yogurt, and a fresh mint relish.

Ingredients:

Serves 2

225 g/8 oz potatoes

75 ml/5 tbsp peanut oil

5 ml/ 1 tsp ground cumin

5 ml/ 1 tsp ground coriander

1.5 ml/ 1/4 tsp ground turmeric

1.5 ml/ 1/4 tsp cayenne pepper

1 fresh green chilli, seeded and finely chopped

1 medium cauliflower, broken up into small florets

5 ml/ 1 tsp cumin seeds

2 garlic cloves, cut into shreds

15-30 ml/1-2 tbsp fresh coriander, finely chopped

Salt

1-Cook the potatoes in their skins in boiling salted water for about 20 minutes, until just tender. Drain and let cool. When cool enough to handle, peel and cut into 2.5 cm/1 in cubes.

2-Heat 45 ml/3 tbsp of the oil in a frying pan or wok. When hot, add the ground cumin, coriander, turmeric, cayenne pepper and chilli. Let the spices sizzle for a few seconds.

3-Add the cauliflower and about 60 ml/4 tbsp water. Cook over medium heat, stirring continuously, for 6-8 minutes. Add the potatoes and stir-fry for 2-3 minutes. Season with salt, then remove from the heat.

4-Heat the remaining oil in a small frying pan. When hot, add the cumin seeds and garlic and cook until lightly browned. Pour the mixture over the vegetables. Sprinkle with the chopped coriander and serve at once.

Garlic Mashed Potatoes

These creamy mashed potatoes have a wonderful aroma. Although two bulbs seems like a lot of garlic, the flavour is sweet and subtle when cooked in this way.

Ingredients:

Serves 6-8

2 garlic bulbs, separated into cloves, unpeeled

115 g/4 oz / 1/2 cup unsalted butter

1.3 kg/3 lb baking potatoes

120-175 ml/4-6 fl oz / 1/2 - 3/4 cup milk salt and white pepper

1-Bring a small saucepan of water to the boil over high heat. Add the garlic cloves and boil for 2 minutes, then drain and peel.

2-In a heavy frying pan, melt half of the butter over a low heat. Add the blanched garlic cloves, then cover and cook gently for 20-25 minutes, until very tender and just golden, shaking the pan and stirring occasionally. Do not allow the garlic to scorch or brown.

3-Remove the pan from the heat and cool slightly. Spoon the garlic and any butter from the pan into a blender or food processor fitted with a metal blade and process until smooth. Tip into a small bowl, press clear film on to the surface to prevent a skin forming and set aside.

4-Peel and quarter the Potatoes, place in a large saucepan and add enough cold water to just cover them. Salt the water generously and bring to the boil over a high heat.

5-Cook the potatoes until tender, then drain and work through a food mill or press through a sieve back into the saucepan. Return the pan to a medium heat and, using a wooden spoon, stir the potatoes for 1-2 minutes to dry them out completely. Remove from the heat.

6-Warm the milk over a medium-high heat until bubbles form around the edge. Gradually beat the milk, remaining butter and reserved garlic puree into the potatoes, then season with salt, if needed, and white pepper.

Roasted Potatoes, Peppers and Shallots

This popular dish from North America's Deep South is often served in elegant New Orleans restaurants fall into their natural segments.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

500 g/ 1 ¼ lb waxy potatoes

2 sweet yellow peppers

12 shallots

Olive oil

2 sprigs of fresh rosemary

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Preheat the oven to 200°C/400°F/Gas 6. Wash the potatoes and blanch for 5 minutes in boiling water. Drain.

3-Peel the shallots and break them apart, allowing them to

2-When the potatoes are cool enough to handle, skin them and halve lengthways. Cut each sweet yellow pepper lengthways into 8 strips, discarding the seeds and pith.

4-Oil a shallow ovenproof dish thoroughly with olive oil.

5-Arrange the potatoes and 5 peppers in alternating rows and stud with the shallots.

6-Cut the rosemary sprigs into 5 cm/2 in lengths and tuck among the vegetables. Season the dish generously with olive oil, salt and pepper and bake in the oven, uncovered, for 30-40 minutes, until all the vegetables are tender.

Baked Sweet Potatoes

Give sweet potatoes a Cajun flavour with salt, three different kinds of pepper and lavish quantities of butter. Serve half a potato per person as an accompaniment, or a whole one as a supper dish with a green salad peppered with watercress.

Ingredients:

Serves 3-6

3 pink-skinned sweet potatoes, about 450 g/lb each

75 g/3 oz/6 tbsp butter, sliced black, white and cayenne peppers salt

1-Wash the potatoes and leave the skins wet. Rub salt into the skins, prick them all over with a fork and place on the middle shelf of the oven. Turn on the oven to 200°C/400°F/ Gas 6 and bake for about an hour, until the flesh yields and feels soft when pressed.

2-The potatoes can either be served in halves or whole. For halves, split each one lengthways and make close crisscross cuts in the flesh of each half. Then spread with slices of butter, and work the butter and seasonings roughly into the cuts with a knife point.

3-Alternatively, make an incision along the length of each potato if they are to be served whole. Open them slightly and put in butter slices along the length, seasoning with the peppers and a pinch of salt.

COOK'S TIP

Sweet potatoes cook more quickly than ordinary ones, and there is no need to preheat the oven.

Seeds and Spices

A change from plain boiled rice, and a colourful accompaniment to serve with spicy curries. Basmati rice gives the best texture and flavour, but you can use ordinary long grain rice instead, if you prefer.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

5 ml/ 1 tsp sunflower oil

2.5 ml/ 1/2tsp ground turmeric

6 cardamom pods, lightly crushed

5 ml/ 1 tsp coriander seeds, lightly crushed

1 garlic clove, crushed

200 g/7 oz/1 cup basmati rice

400 ml/14 fl oz/1 2/3 cups vegetable stock

115 g/4 oz/ ½ cup natural yogurt

15 ml/ 1 tbsp toasted sunflower seeds

15 ml/ 1 tbsp toasted sesame seeds Salt and freshly ground black pepper Coriander leaves, to garnish

1-Heat the oil in a non-stick frying pan and fry the spices and garlic for about 1 minute, stirring all the time.

2-Add the rice and stock, bring to the boil, then cover and simmer for 15 minutes, or until just tender.

3-Stir in the yogurt and the toasted sunflower and sesame seeds. Season with salt and pepper and serve hot, garnished with coriander leaves.

COOK'S TIP

Seeds are particularly rich in minerals, so they are a good addition to all kinds of dishes. Light toasting will improve their flavour.

Red Fried Rice

This vibrant rice dish owes its appeal as much to the bright colours of red onion, red pepper and tomatoes as it does to their flavours.

Ingredients:

Serves 2

145 g/4 1/2 oz/ 3/4cup basmati rice

30 ml/2 tbsp peanut oil

1 small red onion, chopped

1 red pepper, seeded and chopped

225 g/8 oz cherry tomatoes, halved

2 eggs, beaten

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Wash the rice several times under cold running water. Drain well. Bring a large pan of water to the boil. Add the rice and cook for 10-12 minutes.

2-Meanwhile, heat the oil in a wok until very hot. Add the onion and red pepper and stir-fry for 2-3 minutes. Add the cherry tomatoes and continue stir-frying for 2 minutes more.

3-Pour in the beaten eggs all at once. Cook for 30 seconds without stirring, then stir to break up the egg as it sets.

4-Drain the cooked rice thoroughly. Add to the wok and toss it over the heat with the vegetables and egg mixture for 3 minutes. Season with salt and pepper and serve immediately.

Chinese Brussels Sprouts

If you are bored with plain boiled Brussels sprouts, try peppering them up Chinese-style with this unusual stir-fried method.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

450 g/lb Brussels sprouts

5 ml/ 1 tsp sesame or sunflower oil

2 spring onions, sliced

2.5 ml/ ½ tsp Chinese five-spice powder

15 ml/ 1 tbsp light soy sauce

1-Trim the Brussels sprouts, then shred them finely using a large sharp knife or a food processor.

2-Heat the oil and add the sprouts and spring onions. Stir-fry for about 2 minutes, without allowing the mixture to brown.

3-Stir in the five-spice powder and soy sauce, then cook, stirring, for a further 2-3 minutes, until just tender. Serve hot with other Chinese dishes.

Festive Brussels Sprouts

This recipe originated in France, where it is a popular side dish at Christmas time.

Ingredients:

Serves 4-6

225 g/8 oz chestnuts

120 ml/4 fl oz/ 1/2 cup milk

500 g/ 1 1/4 lb/4 cups small tender Brussels sprouts

25 g/1 oz/2 tbsp butter

1 shallot, finely chopped

30-45 ml/2-3 tbsp dry white wine or water

1-Using a small knife, score a cross in the base of each chestnut. Bring a saucepan of water to the boil over medium- high heat, then drop in the chestnuts and boil for 6-8 minutes. Remove pan from the heat.

2-Using a slotted spoon, remove a few chestnuts from the pan, leaving the others immersed in the water until ready to peel. Before the chestnuts cool, remove the outer shell with a knife and then peel off the inner skin.

3-Rinse the pan, return the peeled chestnuts to it and add the milk. Top up with enough water to completely cover the chestnuts. Simmer over medium heat for 12-15 minutes until the chestnuts are just tender. Drain and set aside.

4-Remove any wilted or yellow leaves from the Brussels sprouts. Trim the root ends but leave intact or the leaves will separate. Using a small knife, score a cross in the base of each sprout so they cook evenly.

5-In a large, heavy frying pan, melt the butter over medium heat. Stir in the chopped shallot and cook for 1-2 minutes until just softened, then add the Brussels sprouts and wine or water. Cook, covered, over medium heat for 6-8 minutes, shaking the pan and stirring occasionally, adding a little more water if necessary.

6-Add the poached chestnuts and toss gently to combine, then cover and cook for 3-5 minutes more, until the chestnuts and Brussels sprouts are tender.

Szechuan Aubergine

This medium-hot dish is also known as fish-fragrant aubergine in China, because the aubergine is cooked with flavourings that are often used with fish.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

2 small aubergines

5 ml/ 1 tsp salt

3 dried red chillies peanut oil, for deep frying

3-4 garlic cloves, finely chopped

1 cm// ½ in piece of fresh root ginger, finely chopped

4 spring onions, cut into 2.5 cm/1 in lengths (white and green parts separated)

15 ml/ 1 tbsp Chinese rice wine or medium-dry sherry

15 ml/ 1 tbsp light soy sauce

5 ml/1 tsp sugar

1.5 ml/ ¼ tsp ground roasted Szechuan peppercorns

15 ml/1 tbsp Chinese rice vinegar

5 ml/1 tsp sesame oil

1-Trim the aubergines and cut into strips about 4 cm/ 1 ½ in wide and 7.5 cm/3 in long. Place the aubergine strips in a colander and sprinkle over the salt. Set aside for 30 minutes, then rinse thoroughly under cold running water. Pat dry with kitchen paper,

2-Meanwhile, soak the chillies in warm water for 15 minutes. Drain, then cut each chilli into four pieces, discarding the seeds

3-Half-fill a wok with oil and heat to 180°C/350°F. Deep-fry the aubergine until golden brown. Drain on kitchen paper. Pour off most of the oil from the wok. Reheat the oil and add the garlic, ginger and white spring onion.

4-Stir-fry for 30 seconds. Add the aubergine and toss, then add the rice wine or sherry, soy sauce, sugar, ground peppercorns and rice vinegar. Stir-fry for 1-2 minutes. Sprinkle over the sesame oil and green spring onion and serve immediately.

Chinese Greens with Soy Sauce

In this recipe, Chinese greens are prepared in a very simple way - stir-fried and served with soy sauce. The combination makes a very simple, quickly prepared, tasty accompaniment.

Ingredients:

Serves 3-4

450 g/lb Chinese greens

30 ml/2 tbsp peanut oil

15-30 ml/1-2 tbsp plum sauce

1-Trim the Chinese greens, removing any discoloured leaves and damaged stems. Tear into manageable pieces.

2-Heat a wok until hot, add the oil and swirl it around.

3-Add the Chinese greens and stir-fry for 2-3 minutes, until the greens have wilted a little.

4-Add the plum sauce and continue to stir-fry for a few seconds more, until the greens are cooked but still slightly crisp. Serve immediately.

VARIATION:

You can replace the Chinese greens with Chinese flowering cabbage or Chinese broccoli, which is also known by its Cantonese name, Choi sam. It has green leaves and tiny yellow flowers, which are also eaten along with the leaves and stalks. It is available at Asian markets.

Sweet and Sour Onions

Cooked in this way, sweet baby onions make an unusual yet tasty side dish. This recipe originated in the Provence region of France.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

450 g / 1 lb baby onions, peeled

50 ml/2 fl oz/ ¼ cup wine vinegar

45 ml/3 tbsp olive oil

40 g/ 1 ½ oz /3 tbsp caster sugar

45 ml/3 tbsp tomato pur@e

1 bay leaf

2 sprigs of fresh parsley

65 g/2 1/2 oz/ 1/2 cup raisins

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Put all the ingredients in a saucepan with 300 ml/ 1/2pint/l ¼ cups water. Bring to the boil and simmer gently, uncovered, for 45 minutes or until the onions are tender and most of the liquid has evaporated.

2-Remove the bay leaf and parsley, check the seasoning and transfer to a serving dish. Serve at room temperature.

Spinach with Raisins and Pine Nuts

Raisins and Pine Nuts Raisins and pine nuts are perfect partners. Here, tossed with wilted spinach and croutons their contrasting textures make a delicious main meal accompaniment.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

50 g/2 ozl'/3cup raisins

1 thick slice crusty white bread

45 ml/3 tbsp olive oil

25 g/1 oz//3cup pine nuts

500 g/ 1 ¼ lb young spinach, stalks removed

2 garlic cloves, crushed

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Put the raisins in a small bowl with boiling water and leave to soak for 10 minutes. Drain.

2-Cut the bread into cubes and discard the crusts. Heat 30 ml/2 tbsp of the oil and fry the bread until golden. Drain

3-Heat the remaining oil in the pan. Fry the pine nuts until they are beginning to colour. Add the spinach and garlic and cook quickly, turning the spinach until it has just wilted.

4-Toss in the raisins and season with salt and pepper. Transfer to a warmed serving dish. Scatter with croutons and serve hot.

VARIATION

Use Swiss chard or spinach beet instead of the spinach, and cook little longer.

Hot Parsnip Fritters on Baby Spinach

Deep-frying brings out the luscious sweetness of parsnips, and their flavour is perfectly complemented by walnut-dressed baby spinach leaves.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

2 large parsnips

115 g/4 oz/1 cup plain flour

1 egg, separated

120 ml/4 fl oz/1/2 cup milk

115 g/4 oz baby spinach leaves, washed and dried

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

15 ml/ 1 tbsp walnut oil

15 ml/ 1 tbsp sherry vinegar

15 ml/ 1 tbsp coarsely chopped walnuts

Salt, freshly ground black pepper and cayenne pepper

1-Peel the parsnips, bring to the boil in a pan of salted water and simmer for 10-15 minutes, until tender but not in the least mushy. Drain, cool and cut diagonally into slices about 5 cm/2 in oil for deep frying long x 5 mm-1 cm//4-V2 in thick.

2-Put the flour in a bowl and make a well in the centre. Put the egg yolk in the well and mix in with a fork. Add the milk, while continuing to mix in the flour. Season with salt and black and cayenne peppers, and beat with a whisk until the batter is smooth.

3-Put the spinach leaves in a bowl. Mix the oils and vinegar. Season with salt and pepper.

4-When you are ready to serve, whisk the egg white to soft peaks, fold in a little of the yolk batter, then fold the white into the batter. Heat the oil for frying.

5-Shake the dressing vigorously, then toss the salad in the dressing. Arrange the leaves on 4 plates and scatter with walnuts.

6-Dip the parsnip slices in batter and fry until puffy and golden. Drain on kitchen paper and keep warm. Arrange the fritters on top of the salad leaves.

Parsnip and Chestnut Croquettes

The distinctive sweet nutty taste of chestnuts blends perfectly with the similarly sweet but earthy flavour of parsnips. Fresh chestnuts need to be peeled but frozen chestnuts are easy to use and are nearly as good as fresh for this recipe.

Ingredients:

Makes 10-12

450 g / 1 lb parsnips, cut roughly into small pieces

115 g/4 oz frozen chestnuts

25 g / 1 oz/2 tbsp butter

1 garlic clove, crushed

15 ml/1 tbsp chopped fresh coriander

1 egg, beaten

40-50 g/ 1 1/2-2 oz fresh white breadcrumbs

Vegetable oil, for frying

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Sprig of fresh coriander, to garnish

1-Place the parsnips in a saucepan with enough water to cover. Bring to the boil, cover and simmer for 15-20 minutes.

2-Place the frozen chestnuts in a pan of water, bring to the boil and simmer for 8-10 minutes. Drain, place in a bowl and mash roughly into a pulp.

3-Melt the butter in a saucepan and cook the garlic for 30 seconds. Drain the parsnips and mash with the garlic butter. Stir in the chestnuts and coriander. Season with salt and pepper.

4-Take about 15 ml/ 1 tbsp of the mixture at a time and form into small croquettes, about 7.5 cm/3 in long. Dip each croquette into the beaten egg and then roll in the breadcrumbs.

5-Heat a little oil in a frying pan and fry each of the croquettes for 3-4 minutes until crisp and golden, turning frequently so they brown evenly.

6-Drain the croquettes on sheets of kitchen paper, wiping away any excess oil, and serve at once, garnished with sprigs of fresh coriander.

Fried Noodles, Beansprouts and Asparagus

Soft fried noodles contrast beautifully with crisp beansprouts and asparagus in this super- quick recipe.

Ingredients:

Serves 2

115 g/4 oz dried egg noodles

60 ml/4 tbsp vegetable oil

1 small onion, chopped

2.5 cm/ 1 in piece of fresh root ginger, peeled and grated

2 garlic cloves, crushed

175 g/6 oz young asparagus spears, trimmed

115 g/4 oz beansprouts

4 spring onions, sliced

45 ml/3 tbsp soy sauce

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Bring a pan of salted water to the boil. Add the noodles and cook for 2-3 minutes, until just tender. Drain and toss in 30 ml/2 tbsp of the oil.

2-Heat the remaining oil in a wok or frying pan until very hot. Add the onion, ginger and garlic and stir-fry for 2-3 minutes. Add the asparagus and stir-fry for 2-3 minutes more.

3-Add the egg noodles and beansprouts and stir-fry for 2 minutes.

4-Stir in the spring onions and soy sauce. Season with salt and pepper, adding salt sparingly as the soy sauce will probably supply enough salt in itself Stir-fry for 1 minute then serve at once.

Deep-fried Root Vegetables with Spiced Salt

All kinds of root vegetables may be finely sliced and deep-fried to make 'chips'. Serve as an accompaniment to an oriental-style meal or simply by themselves as a nibble.

Ingredients:

Serves 4-6

1 carrot

2 parsnips

2 raw beetroot

1 sweet potato

Peanut oil, for deep frying

1.5 ml/ ¼ tsp cayenne pepper

1 tsp sea salt flakes

1-Peel all the vegetables, then slice the carrot and parsnips into long, thin ribbons, and the beetroot and sweet potato into thin rounds. Pat dry all the vegetables on kitchen paper.

2-Half-fill a wok with oil and heat to 180°C/350°F. Add the vegetable slices in batches and deep-fry for 2-3 minutes, until golden and crisp. Remove and drain on kitchen paper.

3-Place the cayenne pepper and sea salt in a mortar and grind together to a coarse powder.

4-Pile up the vegetable 'chips' on a serving plate and sprinkle over the spiced salt.

COOK'S TIP

To save time, you can slice the vegetables using a mandoline or a blender or food processor with a thin slicing disc attached.

Frijoles

A traditional Mexican bean dish that tastes great with tortillas and vegetable chilli.

Ingredients:

Serves 6-8

350 g/12 oz/ 1 ¼- 1 ½ cups dried red kidney, pinto or black haricot beans, picked over and rinsed

2 onions, finely chopped

2 garlic cloves, chopped

1 bay leaf or more small fresh green chillies

30 ml/2 tbsp corn oil

2 tomatoes, peeled, seeded and chopped

Salt

Sprigs of fresh bay leaves, to garnish

1-Put the beans into a pan and add cold water to cover by 2.5 cm/ 1 in.

2-Add half the onion, half the garlic, the bay leaf and the chilli or chillies. Bring to the boil and boil vigorously for about 10 minutes. Put the beans and liquid into an earthenware pot or large saucepan, cover and cook over low heat for 30 minutes. Add boiling water if the mixture starts to become dry.

3-When the beans begin to wrinkle, add 15 ml/ 1 tbsp of the corn oil and cook for a further 30 minutes, or until the beans are tender. Add salt to taste and cook for 30 minutes more, but try to avoid adding any more water.

4-Remove the beans from the heat. Heat the remaining oil in a small frying pan and saute the remaining onion and garlic together until the onion is soft. Add the tomatoes and cook for a few minutes more.

5-Spoon 45 ml/3 tbsp of the beans out of the pot or pan to and add them to the tomato mixture. Mash to a paste. Stir into the beans to thicken the liquid. Cook for just long enough to heat through, if necessary. Serve the beans in small bowls and garnish with fresh bay leaves.

Peas with Baby Onions and Cream

Ideally, use fresh peas and fresh baby onions, Frozen peas are an acceptable substitute if fresh ones aren't available, but frozen onions tend to be insipid and are not worth using. Alternatively, use the white parts of spring onions.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

175 g/ 6 oz baby onions

15 g/ ½ oz/1 tbsp butter

900 g/ 2 lb fresh peas (about 350 g/12 oz shelled or frozen)

150 ml / ¼ pint/ 2/3 cup double cream

15 g/ 1/2 oz /2 tbsp plain flour

10 ml/2 tsp chopped fresh parsley

15-30 ml/1-2 tbsp lemon juice (optional) Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Peel the onions and halve them if necessary. Melt the butter in a flameproof casserole and fry the onions for 5-6 minutes over a moderate heat, until they begin to be flecked with brown.

2-Add the peas and stir-fry for a few minutes. Add 120 ml / 4 fl oz/ ½ cup water and bring to the boil. Partially cover and simmer for about 10 minutes, until the peas and onions are tender. There should be a thin layer of water on the base of the pan - add a little more water if necessary or, if there is too much liquid, remove the lid and increase the heat until the liquid is reduced.

3-Using a small whisk, blend the cream with the flour. Remove the pan from the heat and stir in the combined cream and flour and chopped parsley. Season with salt and pepper.

4-Cook over a gentle heat for 3-4 minutes, until the sauce is thick. Taste and adjust the seasoning; add a little lemon juice to sharpen, if desired.

Red Cabbage in Port and Red Wine

A sweet and sour, spicy red cabbage dish, with the added crunch of pears and walnuts.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

15 ml/1 tbsp walnut oil

1 onion, sliced

2 whole star anise

5 ml/1 tsp ground cinnamon

Pinch of ground cloves

450 g / 1 lb red cabbage, finely shredded

25 g / 1 oz/2 tbsp dark brown sugar

45 ml/3 tbsp red wine vinegar

300 ml / 1/2 pint/1 ¼ cups red wine

150 ml/1/4 pint/2/3 cup port

2 pears, cut into 1 cm/1/2 in cubes

115 g/4 oz//2cup raisins

115 g/4 oz//2 cup walnut halves

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Heat the oil in a large pan. Add the onion and cook gently for about 5 minutes, until softened.

2-Add the star anise, cinnamon, cloves and cabbage and cook for about 3 minutes more.

3-Stir in the sugar, vinegar, red wine and port. Cover the pan and simmer gently for 10 minutes, stirring occasionally.

4-Stir in the cubed pears and 4raisins and cook for a further 10 minutes, or until the cabbage is tender. Season with salt and pepper. Mix in the walnut halves and serve.

COOK'S TIP

You can braise this dish in a low oven for up to 1 1/2 hours.

Beetroot and Celeriac Gratin

Beautiful ruby-red slices of beetroot and celeriac make a stunning light accompaniment to any main course dish.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

350 g/12 oz raw beetroot

350 g/12 oz raw celeriac

4 sprigs of fresh thyme, chopped

6 juniper berries, crushed

120 ml/4 fl oz/1/2 cup fresh orange juice

120 ml/4 fl oz/1/2 cup vegetable stock

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Preheat the oven to 190°C/375°F/Gas 5. Peel and slice the beetroot very finely. Quarter and peel the celeriac and slice very finely.

2-Fill a 25 cm/10 in diameter, cast iron, ovenproof or flameproof frying pan with alternate layers of beetroot and celeriac slices, sprinkling with thyme, juniper and salt and pepper between each layer.

3-Mix the orange juice and stock together and pour over the gratin. Place over a medium heat and bring to the boil. Boil for 2 minutes.

4-Cover with foil and place in the oven for 15-20 minutes. Remove the foil and raise the oven temperature to 200°C/400°F/Gas 6. Cook for a further 10 minutes.

Runner Beans with Garlic

Delicate and fresh-tasting flageolet beans and sautéed garlic add a distinctly French flavour to this simple side dish.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

225 g/8 oz/1 1/4 cups flageolet beans

15 ml/1 tbsp olive oil

25 g/ 1oz/2 tbsp butter

1 onion, finely chopped

1-2 garlic cloves, crushed

3-4 tomatoes, peeled and chopped

350 g/12 oz runner beans, prepared and sliced

150 ml/1/4 pint//3 cup white wine

150 ml/1/4 pint//3 cup vegetable stock

30 ml/2 tbsp chopped fresh parsley

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Place the flageolet beans in a 1 large saucepan of water, bring to the boil and simmer for 3/4-1 hour, until tender.

2-Heat the olive oil and butter in a large frying pan and saute the onion and garlic for 3-4 minutes, until soft.

3-Add the chopped tomatoes to the onions in the pan and continue cooking over a gentle heat, until they are soft. Stir the flageolet beans into the onion and tomato mixture, then add the runner beans, wine, stock and a little salt. Stir. Cover and simmer for 5-10 minutes.

5-Increase the heat to reduce the liquid, then stir in the parsley, more salt, if necessary, and pepper.

Green Lima Beans in Chilli Sauce

Try this fabulous dish of lima beans with a tomato and chilli sauce for warming up on winter evenings.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

450 g/lb green lima or broad beans, thawed if frozen

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

1 onion, finely chopped

2 garlic cloves, chopped

350 g/ 12 oz tomatoes, peeled, seeded and chopped

1 or 2 drained canned jalapeno chillies, seeded and chopped

Salt

Chopped fresh coriander, to garnish

1-Cook the beans in a saucepan of boiling water for 15-20 minutes, until tender. Drain and keep hot, to one side, in the covered saucepan.

2-Heat the olive oil in a frying pan and saute the onion and garlic until the onion is soft but not brown. Add the tomatoes and cook until the mixture thickens.

3-Add the jalapenos and cook for 31-2 minutes. Season with salt.

4-Pour the mixture over the reserved beans and check that they are hot. If not, return everything to the frying pan and cook over low heat for just long enough to heat through. Put into a warmed serving dish, garnish with coriander and serve.

Courgettes with Sun-dried Tomatoes

Sun-dried tomatoes have a concentrated, sweet flavour that goes well with courgettes.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

10 sun-dried tomatoes, dry or preserved in oil and drained

175 ml/6 fl oz//4 cup warm water

75 ml/5 tbsp olive oil | large onion, finely sliced

2 garlic cloves, finely chopped

1 kg/2 1/4 lb courgettes, cut into thin strips salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Slice the sun-dried tomatoes into thin strips. Place in a bowl with the warm water. Allow to stand for 20 minutes.

2-In a large frying pan or saucepan, heat the oil and stir in the onion. Cook over low to moderate heat until the onion softens but does not brown.

3-Stir in the garlic and courgette strips. Cook for about 5 minutes, continuing to stir the mixture.

4-Stir in the tomatoes and their soaking liquid. Season with salt and pepper. Raise the heat slightly and cook until the courgettes are just tender. Adjust seasoning and serve hot or cold.

Tomato and Okra Stew

Okra is an unusual and delicious vegetable. It releases a sticky sap when cooked, which helps to thicken the stew.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

15 ml/1 tbsp olive oil

1 onion, chopped

350 g/12 oz jar pimientos, drained

2 x 400 g/14 oz cans chopped tomatoes

275 g/10 oz okra

30 ml/2 tbsp chopped fresh parsley

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Heat the oil in a heavy-based pan. Add the onion and cook for 2-3 minutes.

2-Coarsely chop the pimientos and add to the onion. Add the chopped tomatoes and mix well.

3-Cut the tops off the okra and cut into halves or quarters if large. Add to the tomato sauce in the pan. Season with plenty of salt and pepper.

4-Bring the vegetable stew to the boil. Then lower the heat, cover the pan and simmer for 12 minutes, until the vegetables are tender and the sauce has thickened. Stir in the chopped parsley and serve at once.

Glazed Carrots with Cider

This recipe is extremely simple to make. The carrots are cooked in the minimum of liquid to bring out the best of their flavour, and the cider adds a pleasant sharpness.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

450 g/1 lb young carrots

25 g/l oz/2 tbsp butter

15 ml/ 1 tbsp brown sugar

120 ml/4 fl oz/ 1/2cup cider

60 ml/4 tbsp vegetable stock or water

1 tsp Dijon mustard

15 ml / 1 tbsp finely chopped fresh parsley

1-Trim the tops and bottoms of the carrots. Peel or scrape them. Using a sharp knife, cut them into julienne strips.

2-Melt the butter in a frying pan add the carrots and saute for 4-5 minutes, stirring frequently. Sprinkle over the sugar and cook, stirring, for 1 minute or until the sugar has dissolved.

3-Add the cider and stock or water, bring to the boil and stir in the Dijon mustard. Partially cover the pan and simmer for 10-12 minutes, until the carrots are just tender. Remove the lid and continue cooking until the liquid has reduced to a thick sauce.

4-Remove the saucepan from the heat, stir in the chopped fresh parsley and then spoon into a warmed serving dish.

COOK'S TIP

If the carrots are cooked before the liquid in the saucepan has reduced, transfer the carrots to a serving dish and rapidly boil the liquid until thick. Pour over the carrots and sprinkle with parsley.

Broccoli and Cauliflower Gratin

Broccoli and cauliflower make an attractive combination, and a yogurt and cheesy sauce gives them extra piquant flavour.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

1 small cauliflower (about 250 g/9 oz)

1 small head broccoli (about 250 g/9 oz)

150 g/5 oz/1 cup natural yogurt

75 g/3 oz/1 cup grated Cheddar cheese

5 ml/1 tsp wholegrain mustard

30 ml/2 tbsp wholemeal breadcrumbs

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Break the cauliflower and broccoli into florets and cook in lightly salted boiling water for about 8-10 minutes, until just tender. Drain well and transfer to a flameproof dish.

2-Mix together the yogurt, grated cheese and mustard, then season the mixture with salt and pepper and spoon over the cauliflower and broccoli.

3-Preheat the grill to moderately hot. Sprinkle the breadcrumbs over the top of the vegetables and grill until golden brown. Serve hot.

COOK'S TIP

When preparing the cauliflower and broccoli, discard the tougher parts of the stalk, then break the florets into even-size pieces so they cook evenly.

Summer Tomato Pasta

This is a deliciously light pasta dish, full of fresh flavours. Use buffalo-milk mozzarella if you can - the flavour is noticeably better.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

275 g/10 oz/2 1/4 cups dried penne

450 g/1 lb plum tomatoes

275 g/10 oz mozzarella, drained

60 ml/4 tbsp olive oil

15 ml/ 1 tbsp balsamic vinegar

Grated rind and juice of 1 lemon

15 fresh basil leaves, shredded

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Fresh basil leaves, to garnish

1-Cook the pasta in boiling salted water, according to the package instructions, until just tender.

2-Quarter the tomatoes and remove the seeds, then chop the flesh into small cubes. Slice up the mozzarella into similarly sized pieces.

3-Mix together the olive oil, balsamic vinegar, grated lemon rind, 15 ml/1 tbsp of the lemon juice and the basil. Season with salt and pepper. Add the tomatoes and mozzarella and leave to stand until the pasta is cooked.

4-Drain the pasta and toss with the tomato mixture. Serve immediately, garnished with fresh basil leaves.

Pappardelle and Provencal Sauce

A classic French sauce of tomatoes and fresh vegetables adds colour and robust flavour to pasta.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

2 small purple onions, peeled, root left intact

150 ml/1/4 pint/ 2/3 cup vegetable stock

1-2 garlic cloves, crushed

60 ml/4 tbsp red wine

2 courgettes, cut into fingers

1 yellow pepper, seeded and sliced

400 g/14 oz can tomatoes

10 ml/2 tsp chopped fresh thyme

5 ml/ 1 tsp caster sugar

350 g/ 12 oz pappardelle

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Fresh thyme and 6 black olives, stoned and roughly chopped, to garnish

1-Cut each onion into eight wedges through the root end, to hold them together during cooking. Put into a saucepan with the stock and garlic. Bring to the boil, cover and simmer for 5 minutes, until tender.

2-Add the red wine, courgettes, 2 yellow pepper, tomatoes, thyme and sugar. Season with salt and pepper. Bring to the boil and cook gently for 5-7 minutes, shaking the pan occasionally to coat the vegetables with the sauce. (Do not overcook the vegetables as they are much nicer if they are slightly crunchy.)

3-Cook the pasta in a large pan of boiling salted water according to the instructions on the package, until tender. Drain the pasta thoroughly.

4-Transfer to a warmed serving dish and top with the vegetables. Garnish with fresh thyme and chopped black olives.

Pasta Primavera

There's no better way to showcase the best of the spring season's young vegetables than in this delightful pasta dish.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

225 g/8 oz thin asparagus spears, cut in half

115 g/4 oz mangetouts, topped and tailed

115 g/4 oz whole baby sweetcorn

225 g/8 oz whole baby carrots

1 small red pepper, seeded and chopped

8 spring onions, sliced

225 g/ 8 oz torchietti

150 ml/1/4 pint/1/3 cup cottage cheese

150 ml/1/4 pint/1/3 cup low-fat yogurt

15 ml/1 tbsp lemon juice

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh parsley milk (optional)

15 ml/1 tbsp snipped chives

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Sun-dried tomato bread, to serve

1-Cook the thin asparagus spears in a pan of boiling salted water for 3-4 minutes. Add the mangetouts halfway through the cooking time. Drain and rinse both under cold water.

2-Cook the baby sweetcorn, carrots, red pepper and spring onions in the same way until tender. Drain and rinse.

3-Cook the pasta in a large pan of boiling salted water until tender. Drain thoroughly. Put the cottage cheese, yogurt, lemon juice and parsley into a food processor or blender. Season with salt and pepper, then process until smooth. Thin the sauce with a little milk, if necessary.

4-Put the sauce into a large pan 4with the pasta and vegetables, heat gently and toss carefully. Transfer to a warmed serving plate, scatter the chives over the top and serve with sun-dried tomato bread.

Pasta with Pesto Sauce

Don't stint on the fresh basil - this is the most wonderful sauce in the world! And it tastes completely different from the ready-made pesto sold in jars.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

2 garlic cloves

50g/ 2 oz/ ½ cup pine nuts

40g/ 1 ½ oz/ 1 cup fresh basil leaves

150ml/ 1/4 pint/ 2/3 cup olive oil

50g/ 2 oz/4 tbsp unsalted butter, softened

60ml/ 4 tbsp freshly grated Parmesan cheese

450g / 1 lb spaghetti salt and ground black pepper

1-Peel the garlic and process in a blender or food processor with a little salt and the pine nuts until broken up. Add the basil leaves and continue mixing to a paste.

2-Gradually add the olive oil, little by little, until the mixture is creamy and thick.

3-Beat in the butter and season with ground black pepper. Beat in the cheese. Alternatively, you can make the pesto by hand using a pestle and mortar.

4-Store the pesto sauce in a jar, with a layer of olive oil on top to exclude the air, in the fridge until needed.

5-Cook the pasta in plenty of boiling salted water according to the instructions on the packet, until al dente. Drain well.

6-Toss the pasta with half the pesto and serve in warm bowls, with the remaining pesto sauce spooned over the top.

Penne with Fennel, Tomato and Blue Cheese

The anise flavour of the fennel makes it the perfect partner for tomato, especially when topped with blue cheese.

Ingredients:

Serves 2

1 fennel bulb

225 g/8 oz/2 cups penne or other dried pasta shapes

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

1 shallot, finely chopped

300 ml/1/2 pint/ 1 ¼ cups passata

Pinch of sugar

5 ml/ 1 tsp chopped fresh oregano

115 g/4 oz blue cheese

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Cut the fennel bulb in half Cut away the hard core and root. Slice the fennel thinly, then cut the slices into strips.

2-Bring a large pan of salted water to the boil. Add the pasta and cook for 10-12 minutes, until

3-Meanwhile, heat the oil in a small saucepan. Add the fennel and shallot and cook for 2-3 minutes over high heat, stirring occasionally.

4-Add the passata, sugar and oregano. Cover the pan and simmer gently for 10-12 minutes, until the fennel is tender. Season with salt and pepper. Drain the just tender.

pasta and return it to the pan. Toss with the sauce. Serve with blue cheese crumbled over the top.

Peanut Noodles

Add any of your favourite vegetables to this quick lunch recipe - and increase the quantity of chilli, if you can take the heat!

Ingredients:

Serves 4

200 g/7 oz medium egg noodles

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

2 garlic cloves, crushed

1 large onion, roughly chopped

1 red pepper, seeded and roughly chopped

1 yellow pepper, seeded and roughly chopped

350 g/12 oz courgettes, roughly chopped

150 g/5 oz/generous 3/4 cup roasted unsalted peanuts, roughly chopped

For the dressing

50 ml/2 fl oz/ 1/4 cup olive oil

Grated rind and juice of 1 lemon

1 fresh red chilli, seeded and finely chopped

45 ml/3 tbsp snipped fresh chives

15-30 ml/1-2 tbsp balsamic vinegar

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Snipped fresh chives, to garnish

1-Cook the noodles according to the package instructions and drain well.

2- Meanwhile, heat the oil in a very large frying pan or wok and cook the garlic and onion for 3 minutes, or until beginning to soften. Add the peppers and courgettes and cook for a further 15 minutes over a medium heat until beginning to soften and brown. Add the peanuts and cook for a further 1 minute.

3-Whisk together the olive oil, grated lemon rind and 45 ml/ 3 tbsp of the lemon juice, the chilli, chives and balsamic vinegar to taste. Season with salt and pepper.

4-Toss the noodles into the vegetables and stir-fry to heat through. Add the dressing, stir to coat and serve immediately, garnished with fresh chives.

Stir-fried Vegetables with Cashew Nuts

Stir-frying is the perfect way to make a delicious, colourful and very speedy meal.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

900 g/2 lb mixed vegetables (see Cook's Tip)

30-60 ml/2-4 tbsp sunflower or olive oil

2 garlic cloves, crushed

15 rnl / 1 tbsp grated fresh root ginger

50 g/2 oz//2 cup cashew nuts or 60 ml/ 4 tbsp sunflower seeds, pumpkin seeds or sesame seeds

Soy sauce

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Prepare the vegetables according to type. Carrots and cucumber should be cut into very fine matchsticks.

2-Heat a frying pan, then trickle the oil around the rim so that it runs down to coat the surface. When the oil is hot, add the garlic and ginger and cook for 2-3 minutes, stirring. Add the harder vegetables and toss over the heat for a further 5 minutes, until they start to soften.

3-Add the softer vegetables and stir-fry all of them over a high heat for 3-4 minutes.

4-Stir in the cashew nuts or seeds. Season with soy sauce, salt and pepper. Serve at once.

COOK'S TIP

Use a pack of stir-fry vegetables or make up your own mixture. Choose from carrots, mangetouts, baby sweetcorn, pak choi, cucumber, beansprouts, mushrooms, peppers and spring onions. Drained canned bamboo shoots and water chestnuts are delicious additions.

Rice Noodles with Vegetable Chilli Sauce

Fresh chilli and coriander combine to give this recipe quite a strong flavour kick.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

15 ml/1 tbsp sunflower oil

1 onion, chopped

2 garlic cloves, crushed

1 fresh red chilli, seeded and finely chopped

1 red pepper, seeded and diced

2 carrots, finely chopped

175 g/6 oz baby sweetcorn, halved

225 g/8 oz can sliced bamboo shoots, rinsed and drained

400 g/14 oz can red kidney beans, rinsed and drained

300 ml/ 1/2 pint/ 1 1/4 cups passata

15 ml/1 tbsp soy sauce

5 ml/1 tsp ground coriander

250 g/9 oz rice noodles

30 ml/2 tbsp chopped fresh coriander

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Fresh parsley sprigs, to garnish

1-Heat the oil in a saucepan, add the onion, garlic, chilli and red pepper and cook gently for 5 minutes, stirring. Add the carrots, sweetcorn, bamboo shoots, kidney beans, passata, soy sauce and ground coriander and stir to mix.

2-Bring to the boil, then cover and simmer gently for 30 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the vegetables are tender. Season with salt and pepper.

3-Meanwhile, place the noodles in a bowl and cover with boiling water. Stir with a fork and leave to stand for 3-4 minutes or according to the package instructions. Rinse and drain.

4- Stir the fresh Coriander into the sauce. Spoon the noodles on to warmed serving plates, top with the sauce, garnish with parsley and serve.

LIGHT LUNCHES

Frittata with Sun-dried Tomatoes

Adding just a few sun-dried tomatoes gives this frittata a distinctly Mediterranean flavour.

Ingredients:

Serves 3-4

6 sun-dried tomatoes, dry or in oil and drained

60 ml/4 tbsp olive oil

1 small onion, finely chopped

Pinch of fresh thyme leaves

6 eggs

50 g/2 oz/ 1/2 cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Place the tomatoes in a small bowl and pour on enough hot water to just cover them. Soak for about 15 minutes. Lift the tomatoes out of the water and slice them into thin strips. Reserve the soaking water.

2-Heat the oil in a large non-stick or heavy frying pan. Stir in the onion and cook for 5-6 minutes or until soft and golden. Add the tomatoes and thyme and continue to stir over moderate heat for 2-3 minutes. Season with salt and pepper.

3-Break the eggs into a bowl and beat lightly with a fork. Stir in 45-60 ml/3-4 tbsp of the tomato soaking water and the grated Parmesan cheese.

4-Raise the heat under the pan. When the oil is sizzling, pour in the eggs. Mix them quickly into the other ingredients and stop stirring. Lower the heat to moderate and cook for 4-5 minutes on the first side, or until the frittata is puffed and golden brown underneath.

5-Take a large plate, place it upside down over the pan and, holding it firmly with oven gloves, turn the pan and the frittata over on to it. Slide the frittata back into the pan and continue cooking until golden brown on the second side, 3-4 minutes more. Remove from the heat. The frittata can be served hot, at room temperature or cold. Cut it into wedges to serve.

Vegetable Fajitas

A colourful medley of mushrooms and peppers in a spicy sauce, wrapped in tortillas and served with creamy guacamole.

Ingredients:

Serves 2

1 onion

1 red pepper

1 green pepper

1 yellow pepper

1 garlic clove, crushed

225 g/8 oz mushrooms

90 ml/6 tbsp vegetable oil

30 ml/2 tbsp medium chilli powder salt and freshly ground black pepper

For the guacamole

1 ripe avocado

1 shallot, coarsely chopped

1 fresh green chilli, seeded and coarsely chopped

Juice of 1 lime

To serve

4-6 flour tortillas, warmed

1 lime, cut into wedges

Sprigs of fresh coriander

1-Slice the onion. Cut the peppers in half, remove the seeds and cut the flesh into strips. Combine the onion and peppers in a bowl. Add the crushed garlic and mix lightly.

2-Remove the mushroom stalks. Save for making stock, or discard. Slice the mushroom caps and add to the pepper mixture in the bowl. Mix the oil and chilli powder in a cup, pour over the vegetable mixture and stir well. Set aside.

3-Make the guacamole. Cut the avocado in half and remove the stone and the peel. Put the flesh into a food processor or blender with the shallot, green chilli and lime juice.

4-Process for 1 minute, until smooth. Scrape into a small bowl, cover tightly and put in the fridge to chill until required.

5-Heat a frying pan or wok until very hot. Add the marinated vegetables and stir-fry over high heat for 5-6 minutes, until the mushrooms and peppers are just tender. Season with salt and pepper. Spoon the filling on to each tortilla and roll up. Garnish with coriander and serve with the guacamole and lime wedges.

Chinese Garlic Mushrooms

Tofu is high in protein and very low in fat, so it is a very useful food to keep handy for quick meals and snacks like this one.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

8 large open-cap mushrooms

3 spring onions, sliced

1 garlic clove, crushed

30 ml/2 tbsp mushroom sauce

275 g/10 oz packet marinated tofu (beancurd), cut into small dice

200 g/7 oz can sweetcorn, drained

10 ml/2 tsp sesame oil

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Preheat the oven to 200oC/400oF/Gas 6. Finely chop the mushroom stalks and mix with the spring onions, garlic and mushroom sauce.

2-Stir in the diced marinated tofu and sweetcorn, season with salt and pepper, then spoon the filling into the mushrooms.

3-Brush the edges of the 3mushrooms with the sesame oil. Arrange the stuffed mushrooms in a baking dish and bake for 12-15 minutes, until the mushrooms are just tender, then serve at once.

COOK'S TIP

If you prefer, omit the musnroom sauce and use light soy sauce instead.

Savoury Nut Loaf

This delicious nut loaf makes perfect picnic food.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

15 ml/1 tbsp olive oil, plus extra for greasing

1 onion, chopped

1 leek, chopped

2 celery sticks, finely chopped

225 g/8 oz mushrooms, chopped

2 garlic cloves, crushed

425 g/1 1/2 lb 5 oz can lentils, rinsed and drained

115 g/4 oz/1 cup mixed nuts, such as hazelnuts, cashew nuts and almonds, finely chopped 50 g/2 oz/ 1/2 cup flour

50 g/2 oz/1/2 cup grated mature Cheddar cheese

1 medium egg, beaten

45-60 ml/3-4 tbsp chopped fresh mixed herbs

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Chives and sprigs of fresh flat leaf parsley, to garnish

1-Preheat the oven to 190°C/375°F/Gas 5. Lightly grease the base and sides of a 900 g/2 lb loaf tin and line with greaseproof paper.

2-Heat the oil in a large saucepan, add the chopped onion, leek, celery sticks and mushrooms and the crushed garlic, then cook gently for 10 minutes, until the vegetables have softened, stirring occasionally.

3-Add the lentils, mixed nuts, flour, grated cheese, egg and herbs. Season with salt and pepper and mix thoroughly.

4-Spoon the nut, vegetable and lentil mixture into the prepared loaf tin, ensuring that it is pressed into the corners, and level the surface. Bake, uncovered, for 50-60 minutes, or until the nut loaf is lightly browned on top and firm to the touch.

5-Cool the loaf slightly in the tin, then turn out on to a serving plate. Serve hot or cold, cut into slices and garnished with chives and flat leaf parsley.

Spicy Bean and Lentil Loaf

An appetizing, high-fibre savoury loaf, ideal for packed lunches.

Ingredients:

Serves 12

10 ml/2 tsp olive oil

1 onion, finely chopped

1 garlic clove, crushed

2 celery sticks, finely chopped

400 g/14 oz can red kidney beans

400 g/ 14 oz can lentils

1 egg

1 carrot, coarsely grated

50 g/2 oz/1/2 cup finely grated mature Cheddar cheese

50 g/2 oz/1 cup fresh wholemeal breadcrumbs

15 ml/1 tbsp tomato puree

15 ml/1 tbsp tomato ketchup

5 ml/1 tsp each ground cumin, ground coriander and hot chilli powder

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Salad, to serve

1-Preheat the oven to 180°C/350°F/Gas 4. Lightly grease a 900 g/2 lb loaf tin.

2-Heat the oil in a saucepan, add the onion, garlic and celery and cook gently for 5 minutes, stirring occasionally. Remove the pan from the heat and cool slightly.

3-Rinse and drain the beans and lentils. Put in a blender or food processor with the onion mixture and egg and process until smooth.

4-Transfer the mixture to a bowl, add all the remaining ingredients and mix well. Season with salt and pepper.

5-Spoon the mixture into the prepared tin and level the surface. Bake for about 1 hour, then remove from the tin and serve hot or cold in slices, accompanied by a salad.

Stuffed Mushrooms

This is a classic mushroom dish, strongly flavoured with garlic. Use flat mushrooms or field mushrooms that are sometimes available from farm shops.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

450 g/1 lb large flat mushrooms

Butter, for greasing

About 75 ml/5 tbsp olive oil

2 garlic cloves, crushed

45 ml/3 tbsp finely chopped fresh parsley

40-50 g/ ½ - 2 oz/1/4-1 cup fresh white breadcrumbs

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Sprig of fresh flat leaf parsley, to garnish

1-Preheat the oven to 180oC/ 350oF/Gas 4. Cut off the mushroom stalks and reserve.

2-Arrange the mushroom caps in a buttered shallow dish, gill side upwards.

3-Heat 15 ml/ 1 tbsp of the oil in a frying pan and fry the garlic briefly. Finely chop the mushroom stalks and mix with the parsley and breadcrumbs. Add the garlic and 1 5 ml/ 1 tbsp of the oil. Season with salt and pepper. Pile a little of the mixture into each mushroom.

4-Add the remaining oil to the dish and cover the mushrooms with buttered greaseproof paper. Bake for 15-20 minutes, removing the paper for the last five minutes to brown the tops. Garnish with a sprig of flat leaf parsley.

Sweetcorn and Cheese Pasties

These tasty pasties are really simple to make and extremely moreish. Why not make double - they'll go like hot cakes.

Ingredients:

Makes 18-20

250 g/9 oz sweetcorn

115 g/4 oz feta cheese

1 egg, beaten

30 ml/2 tbsp whipping cream

15 g/1/2 oz freshly grated Parmesan cheese

3 spring onions, chopped

8-10 small sheets filo pastry

115 g/4 oz/8 tbsp butter, melted

Freshly ground black pepper

1-Preheat the oven to 190oC/375oF/Gas 5. Butter two bun tins.

2-If using fresh sweetcorn, strip the kernels from the cob using a large sharp knife, cutting downwards from top to bottom of the cob. Simmer in a little salted water for 3-5 minutes, until tender. For canned sweetcorn, drain and rinse well under cold running water.

3-Crumble the feta cheese into a bowl and stir in the sweetcorn. Add the egg, cream, Parmesan cheese, spring onions and ground black pepper and stir well.

4-Take one sheet of pastry and cut it in half to make a square. (Keep the remaining pastry covered with a damp cloth to prevent it from drying out.) Brush with melted butter and then fold into four to make a smaller square (about 7.5 cm/3 in).

5-Place a heaped teaspoon of mixture in the centre of each pastry square and then squeeze the pastry around the filling to make a 'money bag' casing.

6-Continue making pasties until all the filling is used up. Brush the outside of each 'bag' with any remaining butter and then bake for about 15 minutes, until golden brown. Serve hot.

Gado Gado

The peanut sauce on this traditional Indonesian vegetable dish owes flavour to galangal, an aromatic rhizome that resembles ginger.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

250 g/9 oz white cabbage, shredded

4 carrots, cut into matchsticks

4 celery sticks, cut into matchsticks

250 g/9 oz/4 cups beansprouts

1/2 cucumber, cut into matchsticks

fried onion, salted peanuts and sliced fresh chilli, to garnish

For the peanut sauce

15 ml/ 1 tbsp oil

1 small onion, finely chopped

1 garlic clove, crushed

1 small piece galangal, peeled and grated

5 ml/ 1 tsp ground cumin

1.5 ml/1/4tsp ground chilli powder

5 ml/1 tsp tamarind paste or lime juice

60 ml/4 tbsp crunchy peanut butter

5 ml/ 1 tsp soft light brown sugar

1- Steam the cabbage, carrots and celery for about 3-4 minutes, until just tender. Leave to cool. Spread out the beansprouts on a large serving dish. Arrange the cabbage, carrots, celery and cucumber on top.

2-To make the sauce, heat the oil in a saucepan, add the onion and garlic and cook gently for 5 minutes, until soft.

3-Stir in the spices and cook for 1 minute more. Add the tamarind paste or lime juice, peanut butter and sugar. Mix well.

4-Heat the sauce gently, stirring occasionally and adding a little hot water if necessary, to make the sauce runny enough to coat the vegetables when poured.

5-Spoon a little of the sauce over the vegetables and toss lightly together. Garnish with fried onions, peanuts and sliced chilli. Serve the rest of the sauce in a bowl separately.

COOK'S TIP

As long as the sauce remains the same, the vegetables can be altered at the whim of the cook and to reflect the contents of the vegetable rack or chiller.

Ratatouille

A classic vegetable stew, packed full of fresh vegetables and herbs and absolutely bursting with wonderful flavour.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

2 large aubergines, roughly chopped

4 courgettes, roughly chopped

150 ml/ 1/4 pint/1/3 cup olive oil

2 onions, sliced

2 garlic cloves, chopped

1 large red pepper, seeded and roughly chopped

2 large yellow peppers, seeded and roughly chopped

Sprig of fresh rosemary sprig of fresh thyme

5 ml/ 1 tsp coriander seeds, crushed

3 plum tomatoes, skinned, seeded and chopped

8 basil leaves, torn

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Sprigs of fresh parsley or basil, to garnish

1-Sprinkle the aubergines and courgettes with salt, then put them in a colander with a plate and a weight on top to extract the bitter juices. Leave for about 30 minutes.

2-Heat the olive oil in a large saucepan. Add the onions and fry gently for 6-7 minutes, until just softened. Add the garlic and cook for another 2 minutes.

3-Rinse the aubergines and courgettes and pat dry with a clean dish towel. Add to the pan with the peppers, increase the heat and sauté until the peppers are just turning brown.

4-Add the herbs and coriander seeds, then cover the pan and cook gently for about 40 minutes.

5-Add the tomatoes and season with salt and pepper. Cook gently for a further 10 minutes, until the vegetables are soft but not too mushy. Remove the sprigs of herbs. Stir in the torn basil leaves and check the seasoning. Leave to cool slightly and serve warm or cold, garnished with sprigs of parsley or basil.

Vegetable Fritters

Ingredients:

1 cup of gram (chick pea) flour

1 cup of water a little salt

a teaspoon of chopped coriander sunflower oil for shallow frying

2 cups of vegetables of your choice broken or chopped into desired size - for example broccoli or cauliflower florets, celery chunks, onion rings etc.

Beat the flour and water together with the salt and coriander until a smooth batter is formed. Heat the oil in a large frying pan. Dip the vegetables in the batter and then fry for about 5 minutes

turning once. Nice served with oven chips or rice and a big green salad and vegan mayo.

Balmoral Pie

Ingredients (entirely versatile in quantity!):

tins of baked beans

vegan sausages

mashed potatoes (mashed with soya milk and soya marg)

Cheezly or other vegan cheese (optional)

Heat beans. Grill or fry sausages and chop into large chunks. Mix with heated beans. Put in casserole dish and top with mashed potatoes and then cheezly (or mix cheezly in with potatoes when mashing). Place under grill until all hot and bubbly and going brown.

Potato Layer Thing

Ingredients:

6 or 7 medium sized potatoes

1 large can of baked beans in tomato sauce (approx 800g)

1 large onion, thinly sliced

2 or 3 sliced tomatoes

1 tablespoon of margarine for dotting over the top

1 tablespoon of sesame seeds for sprinkling on the top other optional layers:

1 or 2 cups of left-over rice mixed with some soya milk and herbs

sliced mushrooms mixed with a little veg. oil and 2 cloves of crushed garlic

1 can of sweetcorn

1 can of spinach

Part-boil the potatoes for 5 or 6 minutes until starting to soften. Thinly slice them. In a large casserole or lasagne dish place a layer of potatoes then a layer of beans, then onion and repeat until all used up. That is the basic dish but you can add any other layers you like, such as the garlic mushrooms, sweetcorn, spinach or rice ones above, making the last layer potatoes. Spread the sliced tomatoes over the top, dot with the marg. and sprinkle on the sesame seeds. Bake for about an hour or until the potatoes are soft at 190C/380F.

Bradies

A traditional pastry from the North East of Scotland - they're a bit like flat meat and potato pies - we have replaced the original beef mince with frozen vege-mince! Nice with chips (french fries)

and beans. This recipe makes 4 large bradies. Ingredients:

Approx 400g/15oz of frozen vegan puff pastry, defrosted a little sunflower oil

1 large onion, chopped

1 large potato, cut into small cubes

about 1 and a half cups of frozen vege-mince (dried soya mince would do fine if re-hydrated first in water or stock)

1 tablespoon of soy sauce

Prepare the pastry by rolling out (to about 5mm thick) and cutting into 4 rectangles. In a pan fry

the onion, potato and mince together for a few minutes and then add the soy sauce and mix well.

Place the filling on one half of the pastry rectangles and then fold over and seal the edges by folding them over all the way round with a little water. Place on a baking tray and bake at

200C/400F for 20-30 minutes or until pastry is cooked.

Mince and dumplings

A traditional Scottish meal - often served with skirlie, greens and mashed potatoes.

Ingredients for mince:

a little sunflower oil

1 onion, chopped

2 or 3 carrots, diced

Approx 2 cups of frozen vegemince or re-hydrated dried soya mince

About 1 cup of water or stock

Dash of soy sauce

1 fresh bayleaf or half a teaspoon of dried bayleaf

salt and pepper to taste

For the dumplings:

100g/4oz self raising flour

50g./2oz hard vegan margarine or vegetable suet, broken into small pieces

1 teaspoon of dried herbs (optional)

a little salt

water to mix to a dough (about a quarter cup)

Fry the onion and carrot in the oil for a few minutes. Add the mince, water, seasoning and soy sauce. Make small tears in the bay leaf and place in the pan with the other ingredients (alternatively add dried bay). Bring to the boil and turn down to simmer. For the dumplings: rub the fat into the flour, add herbs if using and salt. Gradually add water and mix until you have a workable dough. Form into about 10 small balls and place in the simmering pan of mince for about 20 minutes until cooked. If the pan of mince is quite shallow you may need to turn the dumplings halfway through cooking. If you used a fresh bayleaf you should remove it before serving (though I have sometimes forgotten and had no complaints!!).

Spicy, Fruity Pasty

These quantities make 4 large or 8 mini pasties - lovely as a simple hot meal with oven chips and salad or cold with Plamil mayo later! Ingredients:

Approx 400g/15oz of frozen vegan puff pastry, defrosted (ready rolled is extra easy!!) Soya milk for glazing and sealing (a few tablespoons)

a little sunflower oil

2 garlic cloves, crushed

1 onion, finely chopped

1 teaspoon of curry powder

2 medium sized potatoes, cubed quite small

3 medium carrots, cubed the same

about 10 dried apricots, chopped

1 apple, peeled then finely chopped (this is a good recipe for using up slightly old apples)

1/4 cup of white wine or stock seasalt to taste

Prepare the pastry by rolling out (to about 5mm thick) if needed and cutting into 4 or 8 just off square rectangles. In a frying pan fry the onion and garlic in the oil then add the curry powder. Add the fruit and vegetables and pour over the wine or stock. Cook for a few minutes until everything is well combined and starting to soften, then divide between the pastry squares, placing the filling in the middle. Seal up the edges using some soy milk for stickiness (like making a little parcel and pinching the edges together). Glaze with a little soya milk and bake at

200C/400F for 20-30 minutes or until pastry is cooked.

Stuffed Acorn Squash

This would work equally well with other squashes such as butternut or pumpkins.

Ingredients:

2 medium acorn squashes

2 tablespoons of olive oil a little sunflower oil

2 garlic cloves, crushed

1 leek, finely chopped

a thumb sized piece of ginger, finely chopped or grated a handful of flaked almonds

1 glass of white wine (optional) (roughly) a cup of rice

seasalt to taste

2 or 3 cups of water for cooking as needed

Cut the squashes in half, remove the seeds and rub them with the olive oil. Place on a baking tray and bake in the oven at 180C/360F for about half an hour. Meanwhile lightly fry the garlic, leek and ginger in the sunflower oil for a few minutes and then add the wine, almonds and salt. Add the rice with enough water to cover well and bring to the boil. Turn down and simmer until the rice is cooked, stirring occasionally and adding more water if needed. Once cooked pile the rice mixture onto the squash halves and bake for a further 20-30 minutes or until the squashes are tender. Nice with gravy and roast potatoes.

Sweet Potatoes in a Coconut and Peanut Sauce

Ingredients:

1 onion, finely chopped

2 cloves of garlic, crushed a little sunflower oil

1 teaspoon of curry powder

2 tablespoons of peanut butter

1 tin of coconut milk

5 or 6 medium sized sweet potatoes, cut into bite size chunks

seasalt to taste

Fry the onion and garlic in the oil for a few minutes. Add the curry spices and stir well. Add the peanut butter, stirring over a medium heat until it begins to melt and then pour in your coconut milk and stir until well blended. Put the sweet potatoes and salt in the pan and bring to the boil and then turn down to simmer until they are softened (10 minutes +). Nice with rice and salad.

Quiche (or tart) Ingredients: pastry:

200g/7 oz/1 and a half cups plain flour (either white or wholemeal)

100g/3 and a half oz/ half a cup vegan margarine

5 or 6 tablespoons of cold water

filling:

1 block of tofu (silken or firm) - roughly about 200g/7oz

half a teaspoon of turmeric

1 onion, roughly chopped

2 cloves of garlic

3 tablespoons of soya milk

a little seasalt

extra ingredients of your choice:

chopped tomatoes sliced mushrooms sliced onions

cheatin' ham (soy based meat analogue)

tinned sweetcorn diced peppers

Preheat oven to 190C/380F. In a large mixing bowl rub the margarine into the flour to a breadcrumb texture. Gradually add the water and mix to a dough. On a floured board roll this out to fit your flat pie or quiche dish. Grease dish and line with the pastry.

In a food processor combine the tofu, turmeric, soya milk, onion, garlic and salt until fairly smooth. Into this you stir your chosen ingredients - mushroom and tomato is lovely - so is plain sweetcorn. Even just a plain quiche topped with sliced tomatoes is a very nice meal when accompanied with new potatoes and salad. For a sage and onion tart add a handful of fresh sage to the tofu mixture before processing.

Pour the filling mixture into the pastry case and bake in the oven for about 45 minutes or until firm in the middle (this will vary from oven to oven so check from about half an hour).

Singapore Vegan Noodles

Ingredients:

Dried rice noodles (200g pack for a family of 4)

2 tablespoons of sunflower oil

3 cloves of garlic, crushed

1 onion cut into inch/2cm long thin strips

1 teaspoon of chilli powder

1 red pepper cut into same strips

1 yellow pepper cut in the same way

1 courgette/zucchini cut into strips

smoked tofu, cut into similar sized pieces

2 tablespoons of soy sauce

2 tablespoons of sesame oil

Cook the rice noodles according to the instructions on the packet - often this is just pouring

boiling water over them and leaving them for a while. Cook the onions and garlic in the sunflower oil for a few minutes and then add the chilli and stir in well. Add your vegetables and soy sauce and cook for a few moments until slightly softened and then add the tofu and stir fry for another 10 minutes or so before adding the rice noodles and combining well (you may want to cut them up if they are very long). At the last minute sprinkle the sesame oil over the dish and serve at once. This goes very well with a fresh salad of Chinese cabbage and herbs.

Sweet Butternut Casserole

A warming, autumnal dish, nice served with garlic bread and a baked potato and perhaps some vegan sausages.

Ingredients:

2 leeks, sliced into thin round slices

A little olive oil

Half a butternut squash (about 3 cups) cut into chunks

2 sweet potatoes cut into chunks

2 tins chopped tomatoes (about 3 cups/800g in all)

half a cup of water or vegetable stock

a handful of fresh mint roughly chopped or 3 teaspoons of dried mint seasalt to taste

Fry the leeks in the oil for a few moments then add the squash and potato and stir until coated with the oil. Add the tomatoes, water/stock, salt and mint and bring to the boil. Simmer gently for about 20 minutes until cooked.

Catriona's Vegan Burger

Ingredients:

600g/21 oz. firm tofu

1 clove of garlic, crushed

quarter cup of barbeque sauce (or favourite marinade)

2 tablespoons of Indonesian sweet soy sauce

Cut the tofu into twelve pieces about the thickness and size of a burger. Place the tofu, garlic and sauces in a dish and marinate over night or for two days. Either fry, barbecue or bake (at 200C/400F) until browned. Serve in a bun with fried onions, egg-free mayonnaise, salad and sauces or mustard.

Lynn's Cornish Pasty

I should point out that if it was a vegan version of a 'traditional' Cornish pasty it would not have carrot in it - but I think it's tastier with it in there.

Ingredients:

To make 4 medium to large pasties:

for the pastry:

10 oz/275g/2 cups plain flour (I use a mixture of 3 oz white & 7 oz wholewheat/wholemeal)

5 oz/130g/ 3/4 cup hard margarine (I grate it - it's easier to rub in!)

pinch salt water to mix for the filling:

1 tablespoon oil or margarine

1 onion, roughly chopped

1 small Swede chopped (about 1/2inch dice)

4 medium/large carrots chopped as above

1 medium/large potato chopped as above

1 tsp yeast extract black pepper to taste

Pastry: Mix flours and salt together. Rub in grated marg until the mixture looks like fine breadcrumbs. Add cold water a tablespoon at a time until the mixture holds together and a firm dough is formed. Knead lightly. Put in fridge

Filling: Melt the margarine or heat the oil in a large saucepan. Add the vegetables and stir well. Put lid on saucepan and cook, on a low heat for about 20 minutes, stirring occasionally until vegetables are nearly cooked. Stir in yeast extract and add black pepper, and allow the mixture to cool.

Remove pastry from fridge and cut into four equal pieces. Roll out each piece roughly into

a circle of about 7 inch (this is very roughly - I never actually measure it!). Place 1/4 of the veg mix along the centre of each circle and wet edges, bring them together above the veg mix and seal and 'crimp'. Brush with soya milk and cook (in a preheated oven!) at 180C/375F on the middle shelf for about 40-45 minutes.

These are good hot or cold, and I sometimes add herbs to the mixture (fresh or dried whatever I have to hand) just for a change! Hope you enjoy them as much as my children have over the years.

Pizza

This pizza is so tasty that you will not miss the cheese!

Ingredients:

for the base:

500g./1 lb./3 cups plain flour, white or wholemeal

1 packet of easy blend dried yeast

200 ml./1 cup of warm water but keep adding until you get a good dough topping:

1 tin chopped tomatoes (approx. 400g/14oz.)

2 tablespoons dried mixed herbs

2 tablespoons olive or sunflower oil salt and pepper to taste

1 small tin of mushrooms or/and sweetcorn (optional)

sesame seeds for sprinkling on top

Mix the flour with the yeast and add the water gradually. Mix well (with your hands is best) and then knead for a couple of minutes until the dough is fairly smooth. Place on a large greased baking tray and flatten into desired shape (ie. - circle). Leave in a warm place while you prepare the topping: Mix together the tomatoes, herbs, oil and seasoning in a bowl and then spread over the pizza base. If using the mushrooms/sweetcorn - coat them in a little olive oil and arrange on the top of the pizza. Sprinkle with sesame seeds and bake at 200 C/400 F for 15 to 20 minutes until ready.

Variations - obviously you can add whatever toppings you like to the basic tomato mixture - olives, vegan 'cheeses', pineapple chunks, vegan meat substitutes etc. You can also vary the herbs used, add garlic and onion or add herbs or seeds to the base. If you want a softer base you can leave the dough to rise for half an hour before adding the toppings but we find it great without doing that.

Chick Pea Curry

Ingredients:

1 - 2 Tablespoons of olive oil

1 onion, chopped

3 cloves of garlic, finely chopped or crushed

1 apple, peeled and finely chopped

1 green pepper, finely chopped

2 - 3 teaspoons of curry powder

1-2 tins of cooked chick peas (or soak dried ones overnight and cook)

1 can of tomatoes

handful of raisins (optional)

2 tablespoons of desiccated coconut (optional)

some frozen peas

salt

Fry the onion, garlic and apple in the olive oil for a few minutes. Add the curry powder and stir for a minute or two. Add the tomatoes (chop them if needed) and green pepper. If you like really sweet tasting curry, then add the raisins and coconut. Cook for about 15 minutes at simmering level and then add your chick peas and cook for a further 10 minutes. Shortly before the end of cooking time put some frozen peas in, as these will go mushy if overcooked. Add salt to taste. We like this best with white basmati rice, and lots of little toppings.

Ideas for toppings are chopped fresh tomato, cucumber, sliced banana (yes this does work!), sunflower seeds, avocado, in fact anything you fancy! My kids love these all put in small separate bowls so they can help themselves.

Smokey Seafood Risotto

Don't worry the seafood here is Arame, a sea vegetable!

Ingredients:

A little sunflower oil

1 onion

2 or 3 cloves of garlic

1 block of smoked tofu

a good handful of dried arame

500g/18 oz/2 cups basmati rice (this makes a large potful to feed a family - reduce the amount of rice and water accordingly if you want)

a cupful of frozen peas

Seasalt to taste

Water to cover

Fry the onion and garlic in the oil for a few minutes. Chop the tofu into small cuboids and add to the onion and garlic. Add the rice and mix well then add enough water to well cover the rice.

Add the arame (you may need to add more water as seaweeds vary in how absorbent they are) and the seasalt. Bring to the boil then turn down to simmer. A few minutes before the end of cooking time add the peas. Nice served with a green salad.

Mediterranean Roast Vegetables

Ingredients:

2 yellow peppers

2 red peppers

3 or 4 parsnips

3 or 4 carrots

half a cup of sunflower oil

3 cloves of garlic

a good handful of basil

Seasalt

Cut the peppers into chunks and scrape and do the same with the carrots and parsnips. Crush the garlic and tear the basil. Mix into the oil. Thoroughly coat the vegetables in the oil mixture and place on a roasting tray. Sprinkle with seasalt and roast for about half to three quarters of an hour at 190C/380F. Lovely as an accompaniment to main dishes such as nut roast, baked potatoes and casseroles.

Basic Baked Potatoes

Ingredients:

Large baking potatoes

Olive oil

Seasalt

Wash the potatoes well and then prick all over with a fork. Coat them with the oil and salt - messy but fun! Bake in the oven for about 1 hour and 15 minutes at 180C/360F. Alternatively you can cook these in a microwave in minutes (follow manufacturers guidelines for timing). Nice served with a green salad and your choice of topping or filling.

Suggested toppings:

Baked beans, hummus, casserole, vegan cheese mixed with soy mayo and chopped spring onions, curry, sweetcorn, stir fried veg - let your imagination run wild!! Don't miss the salads section for ideas too.

Garlic bread

A good accompaniment for many of the above meals - shop bought ones are almost always made with butter so we make our own vegan version.

Ingredients:

2 or 3 half baked baguettes

1 cup of vegan margarine

3 or 4 cloves of garlic, crushed

2 tablespoons of chopped parsley

Slice the baguettes widthwise (about 3cm. thick works well) carefully leaving the bottom intact (so they are still in their loaf shape). Mash the margarine with the garlic and parsley. Spread both sides of each slice with the margarine mixture then wrap the baguettes in tin foil and bake in the oven at 180c/360F for about 15 minutes.

A garlic free alternative would be to use different fresh, chopped herbs in the margarine instead of garlic for a herby bread.

Vegetable Pilau

A popular vegetable rice dish that makes a tasty light supper.

Ingredients:

Serves 4-6

225 g/8 oz/1 cup basmati rice

30 ml/2 tbsp oil

2.5 ml/1/2 tsp cumin seeds

2 bay leaves

4 green cardamom pods

4 cloves

1 onion, finely chopped

1 carrot, finely diced

50 g/2 oz//3 cup frozen peas, thawed

50 g/2 oz/ 1/3 cup frozen sweetcorn, thawed

25 g/l oz//4 cup cashew nuts, lightly fried

1.5 ml/1/4 tsp ground cumin

Salt

1-Wash the basmati rice in several changes of cold water. Put into a bowl and cover with water. Leave to soak for about 30 minutes.

2-Heat the oil in a large frying pan and fry the cumin seeds for 2 minutes. Add the bay leaves, cardamoms and cloves and fry for a further 2 minutes.

3-Add the onion and fry for 3 minutes, until softened and lightly browned.

4-Stir in the carrot and cook for 3-4 minutes.

5-Drain the rice and add to the pan together with the peas, sweetcorn and cashew nuts. Fry for 4-5 minutes.

6-Add 475 ml/16 fl oz/2 cups water, ground cumin and salt. Bring to the boil, cover and simmer for 15 minutes over a low heat until all the water is absorbed. Leave to stand, covered, for 10 minutes, before serving.

Red Pepper Risotto

The character of this delicious risotto depends on the type of rice you use. With arborio rice, the risotto should be moist and creamy. If you use brown rice, reduce the amount of liquid for a drier dish with a nutty flavour.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

3 large red peppers

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

3 large garlic cloves, thinly sliced

1 1/2 x 400 g/14 oz cans chopped tomatoes

2 bay leaves

1.2-1.5 litres/2-2 1/2 pints/5-6 1/4 cups vegetable stock

450 g/1 lb/2 1/2 cups arborio rice or brown rice

6 fresh basil leaves, snipped

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Preheat the grill. Put the peppers in a grill pan and grill until the skins are blackened and blistered all over. Put the peppers in a bowl, cover with several layers of damp kitchen paper and leave for 10 minutes. Peel off the skins, then slice the peppers, discarding the cores and seeds.

2-Heat the oil in a wide, shallow pan. Add the garlic and tomatoes and cook over a gentle heat for 5 minutes, then add the pepper slices and bay leaves. Stir well and cook for 15 minutes more, still over a gentle heat.

3-Pour the stock into a large, heavy-based saucepan and heat it to simmering point. Stir the rice into the vegetable mixture and cook for about 2 minutes, then add two or three ladlefuls of the hot stock. Cook, stirring occasionally, until all the stock has been absorbed into the rice.

4-Continue to add stock in this 4way, making sure each addition has been absorbed before pouring in the next. When the rice is tender, season with salt and pepper. Remove the pan from the heat, cover and leave to stand for 10 minutes before stirring in the basil and serving.

Risotto alla Milanese

This traditional Italian risotto is rich and creamy, and deliciously flavoured with garlic, shavings of Parmesan and fresh parsley.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

2 garlic cloves, crushed

60 ml/4 tbsp chopped fresh parsley finely grated rind of 1 lemon

For the risotto

5 ml/1 tsp (or 1 sachet) saffron strands

25 g/1 oz/2 tbsp butter

1 large onion, finely chopped

275 g/10 oz/1 1/2 cups arborio rice

150 ml/ 1/4 pint/2/3 cup dry white wine

1 litre/1 3/4 pints/4 cups vegetable stock

Parmesan cheese shavings, to serve

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Mix together the garlic, parsley and lemon rind in a bowl. Reserve and set aside.

2-To make the risotto, put the saffron in a small bowl with 15 ml/1 tbsp boiling water and leave to stand while the saffron is infused. Melt the butter in a heavy-based frying saucepan and gently fry the onion for 5 minutes, until softened and golden.

3-Stir in the rice and cook for about 2 minutes until it becomes translucent. Add the wine and saffron mixture and cook for several minutes until all the wine is absorbed.

4-Add 600 ml/ 1 pint/2 1/2 cups of the stock to the pan and simmer gently until the stock is absorbed, stirring frequently.

5-Gradually add more stock, a ladleful at a time, until the rice is tender. (The rice might be tender and creamy before you've added all the stock, so add it slowly towards the end of the cooking time.)

6-Season the risotto with salt and pepper and transfer to a serving dish. Scatter lavishly with shavings of Parmesan cheese and the garlic and parsley mixture.

Vegetable Chilli

This alternative to traditional chilli con carne is delicious served with brown rice.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

2 onions, chopped

1 garlic clove, crushed

3 sticks celery, chopped

1 green pepper, seeded and diced

225 g/8 oz mushrooms, sliced

2 courgettes, sliced

400 g/14 oz can red kidney beans, rinsed and drained

400 g/14 oz can chopped tomatoes

150 ml/1/4 pint//3 cup passata

30 ml/2 tbsp tomato puree

15 ml/1 tbsp tomato ketchup

1 tsp each hot chilli powder, ground cumin and ground coriander

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

natural yogurt and cayenne pepper, to serve

Sprigs of fresh coriander, to garnish

1-Put the onions, garlic, celery, green pepper, mushrooms and courgettes in a large saucepan and mix together.

2-Add the kidney beans, tomatoes, passata, tomato puree and tomato ketchup.

3-Add the spices, season with salt and pepper and mix well.

4-Cover, bring to the boil and simmer for 20-30 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the vegetables are tender. Serve with natural yogurt, sprinkled with cayenne pepper. Garnish with fresh coriander sprigs.

The colours in this aromatic stir-fry are as pleasing to the eye as the flavours are to the palate. Serve with noodles or egg-fried rice.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

10 ml/2 tsp ground cumin

15 ml/ 1 tbsp paprika

5 ml/1 tsp ground ginger

good pinch of cayenne pepper

15 ml/ 1 tbsp caster sugar

275 g/ 10 oz tofu (beancurd)

60 ml/4 tbsp oil

2 garlic cloves, crushed

1 bunch spring onions, sliced

1 red pepper, seeded and sliced

1 yellow pepper, seeded and sliced

225g/8 oz/generous 3 cups brown-cap mushrooms, halved or quartered if necessary

1 large courgette, sliced

115 g/4 oz fine green beans, halved

50 g/2 oz/scant

1/2cup pine nuts

15 ml/ 1 tbsp lime juice

15ml/1 tbsp clear honey

Salt and pepper

1-Mix together the cumin, paprika, ginger, cayenne and sugar with plenty of seasoning. Cut the tofu into cubes and coat them in the spice mixture.

2-Heat some of the oil in a wok or large frying pan. Cook the tofu over a high heat for 3-4 minutes, turning occasionally (take care not to break up the tofu too much). Remove with a slotted spoon. Wipe out the pan with kitchen paper.

3-Add the remaining oil to the pan and cook the garlic and spring onions for 3 minutes. Add the remaining vegetables and cook over a medium heat for 6 minutes, or until beginning to soften and turn golden. Season well.

4-Return the tofu to the pan with the pine nuts, lime juice and honey. Heat through and serve immediately.

Butternut Squash and Sage Pizza

The combination of sweet butternut squash, sage and sharp goat's cheese works wonderfully on this pizza.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

2.5 ml/1/2 tsp active dried yeast

pinch of granulated sugar

450 g/ 1 lb/4 cups strong white flour

5 ml/ 1 tsp salt

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

15 g/2 oz/1 tbsp butter

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

2 shallots, finely chopped

1 butternut squash, peeled, seeded and cubed, about 450 g/1 lb prepared weight

16 sage leaves

2 x 400 g/14 oz cans fresh tomato sauce

115 g/4 oz/1 cup mozzarella cheese, sliced

115 g/4 oz/1/2 cup firm goat's cheese

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Put 300 ml/1/2 pint/ 1 1/4 cups warm water in a measuring jug. Add the yeast and sugar and leave for 5-10 minutes, until it is frothy.

2-Sift the flour and salt into a large bowl and make a well in the centre. Gradually pour in the yeast mixture and the olive oil. Mix to make a smooth dough. Knead on a lightly floured surface for about 10 minutes until smooth, springy and elastic. Place the dough in a floured bowl, cover and leave to rise in a warm place for 1 1/2 hours.

3-Preheat the oven to 200°C/ 400°F/Gas 6. Oil four baking sheets. Put the butter and oil in a roasting tin and heat in the oven for a few minutes. Add the shallots, squash and half the sage leaves. Toss to coat. Roast for 15-20 minutes, until tender.

4-Raise the oven temperature to 220°C/425°F/Gas 7. Divide the dough into four equal pieces and roll out each piece on a floured surface to a 25 cm/ 10 in round.

5-Transfer each round to a baking sheet and spread with tomato sauce, leaving a 1 cm/ 1/2 in border all around. Spoon the squash and shallot mixture over the top. Arrange the mozzarella over the squash mixture and crumble the goat's cheese over. Scatter the remaining sage leaves over and season with plenty of salt and pepper. Bake for 15-20 minutes, until the cheese has melted and the crusts are golden.

Harvest Vegetable and Lentil Casserole

Take advantage of root vegetables in season to produce a hearty dish that's not only full of natural goodness but delicious too.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

15 ml/ 1 tbsp sunflower oil

2 leeks, sliced

1 garlic clove, crushed

4 celery sticks, chopped

2 carrots, sliced

2 parsnips, diced

1 sweet potato, diced

225 g/ 8 oz swede, diced

175 g/6 oz whole brown or green lentils

450 g/ 1 lb tomatoes, skinned, seeded and chopped

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh thyme

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh marjoram

900 ml/1 1/2 pints/3 3/4 cups vegetable stock

15 ml/1 tbsp cornflour

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Sprigs of fresh thyme, to garnish

1-Preheat the oven to 180°C/350°F/Gas 4. Heat the oil in a flameproof casserole over moderate heat. Add the leeks, garlic and celery and cook gently for 3 minutes.

2-Add the carrots, parsnips, sweet potato, swede, lentils, tomatoes, herbs, stock and seasoning. Stir well. Bring to the boil, stirring occasionally.

3-Cover and bake in the oven for about 50 minutes, until the vegetables and the lentils are cooked and tender. While it is cooking, remove the casserole from the oven and stir the vegetable mixture once or twice so that it is evenly cooked.

4-Remove the casserole from the oven. Blend the cornflour with 45 ml/3 tbsp water in a bowl. Stir into the casserole and heat, stirring continuously, until the mixture comes to the boil and thickens. Simmer gently for 2 minutes.

5-Spoon the vegetable mixture into 5 bowls and serve garnished with thyme sprigs.

Tagliatelle with Spinach Gnocchi

Gnocchi are extremely smooth and light and make a delicious accompaniment to this pasta dish.

Ingredients:

Serves 4-6

450 g/1 lb mixed flavoured tagliatelle shavings of Parmesan cheese, to garnish

For the spinach gnocchi

450 g/1 lb frozen chopped spinach

1 small onion, finely chopped

1 garlic clove, crushed

1.5 ml/1/4tsp ground nutmeg

400 g/ 1 4 oz low-fat cottage cheese

115 g/4 oz dried white breadcrumbs

75 g/3 oz semolina or plain flour

50 g/2 oz grated Parmesan cheese

For the tomato sauce

1 onion, finely chopped

1 stick celery, finely chopped

1 red pepper, seeded and diced

1 garlic clove, crushed

150 ml/ ¼ pint/ 2/3 cup vegetable stock

400 g/14 oz can tomatoes

15 ml/ 1 tbsp tomato puree

10 ml/2 tsp caster sugar

5 ml/1 tsp dried oregano

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-To make the tomato sauce, put the chopped onion, celery, pepper and garlic into a non-stick pan. Add the stock, bring to the boil and cook for 5 minutes or until tender.

2-Add the tomatoes, tomato 2pur6c, sugar and oregano. Season to taste, bring to the boil and simmer for 30 minutes until thick, stirring occasionally.

3-Put the spinach, onion and garlic into a saucepan, cover and cook until the spinach is increase the heat. Season with salt, pepper and nutmeg. Cool in a bowl. Mix in the remaining ingredients. Shape into about 24 ovals and refrigerate for 30 minutes.

4-Cook the gnocchi in boiling salted water for about 5 minutes. Remove with a slotted defrosted. Remove the lid and spoon and drain. Cook the tagliatelle in a pan of boiling salted water until al dente. Drain. Transfer to serving plates, top with gnocchi, the tomato sauce and 3 egg whites shavings of Parmesan cheese.

Pizza with Fresh Vegetables

This pizza can be made with any combination of fresh vegetables. Most will benefit from being blanched or sauteed before being baked on the pizza.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

400 g/ 14 oz peeled plum tomatoes, fresh or canned, weighed whole, without extra juice

2 medium broccoli spears

225 g/8 oz fresh asparagus

2 small courgettes

75 ml/5 tbsp olive oil

50 g/2 oz//3 cup shelled peas, fresh or frozen

4 spring onions, sliced

1 pizza base,

25-30 cm/10-12 in in diameter

75 g/3 oz//3 cup mozzarella cheese, cut into small dice

10 leaves fresh basil, torn into pieces

2 cloves garlic, finely chopped

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Preheat the oven to 240°C/475°F/Gas 9 for at least 20 minutes before baking the pizza. Strain the tomatoes through the medium hole of a food mill, scraping in all the pulp.

2-Peel the broccoli stems and asparagus, and blanch with the courgettes in a pan of boiling water for 4-5 minutes. Drain. Cut into bite-size pieces and slice the courgettes lengthways.

3-Heat 30 ml/2 tbsp of the olive oil in a small saucepan. Stir in the peas and spring onions and cook for 5-6 minutes, stirring often. Remove from the heat.

4-Spread the puréed tomatoes on to the pizza dough, leaving the rim uncovered. Add the other vegetables, spreading them evenly over the tomatoes.

5-Sprinkle with the mozzarella, basil, garlic, salt and pepper and remaining olive oil. Immediately place the pizza in the oven. Bake for about 20 minutes, or until the crust is golden brown and the cheese has melted.

Aubergine Curry

A simple and delicious way of cooking aubergines, which retains their full flavour.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

2 large aubergines, about 450 g/lb each

45 ml/3 tbsp oil

2.5 ml/1/2 tsp black mustard seeds

1 bunch spring onions, finely chopped

115 g/4 oz button mushrooms, halved

2 garlic cloves, crushed

1 fresh red chilli, finely chopped

2.5 ml/ 1/2 tsp chilli powder

1 tsp ground cumin

1 tsp ground coriander

1.5 ml/ 1/4 tsp ground turmeric

5 ml/ 1 tsp salt

400 g/14 oz can chopped tomatoes

15 ml/ 1 tbsp chopped fresh coriander

sprigs of fresh coriander, to garnish

1-Preheat the oven to 200°C/ 400°F/Gas 6. Brush both of the aubergines with 15 ml/ 1 tbsp of the oil and prick with a fork. Bake in the oven for 30-35 minutes, until the aubergines are soft.

2-Meanwhile, heat the remaining oil in a saucepan and fry the mustard seeds for 2 minutes, until they begin to splutter.

3-Add the spring onions, mushrooms, garlic and chilli and fry for 5 minutes. Stir in the chilli powder, cumin, coriander, turmeric and salt and fry for 3-4 minutes. Add the tomatoes and simmer for 5 minutes.

4-Cut each of the aubergines in half lengthways and scoop out the soft flesh into a bowl. Mash the flesh briefly.

5-Add the mashed aubergine and fresh coriander to the saucepan. Bring to the boil and simmer for 5 minutes or until the sauce thickens. Serve garnished with coriander sprigs.

COOK'S TIP

If you want to omit some of the oil, wrap the aubergines in foil and bake in the oven for 1 hour.

Vegetable Korma

The blending of spices produces a subtle, aromatic curry.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

50 g/2 oz/4 tbsp butter

2 onions, sliced

2 garlic cloves, crushed

2.5 cm/ 1 in piece of fresh root ginger, grated

5 ml/ 1 tsp ground cumin

15 ml/1 tbsp ground coriander

6 cardamom pods

5 cm/2 in cinnamon stick

5 ml/1 tsp ground turmeric

1 fresh red chilli, seeded and finely chopped

1 potato, peeled and cut into

2.5 cm/ 1 in cubes

1 small aubergine, chopped

115 g/4 oz mushrooms, thickly sliced

115 g/4 oz/1 cup French beans, cut into 2.5 cm/1 in lengths

60 ml/4 tbsp natural yogurt

150 ml/1/4 pint/1/3 cup double cream

5 ml/1 tsp garam masala

Salt and freshly ground black pepper, Sprigs of fresh coriander, to garnish poppadums, to serve

1-Melt the butter in a heavy-based saucepan. Add the onions and cook for 5 minutes, until soft. Add the garlic and ginger and cook for 2 minutes, then stir in the cumin, coriander, cardamoms, cinnamon stick, turmeric and chilli. Cook, stirring, for 30 seconds.

2-Add the potato, aubergine and mushrooms and about 175 ml/ 6 fl oz/1/4 cup water. Cover the pan, bring to the boil, then lower the heat and simmer for 15 minutes. Add the beans and cook, uncovered, for 5 minutes.

3-With a slotted spoon, remove the vegetables to a warmed serving dish and keep hot. Allow the cooking liquid to bubble up until it reduces a little. Season with salt and pepper, then stir in the yogurt, cream and garam masala. Pour the sauce over the vegetables and garnish with coriander. Serve with poppadums.

VARIATION

Any combination of vegetables can be used for this korma, including carrots, cauliflower, broccoli, peas and chick-peas.

Stuffed Peppers

Stuffed Peppers Stuffed peppers are easy to make for a light and healthy supper.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

15 ml/ 1 tbsp olive oil

1 red onion, sliced

1 courgette, diced

115 g/4 oz mushrooms, sliced

1 garlic clove, crushed

400 g/ 14 oz can chopped tomatoes

15 ml/ 1 tbsp tomato puree

40 g/ 1 ½ oz/ scant 1/3 cup pine nuts

30 ml/2 tbsp chopped fresh basil

4 large yellow peppers

50 g/2 oz/1/2 cup red Leicester cheese, finely grated

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

fresh basil leaves, to garnish

1-Preheat the oven to 180oC/350oF/Gas 4. Heat the oil in a saucepan, add the onion, courgette, mushrooms and garlic and cook gently for 3 minutes, stirring occasionally.

2-Stir in the tomatoes and tomato puree, then bring to the boil and simmer, uncovered, for 10-15 minutes, stirring occasionally, until thickened slightly. Remove from the heat and stir in the pine nuts, basil and seasoning.

3-Cut the peppers in half lengthways and seed them. Blanch in a pan of boiling water for about 3 minutes. Drain.

4-Place the peppers in a shallow ovenproof dish and fill with the vegetable mixture.

5-Cover the dish with foil and bake for 20 minutes. Uncover, sprinkle each pepper with grated cheese and bake for a further 5-10 minutes, until the cheese is melted and bubbling. Garnish with basil leaves and serve.

V A R I A T I O N: Use the vegetable filling to stuff other vegetables, such as courgettes or aubergines, in place of the peppers.

Spicy Chick-pea and Aubergine Stew

This is a Lebanese dish that's full of the spicy flavours of the Middle East.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

3 large aubergines, cubed

200 g/7 oz/1 cup chick-peas, soaked overnight

60 ml/4 tbsp olive oil

3 garlic cloves, chopped

2 large onions, chopped

2.5 ml/1/2 tsp ground cumin

2.5 ml/1/2 tsp ground cinnamon

2.5 ml/1/2 tsp ground coriander

3 x 400 g/14 oz cans chopped tomatoes

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

For the garnish

30 ml/2 tbsp olive oil

1 onion, sliced

1 garlic clove, sliced

Sprigs of fresh coriander

1-Place the aubergines in a colander and sprinkle them with salt. Sit the colander in a bowl and leave for 30 minutes, to allow the bitter juices to escape. Rinse the aubergine with cold water and dry on kitchen paper.

2-Drain the chick-peas and put in a saucepan with enough water to cover. Bring to the boil and simmer for 1- 1 1/2 hours, or until tender. Drain.

3-Heat the oil in a large saucepan. Add the garlic and onion and cook until soft. Add the spices and cook, stirring, for a few seconds. Add the aubergine and stir. Cook for 5 minutes. Add the tomatoes and chick-peas and season with salt and pepper. Cover and simmer for 20 minutes.

4-To make the garnish, heat the oil in a frying pan and, when very hot, add the sliced onion and garlic. Fry until golden and crisp. Serve the stew with rice, topped with the onion and garlic and garnished with coriander.

Spicy Jacket Potatoes

Simple baked potatoes take on an exciting new character with the addition of a few herbs and spices.

Ingredients:

Serves 2-4

2 large baking potatoes

5 ml/ 1 tsp sunflower oil

1 small onion, finely chopped

2.5 cm/1 in piece fresh root ginger, grated

5 ml/1 tsp ground cumin

5 ml/l tsp ground coriander

2.5 ml/l/2 tsp ground turmeric garlic

Salt natural yogurt and sprigs of fresh coriander, to serve

1-Preheat the oven to 190oC/375oF/Gas 5. Prick the potatoes with a fork. Bake for 1 hour, or until soft.

2-Cut the potatoes in half and scoop out the flesh. Heat the oil in a non-stick frying pan and fry the onion for a few minutes to soften. Stir in the ginger, cumin, coriander and turmeric.

3-Stir over a low heat for about 2 minutes, then add the potato flesh and garlic salt, to taste.

4-Cook the potato mixture for a further 2 minutes, stirring occasionally. Spoon the mixture back into the potato shells and top each with a spoonful of natural yogurt and a sprig or two of fresh coriander. Serve hot.

Baked Leeks with Cheese and Yogurt

Like all vegetables, the fresher leeks are, the better their flavour, and the freshest leeks available should be used for this dish. Small, young leeks are around at the beginning of the season and are perfect to use here.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

25 g/1 oz/2 tbsp butter 8 small leeks, about 675 g/1 1/2 lb 2 small eggs or 1 large one, beaten 150 g/5 oz fresh goat's cheese

85 ml/3 fl oz/ 1/3 cup natural yogurt

50 g/2 oz Parmesan cheese, grated

25 g/1 oz/ 1/2 cup fresh white or brown breadcrumbs

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Preheat the oven to 180°C/350°F/Gas 4. Butter a shallow ovenproof dish. Trim the leeks, cut a slit from top to bottom and rinse well under cold water.

2-Place the leeks in a saucepan of water, bring to the boil and simmer gently for 6-8 minutes, until just tender. Remove and drain well using a slotted spoon. Arrange in the prepared dish.

3-Beat the eggs with the goat's cheese, yogurt and half the Parmesan cheese. Season well with salt and pepper. Suppers 140

4-Pour the cheese and yogurt mixture over the leeks. Mix the breadcrumbs and remaining Parmesan cheese together and sprinkle over the sauce. Bake for 35-40 minutes, until the top is crisp and golden brown.

Tagliatelle with Gorgonzola Sauce

Gorgonzola is a creamy Italian blue cheese. As an alternative you could use Danish Blue or Pipo Creme.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

25g/ 1 oz/2 tbsp butter, plus extra for tossing the pasta

225g/8oz Gorgonzola cheese

150ml/1/4pint/2/3cup double or whipping cream

30ml/2 tbsp dry vermouth

5ml/1 tsp cornflour

15ml/1 tbsp chopped fresh sage

450g/ 1 lb tagliatelle salt and ground black pepper

1-Melt 25g/1 oz/2 tbsp butter in a heavy saucepan (it needs to be thick-based to prevent the cheese from burning). Stir in 175g/6oz crumbled Gorgonzola cheese and stir over a gentle heat for about 2-3 minutes until melted.

2-Whisk in the cream, vermouth and cornflour. Add the sage; season. Cook, whisking, until the sauce boils and thickens. Set aside.

3-Boil the pasta in plenty of salted water according to the instructions on the packet. Drain well and toss with a little butter.

4-Reheat the sauce gently, whisking well. Divide the pasta among four serving bowls, top with the sauce and sprinkle over the remaining crumbled cheese. Serve immediately.

Pappardelle, with Beans and Mushrooms

A mixture of wild and cultivated mushrooms help to give this dish a rich and nutty flavour.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

30ml/2 tbsp olive oil

50g/2oz/4 tbsp butter

2 shallots, chopped

2-3 garlic cloves, crushed

675g/l ½ lb mixed mushrooms, thickly sliced

4 sun-dried tomatoes in oil, drained and chopped

90ml/6 tbsp dry white wine 400g/14 oz can borlotti beans, drained

45ml/3 tbsp grated Parmesan cheese chopped fresh parsley, to garnish

salt and ground black pepper cooked pappardelle, to serve

1-Heat the oil and butter in a frying pan and fry the shallots until they are soft.

2-Add the garlic and mushroom and fry for 3-4 minutes. Stir in the sun-dried tomatoes, wine and add seasoning to taste.

3-Stir in the borlotti beans and cook for 5-6 minutes, until most of the liquid has evaporated from the pan and the beans are warmed through.

4-Stir in the grated Parmesan cheese. Sprinkle with parsley and serve immediately with freshly cooked pappardelle.

Curly Spaghetti with Walnut and Cream

A classic Italian dish with a strong, nutty flavour, this should be served with a delicately flavoured salad.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

350g/12oz curly spaghetti (fusilli col buco)

50g/ 2 oz/ 1/2 cup walnut pieces

25g/1 oz/2 tbsp butter

300ml/ 1/2 pint/ 1/4 cups milk

50g/2 oz/1 cup fresh breadcrumb

25g/ 1 oz/2 tbsp freshly grated Parmesan cheese pinch of freshly grated nutmeg

salt and ground black pepper fresh rosemary sprigs, to garnish

1-Cook the pasta in plenty of boiling salted water according to the instructions on the packet. Meanwhile, preheat the grill.

2-Spread the walnuts evenly over the grill pan. Grill for about 5 minutes, turning occasionally until evenly toasted.

3-Remove the walnuts from the heat, place in a clean dish towel and rub away the skins. Roughly chop the nuts.

4-Heat the butter and milk in a saucepan until the butter is completely melted.

5-Stir in the breadcrumbs and nuts and heat gently for 2 minutes, stirring constantly until thickened.

6-Add the Parmesan cheese, nutmeg and seasoning to taste.

7-Drain the pasta thoroughly through a colander and toss in the sauce. Serve immediately, garnished with fresh sprigs of rosemary.

Roquefort and Walnut Pasta Salad

This is a simple earthy salad, relying totally on the quality of the ingredients. There is no real substitute for Roquefort - a blue-veined ewe's- milk cheese which comes from south-western France.

Ingredients:

Serves 4

225g/8oz pasta shapes

mixed salad leaves, such as rocket, curly endive, lamb's lettuce, baby spinach, radicchio, etc

30ml/2 tbsp walnut oil

60ml/4 tbsp sunflower oil

30ml/2 tbsp red wine vinegar or sherry vinegar

225g/8oz Roquefort cheese, roughly crumbled

115g/4oz/1 cup walnut halves salt and ground black pepper

1-Cook the pasta in plenty of boiling salted water according to the instructions on the packet. Drain well and cool. Wash and dry the salad leaves and place them in a large bowl.

2-Whisk together the walnut oil, sunflower oil, vinegar and salt and pepper to taste.

3-Pile the pasta in the centre of the leaves, scatter over the crumbled Roquefort and pour over the dressing.

4-Scatter over the walnuts. Toss just before serving.

COOK'S TIP:

Try toasting the walnuts under the grill for a couple of minutes to release the flavour

Chicory Soufflé

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-6

3 heads chicory salt juice

1 lemon

3 tbsp/40g/l ½ oz butter

3/8 cup/40g/l ½ oz flour

1 ¼ cups/300ml/10fl oz milk

½ cup/50g/2oz grated cheese

1-Heat the oven to 400oF/200oC/Gas 6. Trim the chicory and cook in salted water to which you have added the lemon juice. This will stop it discolouring.

2-When the chicory is tender, drain and set aside. When it is cool, press the water out from between the leaves with your fingers. Chop the chicory very finely.

3-Meanwhile, melt the butter in a heavy- bottomed pan. Stir in the flour. Remove from the heat and stir in the milk. Return from the heat and stir until the sauce has thickened. Add the cheese and cook for a further minute. Allow to cool.

4-When the sauce has cooled, mix in the chicory, then the egg yolks.

5-Whisk the whites until they form soft peaks and fold into the chicory mixture. Spoon into a greased souffle dish and sprinkle the top with breadcrumbs. Bake in the oven for 20-25 minutes until lightly set, well risen and golden on top. Serve this souffle with a strongly flavoured salad, such as watercress garnished with slivers of orange.

Sabzi Vegetable Cutlet

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-6

1 cup/100g/4oz beetroot, diced

1 cup/100g/4oz carrots, diced

2 cups/225g/8oz potatoes, diced

1 ½ cups/100g/4oz cabbage, shredded

½ tsp/2.5ml chilli powder

½ tsp/2.5ml ground roasted cumin salt and freshly ground black pepper Large pinch sugar

1 tbsp/15ml raisins (optional)

½ cup/50g/2oz flour

½ cup/120ml/4oz milk breadcrumbs

oil for deep frying

1-Boil the beetroot, carrots, potatoes and cabbage together until tender. Drain.

2-Mash the boiled vegetables with the chilli, roasted cumin, black pepper, salt, sugar and raisins. Divide into 12 balls and flatten. Chill for 1 hour.

3-Make a batter with the flour and milk and dip a cutlet in it. Then roll it in breadcrumbs until well coated.

4-Heat the oil in a large frying pan and fry the cutlets for 2-3 minutes turning once, until crisp and golden. Serve with coriander chutney.

Azuki Bean Burgers

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

1 cup/450g/8oz azuki beans

bay leaf

2 onions, chopped

3 cloves garlic, chopped

1-2 tbsp/15-30ml oil

4 carrots, peeled and grated juice 1 lemon

4 tbsp/60ml parsley, chopped

salt and freshly ground black pepper

soy sauce to taste beaten egg for binding wholewheat flour for coating

1-Soak the azuki beans overnight. Drain, then cook until tender in fresh water with a bay leaf added. Drain, reserving the liquid.

2-Fry the onion and garlic in oil until transparent. Add the carrot and lemon juice and sweat, covered, until soft.

3-Add the beans, mix well and purée in a blender, adding a little of the bean liquor if necessary to form a malleable consistency. Stir in the parsley, season and add soy sauce to taste. Stir in enough beaten egg to bind.

4-Form into balls or burgers, coat with flour and shallow fry until brown and crispy on the outside. Serve with homemade Marinara Sauce

Kidney Bean, Artichoke and Mushroom Casserole

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

1 cup/225g/8oz kidney beans

1-2 tbsp/15-30ml oil

1 large onion, chopped

1-2 cloves garlic, chopped

3 cups/175g/6oz mushrooms, sliced

1 cup/100g/4oz French beans, trimmed, cut in thirds and parboiled

1 ¾ cups/425g/15oz can artichoke hearts, drained

1 ¾ cups/425g/15oz can tomatoes, mashed

salt and freshly ground black pepper parsley

METHOD

1-Soak the kidney beans overnight and cook until tender.

2-Pre-heat the oven to 350oF/180oC/Gas4. Heat oil and fry onion and garlic until translucent. Add the mushrooms and stir- fry for 1-2 minutes until just soft.

3-Transfer all the ingredients to a casserole. Season well. Cover and bake for 30-40 minutes. Sprinkle with parsley and serve.

Bean Moussaka

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

1 cup/225g/8oz rose cocoa beans

1 large aubergine, thinly sliced

oil

1 large onion, chopped

2 cloves garlic, chopped

1 ¾ cups/425g/15oz can tomatoes, mashed

1 tbsp/15ml tomato paste

2 tsp/10ml fresh thyme, chopped

salt and freshly ground black pepper

milk 1/2 cup/50g/2oz grated Cheddar cheese grated nutmeg to taste salt and freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

1-Soak the beans overnight and cook until you can mash them with a fork. Drain.

2-Heat the oven to 350°F/180°C/Gas 4. Sprinkle the aubergine slices with salt and allow to stand in a colander for 30 minutes. Rinse and pat dry with kitchen paper. Heat some oil in a pan and fry aubergines gently until cooked. Set aside.

3-Add some more oil to the pan and fry the onion and garlic until translucent. Add the tomatoes, tomato paste, thyme and seasoning, and heat through, stirring. Mix in the beans. Set aside.

4-To make the cheese sauce, melt the butter in a thick-bottomed saucepan. Stir in the flour, then gradually add the milk, stirring all the time, until the sauce bubbles and thickens. Turn down the heat, add the cheese and stir till melted. Season with nutmeg and add salt and pepper to taste.

5-To assemble the dish, spread a layer of the bean mixture in the bottom of a casserole and top with aubergine slices. Spread thinly with cheese sauce. Continue to layer the ingredients until they are all used up, ending with a thick layer of the sauce. Bake in the oven to heat right through for 30-40 minutes and serve with a crisp green salad.

Bulghar Wheat Stuffed Peppers

INGREDIENTS Serves 4

5oz/150g bulghar wheat

2 red peppers, cut in half lengthways and seeded

2 yellow peppers, cut in half lengthways and seeded

1 tbsp/15ml sunflower oil

1 onion, chopped

½ cup/50g/2oz chopped hazelnuts

2/3 cup/75g/3oz chopped dried apricots

½ tsp/2.5ml powdered ginger 1tsp/5ml cardamon seeds, ground

2 tbsp/30ml coriander leaves, finely chopped

3 tbsp/45ml natural yoghurt

fresh coriander leaves

METHOD

1-Place the bulghar wheat in a bowl, pour over 1 ¼ cups/300ml/ ½ pt boiling water and leave to stand for 15 minutes.

2-Place the peppers in a shallow, lightly oiled ovenproof dish.

3-Place the remaining oil in a saucepan, add the onion and gently fry until softened. Stir in the bulghar wheat, hazelnuts, apricots, ginger and cardamon. Cook for 1 minute, stirring continuously.

4-Add the coriander and yoghurt, mix together and use to fill the pepper shells. Cover the dish tightly with aluminium foil and bake in a pre-heated oven at 375oF/ 190oC/Gas 5 for 30-35 minutes.

5-Serve immediately, garnished with coriander leaves.

Savoury Stuffed Vine Leaves

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

1 cup/225g/8oz brown rice olive oil

1 small onion, chopped

2 cloves garlic, chopped

salt and freshly ground black pepper

8oz/225g peeled bottled or canned chestnuts

1-2 tbsp/15-30ml butter

4oz/100g mushrooms

2 tomatoes, peeled and chopped 1tsp/5ml dried mixed herbs

20 vine leaves

METHOD

1-Wash the rice in several changes of cold water. Heat 1 tbsp/15ml oil in a heavy-bottomed pan and fry the onion and garlic until translucent. Stir in the rice and cook for a few minutes before covering with boiling water. (Use about 2/3 water to 1/3 rice by volume.) Bring back to the boil,

2-Meanwhile, drain the chestnuts and chop them finely. Heat the butter in a pan and add the mushrooms. When they are tender, add the tomatoes, chestnuts and herbs. Stir once or twice and remove from the heat.

3-When the rice is cooked, mix it thoroughly with the nut stuffing and check the seasoning. Use it, by the spoonful, to stuff the vine leaves. Pack them into an ovenproof dish, brush with olive oil and cover the dish with foil. Heat through in the oven. Stuffed vine leaves are best eaten hot, but they're good cold too, if you have any left over.

Potato Topped Vegetable pie

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-6

½ cup/75g/3oz green lentils

¼ cup/50g/2oz pot barley

1 onion, chopped

1 ¾ cups/425ml/15oz can chopped tomatoes

6oz/175g cauliflower florets

2 stalks celery, sliced

1 leek, thickly sliced

1 turnip, sliced

2 carrots, diced

2 tbsp/30ml fresh mixed herbs, chopped

1 ½ lb/750g potatoes, scrubbed

3 tbsp/45ml semi-skimmed milk

2 tbsp/25g/loz grated reduced fat

salt and freshly ground black pepper

medium hard cheese

1-Place the lentils, barley, onion, tomatoes, cauliflower, celery, leek, turnip, carrots and herbs in a large saucepan with 1 ¼ cup/ 300ml/ ½ pt water.

2-Bring to the boil, cover and simmer for 40-45 minutes or until everything is soft.

3-Cover potatoes with boiling water and cook for about 15 minutes, or until soft.

4-Drain, peel and mash the potatoes with the milk and season to taste.

5-Place the lentil mix in a pie dish and either pipe or fork the potato on top.

6-Sprinkle with cheese and place in a pre- heated oven at 400oF/200oC/Gas 6 for 30- 35 minutes.

Grilled Vegetable Terrine

Impress your guests with a colourful layered terrine using a mixture of Mediterranean vegetables.

Ingredients:

Serves 6

2 large red peppers, quartered, cored and seeded

2 large yellow peppers, quartered, cored and seeded

1 large aubergine, sliced lengthways

2 large courgettes, sliced lengthways

90 ml/6 tbsp olive oil

1 large red onion, thinly sliced

75 g/3 oz/1/2 cup raisins

15 ml/ 1 tbsp tomato puree

15 ml/1 tbsp red wine vinegar

400 ml/14 fl oz/1 1/3 cups tomato juice

15 g/1/2 oz/2 tbsp vegetarian gelatine

fresh basil leaves, to garnish

For the dressing

90 ml/6 tbsp olive oil

30 ml/2 tbsp red wine vinegar

salt and freshly ground blackpepper

1-Place the peppers skin side up under a hot grill and cook until blackened. Put in a bowl. Cover.

2-Arrange the aubergine and courgette slices on separate baking sheets. Brush them with oil and cook under the grill.

3-Heat the remaining olive oil in a frying pan. Add the onion, raisins, tomato puree and red wine vinegar. Cook until soft.

4-Line a 1.75 litre/3 pint/7 1/2 cup terrine with clear film.

5-Pour half the tomato juice into a saucepan. Sprinkle with the gelatine. Dissolve over a low heat.

6-Layer the red peppers in the terrine, and cover with some of the tomato juice and gelatine. Add the aubergine, courgettes, yellow peppers and onion mixture.

7-Pour tomato juice over each layer of vegetables and finish with another layer of red peppers.

8-Add the remaining tomato juice to any left in the pan and pour into the terrine. Give the terrine a sharp tap, to disperse the juice. Cover and chill in the refrigerator until set.

9-To make the dressing, whisk together the oil and vinegar. Season with salt and pepper.

10-Turn out the terrine and remove the clear film. Serve in thick slices, drizzled with dressing. Garnish with basil leaves.

Potato, Spinach and Pine Nut Gratin

Pine nuts add a satisfying crunch to this gratin of wafer-thin potato slices and spinach in a creamy cheese sauce. Serve with a simple lettuce and tomato salad.

Ingredients:

Serves 2

450 g/ 1 lb potatoes

1 garlic clove, crushed

3 spring onions, thinly sliced

150 ml/1/4 pint/1/3 cup single cream

250 ml/8 fl oz/1 cup milk

225 g/8 oz frozen chopped spinach, defrosted

115 g/4 oz Cheddar cheese, grated

40 g/ 1 1/2 oz/ scant 1/4 cup pine nuts

salt and freshly ground black pepper lettuce and tomato salad, to serve

1-Peel the potatoes and cut them carefully into wafer-thin slices. Spread them out in a large, heavy-bottomed, non-stick frying pan.

2-Sprinkle the crushed garlic and sliced spring onions evenly over the potatoes.

3-Pour the cream and milk over the potatoes. Place the pan over a gentle heat, cover and cook for 8 minutes, or until the potatoes are tender.

4-Using both hands, squeeze the spinach dry. Add the spinach to the potatoes, mixing lightly. Cover the pan and cook for 2 minutes more.

5-Season with salt and pepper, then spoon the mixture into a shallow, flameproof casserole. Preheat the grill.

6-Sprinkle the grated cheese and pine nuts over the spinach mixture. Heat under the grill for 2-3 minutes until the topping begins to turn golden. Serve with a lettuce and tomato salad.

Autumn Glory

Glorious pumpkin shells summon up the delights of autumn and seem too good simply to throw away. Use one instead as a serving dish. Pumpkin and pasta make marvelous partners, especially as a main course served from the baked shell

Ingredients:

Serves 4

1.75kg/4-4 1/2lb pumpkin

1 onion, sliced

2.5cm/ 1 in piece fresh root ginger

45ml/3 tbsp extra virgin olive oil

1 courgette, sliced

115g/4oz sliced mushrooms

400g/14oz can chopped tomatoes

75g/3oz pasta shells

450ml/1 1/4 pint/1 1/4 cups stock

60ml/4 tbsp fromage frais

30ml/2 tbsp chopped fresh basil

salt and ground black pepper

1-Preheat the oven to 180°C/ 350°F/Gas 4. Cut the top off the pumpkin with a large, sharp knife and scoop out and discard the pumpkin seeds.

2-Using a small sharp knife and a sturdy tablespoon, cut and scrape out as much flesh from the pumpkin shell as possible, then chop the flesh into rough chunks.

3-Bake the pumpkin with its lid on for 45 minutes until the inside begins to soften.

4-Meanwhile, make the filling. Gently fry the onion, ginger and pumpkin flesh in the olive oil for about 10 minutes, stirring the mixture occasionally.

5-Add the sliced courgette and mushrooms and cook for a further 3 minutes, then stir in the tomatoes, pasta shells and stock. Season well, bring to the boil, then cover the pan and simmer gently for about 10 minutes.

6-Stir the fromage frais and basil into the pasta and spoon the mixture into the pumpkin. It may not be possible to fit all the filling into the pumpkin shell, so serve the rest separately if necessary.

Hazelnut and Apricot Crunch

INGREDIENTS

makes about 16

8 tbsp/100g/4oz butter

1/3 cup/50g/2oz soft brown sugar

2 tbsp/30ml maple syrup

1/3 cups/100g/4oz porridge (rolled) oats

1/3 cup/50g/2oz chopped hazelnuts

½ cup/50g/2oz dried apricots, chopped

METHOD

1-Pre-heat the oven to 350oF/180oC/Gas 4. Put the butter, sugar and syrup in a heavy pan and stir over a low heat until combined.

Danish Apple Pie

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-6

Short crust pastry to line a pan approximately 19cm/7 1/2 in

5 medium/700g/1 1/2 lb cooking apples, peeled, cored and sliced

1/4 cup/50ml/2oz water

1/4 cup/50g/2oz sugar

1 tbsp//2oz butter

1 tsp/5ml ground cinnamon

1 cup/250ml/8fl oz soured cream

2 tbsp/30ml castor sugar

METHOD

1-Bake the pastry for 10 minutes at 350oF/ 180oC/Gas 4. Make a thick apple sauce using the apples, water, sugar, butter and half of the cinnamon. There shouldn't be any excess liquid when the apples are cooked, but if there is, cook for a few minutes more without a lid, stirring to prevent the apples sticking.

2-Let the apple sauce cool a little before turning into the pie shell. Spoon the soured cream on-er the apples. Mix the rest of the cinnamon with the sugar and sprinkle this over the soured cream. Bake at 400oF/ 200oC/Gas 6 for 30 minutes.

3-This is best served warm, rather than straight from the oven, but it is also good cold.

Fruit Tartlets

INGREDIENTS

Serves 6-8

6-8 small pie shells, baked

2/3 cup/100g/4oz cream cheese

½ tsp/2.5ml vanilla extract (optional)

1-2 tsp/5-10ml castor sugar

3-4 cups/450g/1 lb fresh fruit (raspberries, grapes, strawberries, redcurrants etc)

apricot jam to glaze

METHOD

1-Mix the cream cheese with the vanilla and just enough sugar to make a mixture the consistency of thick cream. Spoon into the baked and cooled pie shells. Cover the cream cheese with fresh fruit (de-pip the grapes). Melt a little apricot jam in a saucepan and brush over the fruit to glaze it.

2-Use a selection of different fruits to make an attractive plate of pastries. You could also make one large pie and fill the pie shell with alternate rings of different fruits.

Mushroom Pancakes

INGREDIENTS Serves 4

1 recipe pancakes

2 tbsp/25g/loz butter

1 large onion, finely chopped

4 cups/450g/l lb mushrooms, chopped

2 tbsp/2 5g/l oz canned red pimentos, finely chopped

2/3 cup/150ml/1/4 pt soured cream salt and freshly ground black pepper melted butter

METHOD

1-Make the pancakes and keep warm.

2-Melt the butter, and the onion and cook until it has softened but not browned. Add the mushrooms and cook until soft. Drain off excess liquid. Mix in the pimentos, soured cream, salt and pepper.

3-Put a spoonful of the mixture on to each pancake on the cooked side. Roll up the pancakes, tucking in the edges.

4-Place the rolled pancakes in a buttered oven dish, drizzle a little melted butter over the top. Warm through in the oven at 350°F/180°C/Gas 4 for 25 minutes.

5-Serve with more soured cream if desired.

Genoese Pasta with Pesto Sauce

INGREDIENTS Serves 4-6

2 tbsp/25g/1 oz fresh basil leaves

2 cloves garlic pinch salt

½ cup/50g/2oz pine kernels

½ cup/50g/2oz Parmesan cheese

½ cup/100ml/4fl oz olive oil

1 lb/450g spaghetti or tagliatelle, cooked and drained

2 tbsp/25g/1 oz butter

1-Blend the basil leaves in a liquidizer. Add the crushed cloves of garlic and olive oil. Process for a few seconds.

2-Gradually add the pine kernels, Parmesan cheese, season remembering that Parmesan has a salty taste. The consistency should be thick and creamy.

3-Melt the butter in the saucepan and reheat the cooked pasta. Remove from the heat and mix 2 tbsp/25g/1oz pesto with the pasta. Serve on individual plates with a spoonful of pesto on each helping. Parmesan can be added last.

NOTE

The pesto is never heated. It can be served at the table but make sure the pasta is hot.

Fettucini Romana

CREPE AND PASTA DISHES

INGREDIENTS Serves 4

1 lb/450g fettucini

4 tbsp/50g/2oz butter

1/2 tsp/2.5ml ground nutmeg

1/2 cup/150ml/1/2 pt cream

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 cup/100g/4oz Parmesan cheese

METHOD

1-Bring a well filled saucepan of salted water to the boil, add a few drops of oil and salt. Feed in the fettucini and cook until al dente - fresh pasta will only take about 2 minutes. Drain in a colander.

2-Melt the butter in the saucepan, add ground nutmeg. Pour in half the cream and stir until shiny and bubbles start to appear.

3-Add the fettucini and stir around in the pan. Pour in the remaining cream and cheese alternately, forking the pasta as it is mixed. Serve immediately.

NOTE

This is a real pasta-lovers' dish. To obtain best results use freshly grated Parmesan cheese rather than the commercially grated variety.

CREPE AND PASTA DISHES

Tagliatelle with Sweet Pepper Sauce

INGREDIENTS Serves 4

12oz/350g spinach tagliatelle noodles

2 tsp/10 ml oil

½ tsp/2.5ml salt

THE SAUCE

1 small firm red pepper

1 small green pepper

1 small yellow pepper

1-2 tbsp/15-30ml olive oil

1 onion, chopped

2 cloves garlic, chopped

1 1/2 cups/400g/15oz can tomatoes

1 tbsp/15ml tomato paste fresh basil leaves,

snipped salt and freshly ground black pepper

1-Trim and de-seed the peppers and cut into narrow strips. You can make the sauce with green peppers alone if you wish, but the red and yellow varieties are sweeter and make the dish look more colourful. Blanch the peppers for a minute in boiling salted water, refresh in cold water, then drain.

2-Heat the olive oil in a pan, add the garlic and onions and cook gently, stirring, until soft. Add the tomatoes, tomato paste and basil. Break up the tomatoes with a wooden spoon and simmer for about 5 minutes. Season to taste and blend the sauce in a blender. Return to the pan over a very low heat and add the peppers.

3-Cook the pasta in a large pan with plenty of water to which you have added a little oil and the salt. The water should be at a full rolling boil. The pasta will be ready in about 9 minutes. Drain and divide between individual warmed serving bowls.

4-Spoon the sauce over each helping of pasta and serve at once with Parmesan cheese.

Vegetarian Spaghetti Putanesca

INGREDIENTS Serves 4-6

1 onion, peeled and diced

2 tbsp/30ml oil

2 cloves garlic, crushed

1 carrot, scraped and chopped

1 1/2 cups/425g/15oz canned tomatoes

2 tomatoes, skinned and chopped

4 tbsp/60ml white wine

1 bay leaf

3-4 basil leaves or

1 tsp/15ml dried basil

salt and freshly ground pepper

1 tbsp/15ml capers, chopped

½ cup/50g/2oz stoned black olives

3 drops Tabasco sauce

1 tbsp/15ml freshly chopped parsley

450g/1 lb cooked spaghetti

grated Parmesan cheese to serve

1-Put the onion into the oil in a frying saucepan over a low heat. Allow to cook gently for 4 minutes, add the crushed garlic and carrots. Turn in the oil twice more.

2-Add the tomatoes, the white wine, bay leaf, basil and some seasoning. Bring to the boil and simmer for 30 minutes. Sieve or liquidize and return the sauce to the saucepan.

3-Add the chopped capers, chopped olives and the spicy Tabasco sauce. Re-heat and serve over the pasta, with Parmesan cheese.

Vegetarian Bolognese Sauce

INGREDIENTS Serves 4-6

1 ¼ cups/225g/8oz brown lentils

salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 bay leaf

1-2 tbsp/15-30ml olive oil

2 cloves garlic, chopped

1 onion, chopped

1 carrot, chopped

1 stick celery, chopped

1 ½ cups/400g/15oz can tomatoes, mashed

1 tbsp/15ml tomato paste

½ tsp/2.5ml dried mixed herbs

2 tbsp/30ml red wine

350g/12oz whole wheat or spinach pasta

1-Soak the lentils overnight and simmer in salted water with a bay leaf until they can be mashed with a fork. Drain and discard the bay leaf.

2-Heat the oil in a pan and fry the onions and garlic until translucent. Add the carrot and celery and cook for a further 2 minutes.

3-Add the tomatoes and a little juice. Add the remaining ingredients and the lentils. Simmer until the sauce is quite thick. Blend or part-blend in a blender.

4-Serve the sauce in healthy spoonfuls over the warmed cooked pasta.

HOT PASTA SALAD

INGREDIENTS Serves 4

2 cloves garlic

3 tbsp/45ml olive oil handful fresh basil leaves

1 tbsp/15ml grated Parmesan cheese

THE SALAD

4oz/100g Mozzarella cheese

1 lb/450g Mediterranean tomatoes

1 cup/75g/3oz black olives

salt and freshly ground black pepper

THE PASTA

12oz/350g spinach pasta twists

1 tsp/5ml olive oil

1-Chop the garlic and put it in a mortar. Pour in a little of the olive oil and pound it to a pulp. Gradually add the basil leaves and cheese with the rest of the oil, pounding all the time. You should have a thick paste.

2-Dice the Mozzarella. Peel the tomatoes by immersing them in boiling water until their skins burst. Chop them roughly. Mix the cheese, tomatoes and olives together and season.

3-Cook the pasta in boiling salted water, to which you have added a little olive oil, until al dente. Drain. Toss the pasta in the dressing. Pile it into four warmed serving bowls and top with the salad.

Spaghetti with Fresh Tomato and Basil Sauce

Serves 4

2 tsp/10ml olive oil

1 onion, chopped

4 stalks celery, chopped

1 green chilli, seeded and finely chopped

2 cloves garlic, crushed

2 ½ cups/700g/l ½ lb skinned and roughly chopped tomatoes

3 tbsp/45ml tomato puree

1 tbsp/15ml basil leaves, chopped

1 tbsp/15ml marjoram, chopped

12oz/350g whole wheat spaghetti or

60z/175g whole wheat spaghetti and

6oz/175g spaghetti Verdi

2/3 cup/50g/2oz black olives, stoned

3 tbsp/25g/l oz Parmesan cheese, grated

3 tbsp/25g/l oz pine kernels basil sprigs

1-Heat the oil in a saucepan, add the onion, celery, chilli and garlic and fry until soft. Add the tomatoes and tomato puree, 4 tbsp/60ml water, half the basil and marjoram. Bring to the boil and simmer for 10 minutes.

2-Place the whole wheat spaghetti in a large saucepan of boiling lightly salted water and cook for 12 minutes, or until just tender. Add the spaghetti verdi, if using, 2 minutes after the whole wheat spaghetti.

3-Drain the pasta and divide between 4 individual warmed plates. Stir the olives and remaining basil into the sauce and place on top of the spaghetti.

4-Sprinkle with cheese and nuts, garnish with basil sprigs and serve.

Fruit Strudel

Ingredients.

1 block of frozen puff pastry (about 500g), defrosted

100g/4oz/half a cup of sugar

a little soya milk for sealing and glazing

2 cups of fruit - red and black currants are great in the summer, apples go well in autumn

Preheat oven to 180C/360F. Roll the pastry into one wide rectangle and place the fruit and sugar in a line in the middle. Lift up the edges and crimp together using the soya milk. Seal up the ends and glaze the top with soya milk. You can also sprinkle a couple of teaspoons of sugar over the top. Bake in the oven for 25-35 minutes or until the pastry is cooked. Great served with soya cream or Swedich Glace ice cream.

Vanilla Sponge with chocolate chips and pecans

I used a 8" square tin for this cake but any shape you like would be fine. Ingredients.

300g/12oz/2 cups of self raising flour

1 teaspoon of bicarbonate of soda

100g/4oz/half a cup of sugar

1 cup/8 fl.oz/200ml of sunflower oil

1 cup of soya milk (or possibly a little more to get a good mixture)

2 teaspoons of natural vanilla extract

50g./2 oz./quarter cup chocolate chips (or more if you like!)

50g/2 oz/half a cup of pecan halves

Oil your cake tin and preheat oven to 180C/360F. Mix together your dry ingredients of flour, sugar and bicarbonate. Make a well in the middle and pour in the oil, soya milk and vanilla - mix well. Pour into cake tin and then sprinkle on the chocolate chips and arrange the pecans on top. Bake for about half an hour or until cooked in middle (insert a knife or skewer into the centre of cake and if cooked it will come out clean)

Pear and Apple Upside Down Cake

These quantities make a very large cake - we used a 10" deep round tin. Great for keeping in the fridge and having as a pudding with custard or soya cream. Ingredients.

a large tin of pear halves in syrup (around 800g including syrup)

500g/16oz/2 and a half cups of self raising flour

1 teaspoon of bicarbonate of soda

200g/7oz/1 cup of sugar

1 cup/8 fl.oz/200ml of sunflower oil

2 and a half cups/20 fl.oz/500ml of apple juice

1 teaspoon of natural vanilla extract

a tablespoon of brown sugar for sprinkling

Oil your cake tin and preheat oven to 180C/360F. Arrange the pears, cut side down on the base of tin (in a star pattern was very pretty). Combine the dry ingredients (excluding the brown sugar) in a bowl then add the wet ingredients (including the syrup from the pears) and mix well. Pour over the pears and bake in the oven for about 45 minutes or until nearly cooked through. Remove from tin by placing an oven-proof plate over the tin and turning upside down so you have the pears on top. Sprinkle with the brown sugar and return to the oven for a further 10 minutes.

Apricot Flapjacks

Ingredients.

2 cups of oat flakes

2 tablespoons of golden syrup

1 tablespoon of vegan margarine

1 tablespoon of light brown sugar

about 10 dried apricots chopped up quite small

Melt the syrup, sugar and margarine together in a pan over a gentle heat. When thoroughly melted mix in the oats and apricots and press the mixture into an oiled cake tin. I find a 8 inch square tin does well. Bake in the oven for 10-20 minutes at 190C/380F or until just beginning to brown. Cut lines into the 'cake' while still warm. Cool and break into bars.

Little Sticky Lemon Cakes

Ingredients.

6oz/200g./1 and a half cups of self raising flour

4oz./125g./half cup caster sugar

1 teaspoon raising agent

the juice and rind of 1 lemon half a cup of sunflower oil

1 cup of soya milk (water or rice milk can be used instead)

dash of vinegar

half a cup of white icing sugar and a little boiled water, still hot paper cake cases (will make 12-20 depending on the size of case)

Mix the flour, sugar and raising agent together then add the oil, lemon juice, rind and soya milk and mix well. Add the vinegar and stir. Divide the mixture between the cake cases (a couple of

dessert spoons of mixture in each one) and bake for 15-20 minutes at 200C/400F. To make the icing: sift the icing sugar and add a small amount of very hot water and stir well. Start with a

teaspoon full and keep adding and stirring until you get a gooey, spreadable icing. Once the cakes have cooled spread a little icing on each one and leave to set.

Tofu Cheesecake.

This pudding is high in calcium and protein and depending on the variety you choose could also be a good source of vitamin C and potassium.

Ingredients.

200g/7oz/1 and 3 quarters cup of vegan digestive biscuits (graham crackers in the US) or

bourbons for the chocolate variety

150g/.5 oz/half a cup vegan margarine

1 block of tofu - about 400g/12 oz/1 and a quarter cups (silken is best for this recipe but other forms will do)

1 banana

1 cup of orange juice

4 Tbspoons of sugar

4 Tbspoons of sunflower oil

For chocolate variety: 2 Tbspoons of cocoa

For fruit variety: some fruit stewed with a little sugar

Crush the digestive biscuits and melt the margarine and then mix these two ingredients together. Press this mixture into a large flat dish. Combine the tofu, banana, orange juice, sugar, oil, and cocoa (for chocolate only) in a blender until smooth and pour onto the base. Bake in oven at 180 degrees for about half an hour. For the fruit variety, allow the cake to cool slightly then pour the stewed fruit with sugar over the top and chill. This can be topped with all raw fruit instead (kiwi, tangerine slices etc).

Wheat-free Apple Layer Cake

A low-fat, moist cake using soya and rice flours. Nice served as a pudding with soya yoghurt.

Ingredients.

6oz/200g./1 and a half cups of rice flour

2oz./50g./scant cup soya flour

4oz./125g./half cup caster sugar

1 teaspoon wheat free raising agent

2 large eating apples (peeled, cored and thinly sliced)

1 cup water

1/4 cup of apple juice

2 tablespoons of sunflower oil

a few drops of vanilla extract (optional)

dash of vinegar

brown granulated sugar for sprinkling on top

Mix the dry ingredients together then add the water, juice, oil, vanilla and mix well. Add the vinegar and stir. Pour half the cake batter into a greased square cake tin (9x9 inches or 20x20 cm approx. works well). Spread the apple slices evenly over the batter and then top with the remaining mixture and sprinkle with the brown sugar. Bake in an oven pre-heated to 180c/360F for about 40 minutes or until firm.

Chocolate-Banana pudding

This is a 'stodgy, cakey pud' - nice served with vegan ice cream, soy cream or custard. Good for using up overly ripened bananas.

Ingredients.

4oz/125g./scant half cup vegan margarine

4oz./125g./half cup sugar

4oz/125g./three quarters of a cup self-raising flour

1 tablespoon of cocoa

2 ripe bananas

1 cup soya milk

Mash the marg., sugar, bananas, cocoa and flour together in an oven proof bowl, and then use the soya milk to mix everything together well. You may need to add a little more soya milk to get a good cake-mix type consistency. Bake (yes - in the bowl) at 200C/400F for about 20 minutes until cooked.

Jam Roly Poly Pudding

Adrian warns 'Go easy with the roly poly - it has about 10 billion calories!'

Ingredients.

8oz/250g./generous 1 and a half cups of self raising flour

4oz./100g/scant half cup of vegetable suet

half to a third of a jar of jam (usually raspberry or strawberry) (jam translates as jelly for the USA)

Preheat oven to GM 6 / 400 °F / 200 °C.

Mix flour and suet in a bowl. Add a little water to form a dough (not too much so it isn't sticky). Roll out to a square shape and spread with jam. Roll up into a sausage shape and sprinkle sugar on the top. Bake at top of oven for around 30-40 minutes until pastry is crisp and light brown. Serve with custard (Several brands of custard powder are vegan and can be made with soya milk.

Banana Muffins

Ingredients:

200g./7 oz/1 and a half cups of white flour

50g./2oz/third of a cup of caster sugar

1 and a half tea spoons of baking powder

3 fl oz/100ml of orange juice

3 fl.oz/100ml of sunflower oil

2 mashed bananas (over ripe is best)

some soya milk as required vanilla essence

dash of vinegar

Combine the dry ingredients in a bowl. Mix the wet ingredients - but not the vinegar - in a jug or bowl. Mix the two together and then stir in enough soya milk to make a smooth mixture and add the bananas, Finally add the dash of vinegar to get that lovely chemical reaction and mix well. This should make enough to fill 12 cake cases. It's a good idea to put them in a muffin or patty tin to help them keep their shape but not totally essential. Bake for 10 - 15 minutes at 190 degrees and then cool.

A healthier version is to use wholemeal flour and unrefined dark sugar. This is equally delicious, but they don't rise as much and don't impress non-vegan visitors quite as well!!

Wheat/sugar free banana and date cake

Ingredients:

8oz/250g/one and a half cups of wheat free flour (we used Doves Farm organic and gluten free flour which is a mix of rice, maize, buckwheat and potato flours)

2 tsp baking powder

7 or 8 large dates, soaked

half a cup of water

2 very ripe bananas, mashed

1 cup of rice milk

half a cup of sunflower oil

1 tablespoon of vinegar

Mix the flour and baking powder. Liquidise the soaked dates in the half cup of water until fairly thick and smooth. Add the date mixture to the flour along with the rice milk, oil and bananas. Mix well - you may need to add a little more water or rice milk as wheat free flours do vary greatly and tend to absorb more liquid than wheat. Add the vinegar at the last minute and then pour into 9"/18cm cake tin and bake at 190C/380F for about 40 minutes or until cooked through.

Catriona's Ginger and Macadamia fingers

Ingredients:

4oz/120g./scant half cup vegan margarine

2oz/55g./generous quarter cup caster sugar

5oz/150g./1 cup self-raising flour

1 teaspoon of ground ginger

for the topping:

4oz/120g./half a cup icing sugar

3oz/90g./third of a cup vegan margarine

2 tablespoons of golden syrup

5oz/150g./quarter of a cup macadamia nuts, toasted and chopped

2oz/50g./eighth of a cup finely chopped glaze or stem ginger

Heat oven to 180C. Grease a 20x 30 cm tin and line base and sides. Allow an extra 2cm above each edge. Beat margarine and sugar until light and fluffy. Add sifted flour and ground ginger. Mix until combined. Spread on tin and bake for 15 minutes until lightly browned. Cool in pan. For topping: Combine sifted icing sugar, margarine and syrup in a saucepan and melt. Stir in the chopped nuts and ginger. Pour on top of the pre-cooked base and bake for a further 10 minutes. Cool in tin before cutting.

Catriona's Caramel Slices

Ingredients:

7oz/200g./1 cup vegan margarine

4oz/100g./half a cup of sugar

7oz/200g./1 and a half cups self-raising flour

1 and a half teaspoons of ground cinnamon

for the topping:

16oz/450g./2 cups icing sugar

3oz/75g./third of a cup vegan margarine

1 tablespoons of cinnamon

4 tablespoons of golden syrup

Heat oven to 180C. Grease a 20x 30 cm tin and line base and sides. Allow an extra 2cm above each edge. Beat margarine and sugar until light and fluffy. Add sifted flour and ground cinnamon. Mix until combined. Spread on tin and bake for 15 minutes until lightly browned. Cool in pan.

For Topping Combine sifted icing sugar, margarine and syrup in a saucepan and melt. Stir in the cinnamon. Pour on top of the pre-cooked base. Cool in tin before cutting into slices.

Sandra's Versatile Fruit loaf

This can be eaten just as it is, or sliced and spread with vegan margarine, or marg and jam, and if you get fed up of it then use it as a pudding with custard or vegan cream poured over (that is why it is called "versatile" because it is).

Ingredients.

12oz/350g/2 and a half cups self raising flour (or 12 oz plain with 3tsp baking powder added.)

12 oz/350g./2 and a half cups mixed dried fruit

1/2 pint/1 cup/250 ml. tea

4 oz/100g./1 cup sugar (white is ok, brown better and muscavado is the biz)

2 tablespoons soya flour mixed with enough water to make a "single cream" type consistency (sorry about using the C for cream word, but don't know how to describe it otherwise).

Soak the sugar and fruit in the tea for a minimum of 2 hours, but the longer the better and overnight is ok.

Put oven on at between reg.2 and 3/150C/300F.

Grease a loaf tin with vegan margarine.

Add the flour and soya mix, till all incorporated, then put in the tin and bake for about 2 hours. I

test to see if it is cooked by putting a skewer or thin blade knife in, and if it comes out clean the cake is done. Turn out on rack to cool.

Carol's Banana Shake

Ingredients.

1 ripe banana

1 pint/2 and a half cups soya milk

2 tablespoons natural soya yoghurt

2 tablespoons vegan vanilla ice cream

Whiz together and serve over ice. Very nice!

Banana Ice Lollies

Ingredients.

2 or 3 bananas

lolly sticks (you can substitute cocktail sticks for older children)

optional coverings:

melted chocolate or maple syrup

dried coconut sesame seeds chopped nuts

vermicelli (hundreds and thousands - some brands are vegan)

Cut the bananas into bite size chunks and push the lolly sticks into them. Place in the freezer on a covered freezer proof dish for a couple of hours or until frozen. They are delicious just like that but if you prefer a bit of decadence: dip each lolly in chocolate or syrup (be quick - it sets quite fast!) and then into dry ingredients of your choice (chopped nuts are our favourite). Perfect for

all those wonderful long summer days that are coming (positive thinking)

Chocolate Pudding

2 c nonfat milk

3/4 c black chocolate sauce

1/8 ts salt

3 tb sugar

1/4 c nonfat milk

3 tb plus 2 t cornstarch

1 ts vanilla

1. In top of double boiler over boiling water, combine milk, chocolate sauce (separate recipe), salt and sugar.
2. Bring just to a boil. Reduce heat to medium. Combine 1/4 c milk and cornstarch, stirring till smooth.
3. With wire whisk stirring constantly, add cornstarch mixture to chocolate mixture; it will thicken very quickly.
4. Reduce heat to low, cover and cook another 10 minutes.
5. Remove from heat, add vanilla and chill.

Chocolate Grand Mariner Souffle`

1 cup Chocolate or carob chips
1 pound Firm tofu (water packed)
1/2 cup Cocoa or carob powder
3/4 cup Honey
3 tablespoons Grand marnier
1 teaspoon Vanilla
1/2 cup Soy milk
1/2 cup Unbleached white flour
1 teaspoon Baking powder

1. Preheat oven to 350F. Place chocolate chips or carob in a bowl & place it in hot water to melt stirring with a spoon.
2. Place remaining ingredients in a food processor & blend till smooth & creamy.
3. Add melted chocolate & puree a few moments. Pour into a very lightly oiled 1-quart souffle dish.
4. Bake for 40 to 45 minutes, or until the souffle has completely puffed up.

Cool for 5 minutes.

Carob Brownies

2 cups Whole-wheat pastry flour

1/3 cup Carob powder

2 teaspoons Baking powder

1/3 cup Honey

1/2 cup Unsweetened applesauce

1 cup Water

1 teaspoon Vanilla -- 1/2 tsp if Watkins

1/4 cup Chopped nuts (optional)

1. In a large mixing bowl, combine flour, carob powder and baking powder.
2. In a separate bowl, thoroughly mix remaining ingredients, except nuts.
3. Add dry ingredients to wet ingredients and mix well. Stir in nuts if desired.
4. Pour batter into a nonstick or lightly oiled 8-inch square baking dish.

Bake at 350 for 35 minutes. Makes 16 brownies.

Black Forest Cake

CAKE

1 cup Water

1 cup Honey 1/2 cup Applesauce

1 teaspoon Vanilla

1 teaspoon Vinegar

2 cups Wholewheat pastry flour or -- - unbleached white flour

3/4 cup Cocoa powder

1 tablespoon Baking powder

1 teaspoon Baking soda

SYRUP

1/2 cup Water

1/4 cup Honey

2 each Thin lemon or orange slices

1/3 cup Kirsch

ICING

3/4 cup Raw cashews

3/4 cup Water

2 teaspoons Vanilla

1/2 cup Honey

10 ounces Firm tofu

3 ounces Semi-sweet chocolate -- melted

16 ounces Jar pitted cherries -- drained

CAKE: Preheat oven to 350F. Combine liquid ingredients in a large bowl & whisk well. Sift dry ingredients together & whisk into liquid mixture. Pour into greased & floured 9" cake tin & bake for 35 minutes or until springy. Cool cake completely & remove from pan. With a serrated knife, cut cake horizontally to make 3 thin layers.

SYRUP: Combine first 3 ingredients in a small pot & boil for 3 minutes. Let cool & then add kirsch.

ICING: In a blender, combine cashews, water & vanilla. Blend till smooth & creamy. Add honey & tofu & blend again. Set aside 2 c for the vanilla icing to go on top & sides of cake. To the rest of the mixture, add melted chocolate & 3 tb of syrup. Blend till smooth. Chill both icings before using.

TO ASSEMBLE: Carefully remove the top two layers of cake. Brush some syrup onto bottom layer & spread half of chocolate icing over it. Place the middle cake layer on top & brush with syrup & icing. Put down a layer of cherries & dot with a little vanilla icing to help the top layer stick. Place the top layer on the cherries & brush again with syrup. Frost top & sides with vanilla icing. Decorate with cherries & pipe rosettes if desired. Chill several hours before serving. The cake can be kept covered if not being served till the following day. However, the frosting may discolour after about 3 days.

Rhubarb Cream Jelly

INGREDIENTS

serves 6

2 1/2 cups/600ml/1 pt yoghurt

4 cups/450g/1 lb rhubarb

sugar to taste

1 tsp/5ml vanilla essence

1/2 tsp/2.5ml ground cinnamon or a small piece of cinnamon stick

1 cup/250ml/8fl oz whipping cream, whipped

2 tbsp/15g/1/2 oz agar-agar

2 tbsp/30ml boiling water

METHOD

1-Drain the yoghurt for about 3 hours.

2-Cook the rhubarb with the sugar, vanilla essence and cinnamon with just enough water to stop it from burning. You will need 1 1/2 cups/300ml/1pt of cooked rhubarb. Mix the cooked rhubarb with the drained yoghurt and the whipped cream. Mix gently until everything is combined.

3-Dissolve the agar-agar in the boiling water, mixing well until smooth. Add to the rhubarb mixture, stirring the agar-agar in quickly.

4-Turn the mixture into a moistened small ring mould and chill until set. Serve with more whipped cream if desired.

VARIATION

Use 1 1/3 cups/225g/8oz quark, fromage blanc or curd cheese if preferred instead of the drained yoghurt.

Rhubarb Cream Jelly

INGREDIENTS

serves 6

2 1/2 cups/600ml/1 pt yoghurt

4 cups/450g/1 lb rhubarb sugar to taste

1 tsp/5ml vanilla essence

1/2 tsp/2.5ml ground cinnamon or a small piece of cinnamon stick

1 cup/250ml/8fl oz whipping cream, whipped

2 tbsp/15g/1/2 oz agar-agar

2 tbsp/30ml boiling water

METHOD

1-Drain the yoghurt for about 3 hours.

2-Cook the rhubarb with the sugar, vanilla essence and cinnamon with just enough water to stop it from burning. You will need 1 1/2 cups/300ml/1pt of cooked rhubarb. Mix the cooked rhubarb with the drained yoghurt and the whipped cream. Mix gently until everything is combined.

3-Dissolve the agar-agar in the boiling water, mixing well until smooth. Add to the rhubarb mixture, stirring the agar-agar in quickly.

4-Turn the mixture into a moistened small ring mould and chill until set. Serve with more whipped cream if desired.

VARIATION

Use 1 1/3 cups/225g/8oz quark, fromage blanc or curd cheese if preferred instead of the drained yoghurt.

Brown Rice Pudding

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

½ cup/100g/4oz brown rice

2 ½ cups/600ml/1 pt China tea

1 stick cinnamon

1/3 cup/50g/2oz sultanas

3/8 cup/50g/2oz dried apricots, chopped

¼ cup/50g/2oz almonds sliced fresh fruit (optional)

METHOD

1-Wash the rice thoroughly under running water. Put it in a heavy pan with the tea and simmer gently for about an hour with the cinnamon.

2-Pre-heat the oven to 350°F/180°C/Gas 4. Remove the cinnamon and transfer the rice to an ovenproof dish. Stir in the remaining ingredients and bake for about 25 minutes until done. Serve hot or refrigerate and serve cold. Garnish with sliced fresh fruit, if liked.

Chocolate Pudding

2 c nonfat milk

3/4 c black chocolate sauce

1/8 ts salt

3 tb sugar

1/4 c nonfat milk

3 tb plus 2 t cornstarch

1 ts vanilla

1. In top of double boiler over boiling water, combine milk, chocolate sauce (separate recipe), salt and sugar.
2. Bring just to a boil. Reduce heat to medium. Combine 1/4 c milk and cornstarch, stirring till smooth.
3. With wire whisk stirring constantly, add cornstarch mixture to chocolate mixture; it will thicken very quickly.
4. Reduce heat to low, cover and cook another 10 minutes.
5. Remove from heat, add vanilla and chill.

Lite 'n Easy Crustless Pumpkin Pie

2 pk Unflavored gelatin

2 tb Cold water

2 1/4 c Lowfat evaporated milk; UNDILUTED & divided

16 oz Can solid pack pumpkin

6 tb Dark brown sugar; packed OR low-cal sweetener equivalent

1 ts Pumpkin pie spice

1 ts Vanilla extract

1. In medium bowl, sprinkle gelatin over cold water to soften; set aside.
2. In small saucepan, heat 1 cup of the evaporated milk to just boiling.
3. Slowly stir hot milk into gelatin; stir until gelatin is dissolved.
4. Mix in remaining evaporated milk, the pumpkin, brown sugar, pumpkin pie spice, and vanilla; set aside.
5. Spray 10-inch glass pie plate with non-stick vegetable coating. Pour mixture into pie plate; chill until firm.

Chocolate Grand Mariner Souffle`

1 cup Chocolate or carob chips
1 pound Firm tofu (water packed)
1/2 cup Cocoa or carob powder
3/4 cup Honey
3 tablespoons Grand marnier
1 teaspoon Vanilla
1/2 cup Soy milk
1/2 cup Unbleached white flour
1 teaspoon Baking powder

1. Preheat oven to 350F. Place chocolate chips or carob in a bowl & place it in hot water to melt stirring with a spoon.
2. Place remaining ingredients in a food processor & blend till smooth & creamy.
3. Add melted chocolate & puree a few moments. Pour into a very lightly oiled 1-quart souffle dish.
4. Bake for 40 to 45 minutes, or until the souffle has completely puffed up.

Cool for 5 minutes.

Carob Brownies

2 cups Whole-wheat pastry flour

1/3 cup Carob powder

2 teaspoons Baking powder

1/3 cup Honey

1/2 cup Unsweetened applesauce

1 cup Water

1 teaspoon Vanilla -- 1/2 tsp if Watkins

1/4 cup Chopped nuts (optional)

1. In a large mixing bowl, combine flour, carob powder and baking powder.
2. In a separate bowl, thoroughly mix remaining ingredients, except nuts.
3. Add dry ingredients to wet ingredients and mix well. Stir in nuts if desired.
4. Pour batter into a nonstick or lightly oiled 8-inch square baking dish.

Bake at 350 for 35 minutes. Makes 16 brownies.

Courgettes with Almonds

INGREDIENTS

serves 4

6 large/700g/1½lb courgettes, sliced lengthways

1 medium onion, finely chopped

1 tbsp/15ml olive oil

salt and freshly ground black pepper

½ cup/50g/2oz flaked almonds

1 tsp/5ml cornstarch

1 tbsp/15ml water

1 cup/250ml/8fl oz yoghurt

METHOD

1-Place the courgettes in a shallow ovenproof dish. Mix the onions, oil, salt and pepper and spoon the mixture over the courgettes. Bake uncovered at 350°F/180°C/Gas 4 for 40 minutes, or until tender.

2-Meanwhile toast the almonds: put them into a heavy frying pan over a high heat and shake the pan frequently; don't burn.

3-Mix the cornstarch with the water and add it to the yoghurt with seasoning to taste. Warm the mixture over a gentle heat, stirring constantly, for 3 minutes.

4-Spoon it over the courgettes and scatter the almonds on top.

Courgettes with Dill

INGREDIENTS

serves 4

¼ cup/60ml/2fl oz olive oil

2 tbsp/25g/ 1 oz butter

1 onion, chopped

1 garlic, crushed

450g/1 lb courgettes topped, tailed and sliced in thickish rounds salt and freshly ground black pepper

2 tsp/10ml paprika

1 tbsp/15ml dill, chopped (not the stalks)

1 small tub soured cream

METHOD

1-Heat oil and butter in a large frying pan. Cook the onion and garlic gently until soft. Turn up the heat.

2-Add the courgettes, garlic and black pepper and toss.

3-Cook for 5-10 minutes, stirring to cook both sides of the courgette slices.

4-When browning, add the paprika, dill and soured cream. Season and serve.

ChilliBeans

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

1 cup/175g/6oz rose cocoa beans

2 tbsp/30ml olive oil

½ tsp/2.5g fennel seeds

1/2 tsp/2.5g mustard seeds

1 onion, chopped

2 cloves garlic, chopped

1 ¾ cup/100g/4oz sliced mushrooms

½ fresh green chilli, de-seeded and chopped

1 ¾ cups/425g/15oz can tomatoes, mashed

2 tbsp/30ml chopped fresh coriander or parsley salt and freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

1-Soak the beans overnight and cook them in salted water until tender. Cooking time will vary depending on the age of the beans. They could be ready in 20 minutes, or they may take an hour, so keep testing.

2-Meanwhile, heat the oil in a pan and, when hot, add the seeds. As soon as the mustard seeds begin to pop, add the onion and garlic. Cook gently until translucent.

3-Stir in the mushrooms. When they are tender, add the chilli and tomatoes, coriander and seasoning. If you can't get coriander, use parsley instead, but the dish will certainly lose some of its character.

4-Add the beans, heat through for 10 minutes and serve with roasted rarebit or an omelette for a warming winter supper.

Roasted Aubergine

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

1 large aubergine

1 small onion, finely chopped

1-2 green chillis, finely chopped

½ tsp/2.5ml salt 2-3 tbsp/30-45 ml mustard oil

METHOD

1-Place the aubergine under a pre-heated grill for about 15 minutes, turning frequently, until the skin becomes black and the flesh soft.

2-Peel the skin and mash the flesh.

3-Add the rest of the ingredients to the mashed aubergine and mix thoroughly.

Brussels Sprouts with Garlic and Mushrooms

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

2-3 tbsp/30-45ml oil

4 cloves garlic, chopped

1 lb/450g Brussels sprouts, thinly sliced

1 ¼ cups/100g/4oz mushrooms, sliced

METHOD

1-Heat some oil in a wok or deep-sided frying pan. Add the garlic and fry quickly, stirring, until crisp and brown.

2-Add the sprouts and mushrooms and stir until coated with garlic and oil. Stir-fry for 1-2 minutes and eat while crisp and hot. A delicious accompaniment to bean dishes.

Carrots with Yoghurt

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-6

3 1/2 cups/450g/lb carrots, sliced

1 tsp/5ml sugar

1/2 tsp/2.5ml ground cumin

1 small onion, finely chopped

juice 1/2 lemon

2/3 cup/150ml/ 1/4 pt yoghurt

salt and pepper

METHOD

1-Cook the carrots with the sugar in boiling water just until they are al dente. Drain them and add the cumin and onion. Stir around.

2-Mix the lemon juice into the yoghurt, season to taste and spoon it over the carrots.

3-Serve immediately or leave it to cool and serve as a salad or an accompaniment to curry.

Cauliflower with Potatoes and Peas

INGREDIENTS Serves 4-6

4 tbsp/60ml oil

2 medium onions, finely chopped

4 cups/450g/lb diced potatoes in $\frac{3}{4}$ in/ 2cm pieces

1 small cauliflower, cut into $\frac{3}{4}$ in/2cm pieces

$\frac{1}{2}$ tsp/2.5ml ground turmeric

$\frac{1}{3}$ tsp/3ml chilli powder

1 tsp/5ml ground cumin

2 tomatoes, chopped

1 tsp/5 ml salt

$\frac{1}{4}$ tsp/1.5ml sugar

1 cup/200g/7oz peas

$\frac{1}{2}$ tsp/2.5ml

METHOD

1-Heat the oil in a karai over medium high heat. Add the onions and fry for 3-4 minutes until light brown.

2-Add the potatoes and cauliflower and stir. Add the spices, tomatoes, salt and sugar. Stir and fry for 2-3 minutes.

3-Add the peas, cover and lower heat to medium low and cook for about 20 minutes until the potatoes and cauliflower are tender. Stir the vegetables a few times to stop them sticking. Sprinkle with Garam Masala before serving.

Purée of Root Vegetable

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

175g/6oz carrots

175g/6oz secede

1 turnip

1 parsnip butter

salt and freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

1-Trim and peel the vegetables and simmer in salted water until tender.

2-Drain and mash to a fluffy purée butter. Season with salt and plenty of black pepper. Serve with a dish that has a crunchy texture, such as Chestnuts and Vegetable

Fennel Mornay

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4

3 bulbs fenne

l bay leaf

THE SAUCE

2 tbsp/25g/l oz butter

¼ cup/25g/l oz plain untreated flour

1 ¼ cups/300ml/10fl oz milk

2/3 cup/150ml/5fl oz single cream

1 cup/100g/4oz Cheddar cheese, grated

¼ - ½ cup/25-50g/l -2oz breadcrumbs salt and freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

1-Trim the fennel and simmer in salted water with a bay leaf for about 30 minutes until tender.

2-Meanwhile, make the sauce. Melt the butter in a pan and stir in the flour. Cook, stirring, for a couple of minutes and then gradually stir in the milk. Add the cream and most of the cheese and cook gently until the cheese has melted. Season well and keep warm.

3-Drain the fennel and cut each bulb in half. Lay the halves in a flameproof dish and pour the sauce over them. Sprinkle with the remaining cheese and the breadcrumbs. Put under a hot grill to brown and melt the cheese.

NOTE

For a tangier sauce, add a little powdered English mustard to taste.

Corn on the Cob with Garlic Butter

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-6

Corn on the cob butter

garlic paste

METHOD

1-Remove the outer green leaves from the fresh corn. Place in boiling salted water with a drop of olive oil.

2-Simmer for 20 minutes, or until the corn is cooked and tender. Remove from the heat and drain.

3-Smother liberally with butter and garlic paste.

Split peas with vegetables

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-6

scant cup/200g/7oz split peas, washed

3 cups/750ml/25fl oz water

2 tbsp/30ml Ghee

½ tsp/2.5ml whole cumin seeds

2 bayleaves

2-3 green chilies, cut lengthways

2 ½ cups/275g/10oz diced potatoes, cut into 1 in/2.5cm pieces

1/3 cup/75g/3oz peas

3 cups/350g/12oz cauliflower, cut into large florets

1 tsp/2.5ml ground turmeric

1 tsp/5ml salt

METHOD

1-In a large saucepan bring the split peas and water to the boil. Cover and simmer for 30 minutes. Remove from heat.

2-Heat the ghee in a large saucepan over medium high heat. Add the cumin seeds, bay leaves and green chillies and let them sizzle for a few seconds.

3-Add the potatoes, peas, cauliflower and fry for 1-2 minutes.

4-Add the boiled split peas with the water, turmeric and salt. Mix thoroughly, lower heat and cook until the vegetables are tender. (if the dal gets too thick add a little more water.)

Black eyed peas with onions

INGREDIENTS

Serves 4-6

1 good cup/ 200g/7oz black eyed peas, washed

5 cups/1.1 l/ 2 pts water

2 tbsp/30ml oil

1 large onion, finely chopped

2 cloves garlic, crushed

¼ in/0.5cm root ginger, grated

1-2 green chillis, finely chopped

½ tsp/2.5ml salt

1 tsp/5ml molasses

METHOD

1-Soak the beans in the water overnight.

2-Boil the beans in the water and then cover and simmer for 1 hour until tender. Drain.

3-Heat the oil in a large saucepan and fry the onion, garlic, ginger and chilli until the onions are soft. Add the beans, salt and molasses and cook until all the moisture is absorbed, about 15 minutes. Serve with Bakoras.

Three Peppers in Tomato and Garlic

INGREDIENTS

Serves 6

¾ cup/175ml/6fl oz olive oil

2 yellow peppers, de-seeded and cut into thin strips

2 red peppers, de-seeded and cut into thin strips

2 green peppers, de-seeded and cut into thin strips

1 tbsp/15ml parsley, chopped

2 tsp/10ml finely chopped garlic

8oz/225g fresh or canned tomatoes salt and freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

1-Heat the oil in a large frying pan and cook the peppers gently for 2-3 minutes, stirring frequently. Add the parsley and garlic and cook for another couple of minutes.

2-Add the chopped tomatoes and their juice to the pan. Stir and season. Cover and simmer gently for about 20 minutes, until the peppers are tender. The sauce should be quite thick - if necessary, remove the peppers and boil rapidly to reduce the liquid. Season.

Yoghurt

INGREDIENTS

makes about 5 cups

5 cups/1.1 1/2pts milk

2 tbsp/30ml unflavoured commercial yoghurt at room temperature

METHOD

1-Scald the milk. Heat it until it is ready to boil. Just before boiling point, remove the pan from the heat and allow to cool until lukewarm. Test by dripping a little milk on your wrist. It should feel warm, not hot.

2-Put the yoghurt in the chosen container and stir in a little milk until smooth. Now stir in the remaining milk.

3-Cover and place container in the incubator. Be careful not to disturb the yoghurt for about 4 hours. When the consistency is right, chill in the fridge to set before using.

NOTE

Yoghurt can be made in any sterile container with a rightly fitting lid inside any sort of incubator, such as an oven with the pilot light on or a styrofoam box, but because the secret of successful yoghurt making is a constant lukewarm temperature, it is best to use a special yoghurt maker Don't put incubating yoghurt near a heat source regulated by a thermostat that switches on and off. Use 2 tbsp/30ml of the home-made yoghurt to start the next batch. The cost of making yoghurt at home is minimal and the method is easy.

GHEE-CLARIFIED BUTTER

INGREDIENTS

makes about 2 cups/450 ml/ $\frac{3}{4}$ pt

1 lb/450g unsalted butter

METHOD

1-Heat the butter in a saucepan over low heat. Let it simmer for 15-20 minutes until all the white residue turns golden and settles at the bottom.

2-Remove from the heat, strain and cool. Pour into an airtight bottle and store in a cool place.

Homemade Garam Masala

INGREDIENTS

makes about 1/3 cup/2,oz/ 4 tbsp

3 tbsp/45ml cardamom seeds

3in/7.5cm cinnamon sticks

½ tbsp/7.5ml cumin seeds

½ tsp/2.5ml black peppercorns

½ tsp/2.5ml cloves

¼ nutmeg

METHOD.

Grind all the spices together until they are finely ground. Store in a spice bottle until required.

(The ingredients may be added in different proportions to suit individual tastes)

BECHAMEL SAUCE

Ingredients:

Make about 3 ¼ cups/900 ml/ 1 ½ pts.

2 ½ cups/ 600 ml/ 1 pt milk

1 small onion, peeled.

1 small carrot, peeled and sliced.

1 bay leaf

6 slightly crushed peppercorn

1 blade mace

1 stalk parsley

3 tbsp/ 40g/ 1 ½ oz butter

6 tbsp/ 40g/ 1 ½ oz flour

Salt and white pepper.

METHOD

1-Pour milk into a saucepan. Add the onion cut into quarters with 2 slices of carrot, bay leaf, peppercorns, mace and parsley stalk.

2-Cover and allow to heat on a low heat without boiling for about 10 minutes. Remove from the heat and allow to infuse for a further 10 minutes, covered.

3-Make a roux (a blend of butter and flour) by melting the butter in a saucepan. Do not allow the butter to brown. Add the flour and stir well over a medium heat.

4-Gradually add the strained milk and stir briskly or whisk until a smooth creamy sauce is made, season to taste.

Cold Horseradish Sauce

INGREDIENTS

makes about 200mL/7 fl oz

2 tbsp/30ml prepared horseradish cream

2/3 cup/150ml/1/4 pt soured cream

METHOD

1-Stir the horseradish cream into the soured cream. Refrigerate for an hour before use if possible.

2-Use this sauce for potatoes and beetroot k dishes.

Creamy Mustard Vinaigrette

Makes about 2/3 cup/150ml/1/4 pt

3 tbsp/45ml olive oil

2 tbsp/30ml double cream

2 tbsp/30ml red wine vinegar

1 tbsp/15ml Dijon mustard

½ tsp/2.5ml dried thyme

1 ½ tsp/7.5ml soy sauce

saft and freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

Put the olive oil, cream, vinegar and mustard in a small bowl. Stir with a fork or whisk until the mixture is just foamy. Stir in the thyme, soy sauce, salt and pepper.

Modern Vinaigrette

INGREDIENTS

makes 1 cup/250ml/8fl oz

2 tbsp/30ml wine vinegar

1 tbsp/15ml lemon juice

1 tsp/5ml prepared mustard

salt and freshly ground black pepper

3/4 cup/175g/6fl oz pure olive oil

3 tsp/15ml mixed fresh herbs (optional)

METHOD

1-Put the vinegar, lemon juice, mustard, salt and pepper in a jar with a tightly fitting lid.

2-Cover the jar tightly and shake until the salt dissolves. Add the olive oil to the jar and shake until well mixed. Stir in the chopped basil, oregano or mix of herbs if wanted.

Tofu Dressing

INGREDIENTS

makes about 2 cups/ 475ml/16fl oz

1 2/3 cups/300g/10oz silken tofu

2 tbsp/30ml lemon juice

3 tbsp/45ml oil

pinch salt

1 tsp/5ml soy sauce

1 clove garlic, crushed

METHOD

Blend everything together in a liquidiser.

Blue Cheese Dressing

INGREDIENTS

makes about 1 ¼ cups/ 400 ml/ 14 fl oz

1 cup/250ml/8fl oz yoghurt

1/2 cup/50g/2oz blue cheese

3 tbsp/45ml olive oil

salt and freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

Blend all the ingredients together thoroughly.

Tomato Yoghurt Dressing

INGREDIENTS

Makes $\frac{3}{4}$ cup/ 175 ml/ 6 fl oz

$\frac{2}{3}$ cup/150ml/ $\frac{1}{4}$ pt yoghurt

4 tsp/20ml tomato ketchup squeeze of lemon

dash Tabasco

salt and freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

Mix all the ingredients together well. Serve on crisp lettuce.

VARIATION

Add finely chopped green or red pepper, chopped hard-boiled egg, chopped spring onions.

Touch of Asia Dressing

INGREDIENTS

makes 1 cup/250 ml/ 8 fl oz

2 tsp/10 ml soy sauce

2 tsp/10ml water

1 whole spring onion, chopped

1/2 tsp/2.5ml sesame oil

¼ tsp/1.5ml hot pepper chilli oil

1 garlic clove, finely chopped

1/4 tsp/1.5ml ground black pepper

6fl oz/175ml peanut oil

2 1/2 tbsp/38ml rice wine vinegar

METHOD

1-Put the soy sauce, water, spring onion, sesame oil, hot pepper oil, garlic and black pepper in a jar with a tightly fitting lid. Cover and shake until the ingredients are blended.

2-Add the peanut oil to the jar, cover tightly and shake again. Let the mixture stand for 2 minutes.

3-Add the vinegar to the jar. Cover tightly and shake well again. Pour over the salad immediately.

Lemon Dressing

INGREDIENTS

Makes 1/4 cup/ 175ml/6fl oz

1 tsp/5ml water large pinch salt

large pinch grated lemon rind

2 tsp/10ml dried mint

4 tbsp/60ml/2fl oz fresh lemon juice

1/2 cup/120ml/4fl oz pure olive oil

large pinch ground black pepper

METHOD

1-Put the water, salt and lemon rind in a jar with a tightly fitting lid. Let stand for 2 minutes.

2-Add the mint and lemon juice. Cover the jar tightly and shake.

3-Add the olive oil and black pepper. Cover the jar tightly, shake again and serve.

Basil Dressing

INGREDIENTS

makes 1 cup/ 250 ml/ 8 oz

1 cup/250ml/8fl oz yoghurt

10 basil leaves, finely chopped

1 large clove garlic, crushed

salt and freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

1-Blend everything together well. Serve over green or mixed salad or tomato and onion salad.

NOTE

This also makes a good sauce for pasta, in which case double the quantity.

Herb Dressing

INGREDIENTS

makes 1 ½ cups/ 130 ml/ 12fl oz

½ cup/75g/3oz cream cheese

1 cup/250ml/8fl oz yoghurt or buttermilk salt and freshly ground black pepper finely chopped fresh herbs

METHOD

Blend everything together well. Refrigerate until required. Use on salads or fish.

Tahint Dressing

INGREDIENTS

makes 1 $\frac{3}{4}$ cups/ 400 ml/ 14fl oz

1 cup/250ml/8fl oz tahini

4 tbsp/60ml water

4 tbsp/60ml lemon juice

3 cloves garlic, crushed pinch salt

METHOD

Blend all the ingredients together thoroughly.

Chutney Dressing

INGREDIENTS

makes about 1 1/2 cups/ 350ml/12fl oz

1/2 cup/120ml/4fl oz soured cream

1/2 cup/120ml/4fl oz buttermilk

2 tbsp/30ml mango chutney

1 tbsp/15ml lemon juice

2 tsp/10ml oil

2 tsp/10ml mustard

salt and freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

1-Blend everything together well. Refrigerate until required.

2-Serve on salad or cold vegetables. It also makes a delicious dressing for hard-cooked eggs.

Saisa Verde

INGREDIENTS

makes about 1 1/2 cups/350ml/12fl oz

3 cloves of garlic, finely chopped

1 cup/100g/4oz parsley, finely chopped

1 tbsp/15g watercress leaves, finely chopped (optional)

1 tbsp/15g mixed fresh herbs, finely chopped (basil, marjoram, and a little thyme, sage, chervil and dill)

coarse salt

4 tbsp/60ml olive oil juice of 1-2 lemons

1-2 tsp/5-10g sugar black pepper

METHOD

1-Blend or pound together in a mortar, the garlic, parsley, watercress, fresh mixed herbs and a little coarse salt, until they form a smooth paste.

2-Add the oil, a spoonful at a time, and mix well. Add the lemon juice and season with sugar, salt and pepper to taste. This goes excellently with hard-boded eggs or fritters.

Title: Four-Fruit Smoothie

MAKES: 3 1/2 cups

1. To freeze fruit pieces, set them slightly apart on a baking sheet. Put in the freezer until firm, 1 to 2 hours.

2. To store longer, transfer frozen fruit to a freezer container. Or buy individually quick-frozen fruit pieces or berries by the bag, pour out the amount of fruit you need, then seal bag and store in the freezer.

3. In a blender, whirl 1 1/2 cups apple juice, 1 3/4 cups frozen banana chunks (cut into 1-in. pieces), 1 cup frozen strawberries, and 1 cup frozen peach slices until smoothly puréed.

4. Add 1/8 to 1/4 teaspoon almond extract (optional) to taste. Pour into glasses to serve.

Title: Iced Mexican Chocolate

MAKES: 4 1/2 cups

1. In a blender, whirl 1 cup nonfat milk, 1 1/2 ounces unsweetened chocolate (coarsely chopped), 2 tablespoons honey, 1/2 teaspoon grated orange peel, and 1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon until chocolate is finely ground.

2. Add 1 pint vanilla nonfat frozen yogurt and 2 cups ice cubes; whirl until smoothly puréed (chocolate forms streaks). Pour into glasses.

Section: Beverages

Title: Blueberry-Lemon Shake

MAKES: 3 1/2 cups

In a blender, whirl 3 cups frozen blueberries, 1 1/2 cups buttermilk, 1/2 cup sugar, 1/2 teaspoon grated lemon peel, and 2 tablespoons lemon juice until smoothly puréed. Pour into glasses to serve.

Title: Frozen Cappuccino

1. Put 1/3 cup finely ground espresso- roast coffee or other dark-roast coffee in a paper-lined coffee filter set over a mug. Pour 1 cup hot (190°) water into filter and let drip through. Chill until cool, about 20 minutes.
2. In a blender, whirl coffee, 3/4 cup vanilla nonfat frozen yogurt, 1/2 cup ice cubes, and 1 1/2 tablespoons sugar until smoothly puréed.

Pour into a glass.

Bean Curd Dip

Recipe By : Joanne Hush, Classic Chinese Cooking

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:10

Categories : Appetizers Chinese Dishes

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1/2 pound bean curd

1/4 cup plum sauce

2 teaspoons prepared Chinese mustard

1 teaspoon salt

Mash the bean curd, then mix with the other ingredients with a whisk or an electric mixer. the dip should have the consistency of sour cream. To prepare in a blender or food processor, combine the ingredients and process until smooth. Refrigerate until ready to serve. Stored in a sealed container, the dip can be kept in the refrigerator for up to a week. Makes 1 1/2 cups.

Congee

Recipe By : Joanne Hush, Classic Chinese Cooking, pg 155

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :1:45

Categories : Cereals/Grains Chinese Dishes

Vegetarian

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 cup short-grain rice

8 cups cold water

Combine the rice and water in a large saucepan with a tight-fitting lid. Bring to a boil, cover, and reduce heat to simmer. Cook for 1 1/2 hours. Serve hot.

Easy Sweet & Sour Sauce

Recipe By :

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:05

Categories : Chinese Dishes Sauces

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1/4 cup pineapple juice

1 1/2 tablespoons oil

1 tablespoon brown sugar

1 1/4 teaspoons soy sauce

1/2 teaspoon pepper

2 tablespoons milk vinegar

Combine all ingredients in small bowl.

Serving Ideas : Use as dipping sauce or to stir-fry vegetables

Hoisin Dipping Sauce

Recipe By : Joanne Hush, Classic Chinese Cooking, pg 189

Serving Size : 1 Preparation Time :0:05

Categories : Appetizers Vegetarian

Chinese Dishes Sauces

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

2	tablespoons	hoisin sauce
2	tablespoons	tomato catsup
1	teaspoon	rice vinegar
1	teaspoon	honey
1	teaspoon	black soy sauce

Combine the ingredients in a small bowl and mix well. Refrigerate until ready to serve.

Hunan Chow Mein

Recipe By : Carol Greenberg, Veggie Life, pg 55

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:30

Categories : Cereals/Grains Chinese Dishes

Main Course Vegetables

Vegetarian

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

- 1 medium onion -- chopped
- 3 cloves garlic -- minced
- 1 tablespoon peanut oil
- 2 tablespoons soy sauce
- 1 teaspoon dried mustard
- 2 stalks celery -- sliced diagonally
- 2 cups baby bok choy -- chopped
- 1 red bell pepper -- chopped
- 8 ounces waterchestnuts -- sliced
- 1 cup vegetable stock
- 1 cup mushrooms -- sliced
- 4 cups white rice -- cooked

In a wok or large skillet over high heat, cook onion and garlic in oil for 3 minutes, or until they begin to soften. Add soy sauce, mustard, celery, bok choy, bell pepper, water chestnuts, vegetable stock, and mushrooms. Continue cooking, stirring frequently, until vegetables are crisp-tender, about 5 minutes. Serve over rice.

Lo Mein

Serving Size : 4 Preparation Time :0:30

Categories : Chinese Dishes Pasta Dishes

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

3		dried Chinese mushrooms	
1/2	pound	Chinese noodles	
3	tablespoons	peanut oil	
1		onion -- chopped	
2	cups	shredded cabbage	
1	small	zucchini -- in 1/2" cubes	
3	tablespoons	light soy sauce	
1/2	cup	reserved mushroom soaking liquid	
1	teaspoon	honey	
1/2	teaspoon	salt	

Soak the Chinese mushrooms in 1 cup of hot water for 30 minutes. Meanwhile, bring 4 quarts of water to boil in a large pot. Stir in the noodles and cook 3 minutes, just until tender. Drain, rinse in cold water, and toss with 1 tablespoon of peanut oil. Set aside.

Remove the mushrooms, but strain and reserve 1/2 cup of the soaking liquid. Trim and discard the mushroom stems. Coarsely chop the caps and set aside. Combine the ingredients for the sauce in a small bowl. Stir to dissolve the sugar and set aside.

Place a wok over medium-high heat. When it begins to smoke, add the mushrooms, onion, cabbage, and zucchini. Stir-fry for 2 minutes. Pour the sauce over the vegetables. Add the reserved noodles and stir until heated through, about 3 minutes. Serve immediately.

Manchurian Sauce

Recipe By : Michael McDermott, Eat More, Weigh Less, pg 310

Serving Size : 1 Preparation Time :0:40

Categories : Appetizers Chinese Dishes

Sauces

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1/2 cup	soy sauce
1/2 cup	vegetable stock
1/2 cup	green onion -- thinly sliced
1 teaspoon	fresh ginger root -- minced
1 teaspoon	garlic -- minced
1/2 teaspoon	wasabi (or 1/2 tsp minced jalapeno pepper)

In a medium-sized bowl, combine all the ingredients and whisk until well blended. Refrigerate for at least 30 minutes before serving.

NOTES : If you are watching your sodium intake, substitute one of the low-sodium varieties of soy sauce, but keep in mind that these may still be quite high in salt.

Mandarin Noodles

Recipe By : Joanne Hush, Classic Chinese Cooking, pg 67

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:30

Categories : Vegetables Vegetarian

Chinese Dishes

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

4 dried Chinese mushrooms

1/2 pound fresh Chinese noodles

1/4 cup peanut oil

1 tablespoon hoisin sauce

1 tablespoon bean sauce

2 tablespoons rice wine or dry sherry

3 tablespoons light soy sauce

1 teaspoon sugar or honey

1/2 cup reserved mushroom soaking liquid

1 teaspoon chili paste

1 tablespoon cornstarch

1/2 red bell pepper -- in 1/2 inch cubes

1/2 8 ounce can whole bamboo shoots, cut in 1/2in cubes -- rinsed and

drained

2 cups bean sprouts

1 scallion -- thinly sliced

Soak the Chinese mushrooms in 1 1/4 cups of hot water for 30 minutes. While they are soaking, bring 4 quarts of water to a boil and cook teh noodles for 3 minutes. Drain and toss with 1 tablespoon of peanut oil; set aside.

Remove the mushrooms; strain and reserve 1/2 cup of the soaking liquid for the sauce. Trin and discard the mushroom stems; coarsely chop the caps and set aside. Combine the ingredients for the sauce in a small bowl and stir well to dissolve the sugar; set aside. Dissolve the cornstarch in

2 tablespoons of cold water; set aside.

Place the wok over medium-high heat. When it begins to smoke, add the remaining 3 tablespoons of peanut oil, then the mushrooms, red pepper, bamboo shoots, and bean sprouts. Stir-fry 2 minutes. Stir the sauce and add it to the wok, and continue to stir-fry until the mixture

begins to boil, about 30 seconds. Mix the dissolved cornstarch and add it to the wok. Continue to

stir until the sauce thickens, about 1 minute. Add the noodles and toss until heated through, about

2 minutes. Transfer to a serving platter and sprinkle with the sliced scallion. Serve immediately.

NOTES : Because of the chili paste in the sauce, this is a rather hot dish. If you prefer less spicy food, cut down on the chili paste or leave it out entirely...the noodles are still delicious without it.

Shui Mai

Serving Size : 24 Preparation Time :0:40

Categories : Appetizers Chinese Dishes

Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

- 2 tablespoons peanut oil
- 1 garlic cloves
- 1 teaspoon ginger -- minced
- 1 scallion -- chopped
- 1 onion -- coarsely chopped
- 1/2 small cabbage -- coarsely chopped
- 2 teaspoons thin soy sauce
- 1/2 teaspoon sesame oil
- 1 teaspoon rice wine or dry sherry
- 1 teaspoon cornstarch dissolved in 1 tsp cold water
- 24 dumpling wrappers, 3 inch diameter
- 1/2 cup parboiled or frozen green peas
- 10 lettuce leaves

Place a wok over medium-high heat. When it begins to smoke, add the oil, then the garlic, ginger, and scallion. Stir-fry 15 seconds. Add the onion and cabbage and stir-fry 2 minutes. Add the soy sauce, sesame oil, rice wine, and dissolved cornstarch. Stir constantly until the sauce thickens, about 30 seconds. Remove the wok from the heat and set aside to cool.

Place a dumpling wrapper on the work surface. With your fingers, completely moisten the surface of the wrapper with water. Place 1 tablespoon of filling in the center. Pull up the sides of the wrapper around the filling, tucking the wrapper in tiny pleats around the filling. Lightly tap the dumpling on the work surface to flatten the bottom.

Gently squeeze the center of the dumpling to make a slight indentation and force the filling to bulge a bit at the top. Finally, place a green pea in the center indentation of each dumpling for a garnish. Cover the dumplings as they are finished and fill the remaining wrappers. Bring water to boil under a steamer. Place the lettuce leaves on a heat-proof plate and arrange the dumplings on the lettuce. Cover and steam for 10 minutes. Serve immediately with Spicy Soy Dipping Sauce.

Spicy Soy Dipping Sauce

Serving Size : 24 Preparation Time :0:10

Categories : Sauces Appetizers

Chinese Dishes

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1/4 cup bvegetable stock

1/2 cup light soy sauce

1 tablespoon rice wine or dry sherry

2 tablespoons sesame oil

2 tablespoons rice vinegar

1 tablespoon sugar or honey

1 teaspoon hot oil

Spicy Vegetable Lo Mein

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:30

Categories : Chinese Dishes Main Course

Pasta Dishes Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

8	ounces	soba noodles (or other flat Asian noodle)
2	teaspoons	hot chili oil
2	teaspoons	ginger root -- grated
2	cloves	garlic -- minced
3 1/2	ounces	shiitake mushrooms, pkg -- caps thinly sliced
1	medium	red bell pepper -- in short thin strips
2	cups	bok choy -- chopped
1/2	cup	canned vegetable broth
6	ounces	sugar snap peas or snow pea pods
2	tablespoons	tamari or soy sauce
2	tablespoons	seasoned or regular rice vinegar
1	tablespoon	dark-roasted sesame oil
1/4	cup	chopped peanuts or cashews -- optional

Cook noodles according to package directions. Meanwhile, heat oil in large deep skillet or wok over medium heat. Add ginger and garlic; cook 30 seconds. Add mushrooms, bell pepper and bok choy; cook 3 minutes, stirring occasionally. Add broth and sugar snap peas; simmer until vegetables are crisp-tender, stirring occasionally, 3 to 5 minutes. Add tamari or soy sauce, and vinegar.

Drain noodles; add to skillet with vegetables. Add sesame oil; cook 1 minute, tossing well. Sprinkle with peanuts or cashews, if desired.

Spinach Ravioli

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:45

Categories : Appetizers Chinese Dishes

Main Course Pasta Dishes

Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 cup tomatoes -- peeled, seeded,diced

1 small onion -- oven roasted

1 cup mushrooms -- minced

2 teaspoons garlic -- minced

1/2 pound spinach leaves -- blanched, chopped

1/4 cup nonfat cottage cheese

3/4 cup tofu -- mashed

2 tablespoons fresh basil -- minced

freshly ground black pepper salt -- to taste

48 eggless pot sticker skins

In a large saucepan, combine the tomatoes, onion, mushrooms and garlic. Cook over medium heat until the liquid from the mushrooms completely evaporates and the mixture is somewhat dry. Be careful not to burn it. Set aside to cool.

In a large bowl, combine the tomato mixture, spinach, cottage cheese, tofu, and basil. Season to taste with pepper and salt.

On a cutting board, lay out a single layer of pot-sticker skins. Using a pastry brush, moisten the edges with water. Place 1 tablespoon of the spinach mixture onto the center of each skin. Cover with a second potsticker skin and press the edges together with the tines of a fork to seal.

Cook the ravioli in boiling water or vegetable stock for 3 minutes, or until the potsticker skin is al dente. Serve hot.

Spinach-Filled Won Tons

Serving Size : 60 Preparation Time :0:45

Categories : Vegetables Vegetarian

Appetizers Chinese Dishes

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

10 ounces fresh spinach

1 tablespoon peanut oil

1 garlic cloves -- minced

1/4 cup onion -- minced

10 water chestnuts, minced -- rinsed drained

1 pound won-ton wrappers (about 60)

salt & pepper -- to taste

Wash the spinach thoroughly and trim any tough stems. Drain, then dry with paper towels or a salad spinner. Coarsely chop and set aside.

Place a wok over medium-high heat. When it begins to smoke, add the peanut oil, then the garlic and onion. Stir-fry 30 seconds. Add the spinach and water chestnuts and stir fry until the spinach is dry, about 3 minutes. Transfer the vegetables to a bowl and season with salt and pepper.

When the filling has cooled slightly, form the won tons. Dip you fingers in warm water and moisten the entire surface of a wrapper. Place 1 teaspoon of filling in the center of the wrapper and fold it in half. Press the edges to seal. Bring the ends together and moisten with water; press to seal. Cover and set aside the finished won tons while shaping the remainder.

Cook the won tons following the directions in the recipe - either in boiling water or soup stock until they are just tender, or deep-fry them in 3 to 4 cups of peanut oil until golden brown, about 3 minutes on each side.

NOTES : Makes 60 won tons. Won tons may be frozen after being shaped. Place on cookie sheet with sides not touching in the freezer. When completely frozen place in plastic air tight bag.

Steamed Vegetable Buns

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :3:00

Categories : Appetizers Breads

Chinese Dishes Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

4	cups	flour	
1	tablespoon	sugar	
1	package	yeast	
1/2	cup	hot milk (120 - 130 degrees)	
3/4	cup	hot water (120 - 130 degrees)	
4	cloves	garlic -- minced	
2	tablespoons	ginger -- minced	
1	cup	onions -- finely chopped	
1		carrot -- minced	
3	cups	cabbage -- finely chopped	
1		zucchini -- finely chopped	
2	cups	mushrooms -- finely chopped	
1 1/2	cups	bean sprouts -- chopped	
3	tablespoons	peanut oil	
3	tablespoons	dry wine	
2	tablespoons	soy sauce	
1	tablespoon	hoisin sauce	
1 1/2	tablespoons	chili paste	
1	tablespoon	cornstarch	
2	tablespoons	water	
24	pieces	wax paper or aluminum foil (3"x3")	

Mix 3 1/2 cups flour, sugar and yeast in a large bowl. In a small bowl, combine milk and water. Using a thermometer to verify temperature between 120 and 130 degrees. Add milk mixture to flour and stir until flour clumps. Turn dough onto lightly floured surface and knead for 10 minutes or until dough is smooth and elastic. Let rest for 15 minutes. Knead lightly for 1 minutes. Place dough in lightly greased large bowl to rise till doubled about 30-45 minutes.

FILLING: Meanwhile, combine wine, soy sauce, hoisin sauce, and chili paste in small bowl. Combine cornstarch and water in another small bowl. In hot wok add peanut oil. Stir fry garlic, ginger, and onions for 30 seconds. Add carrots, cabbage, zucchini and bean sprouts. Stir-fry 3 minutes. Add mushrooms and stir-fry for 4 minutes. Add soy sauce mixture and stir till bubbly. Briefly stir cornstarch and water; add to vegetables, stirring quickly while mixture thickens. Cook 1 minute and remove from heat to cool.

BUNS: When dough is doubled, punch down. Turn onto lightly floured surface and knead for 5 minutes. Split dough into quarters. Roll each quarter into 3-inch long cylinder. Split each cylinder into 6 pieces. Flatten and stretch pieces to 3 1/2 to 4 inch circles. Place 1 tablespoon of filling in the center. Take up sides and pinch together in the middle. Place on wax paper with pinched side down on steamer rack. Place filled steamer rack and remaining filled buns in oven with 1 1/2 cups of boiling water to rise for 30 minutes. Steam for 20 minutes.

Stir-Fried Broccoli and Chinese Mushrooms

Serving Size : 4 Preparation Time :0:30

Categories : Chinese Dishes Vegetables

Vegetarian

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

6		dried Chinese mushrooms
1	bunch	fresh broccoli
1/2	cup	mushroom soaking liquid
2	tablespoons	light soy sauce
1	tablespoon	rice wine or dry sherry
1	teaspoon	honey
3	tablespoons	peanut oil
1	tablespoon	cornstarch

Soak the Chinese mushrooms in 2 cups of hot water for 30 minutes. Strain and reserve 1/2 cup of the soaking liquid for the sauce. Trim and discard the mushroom stems, and cut the caps in half. Set aside.

Rinse the broccoli and cut the tops into florets. Peel the stems and diagonally cut them in 1/2- inch slices. Mix the ingredients for the sauce in a small bowl, stirring to dissolve the sugar.

Place a wok over medium-high heat. When it is almost smoking, add the peanut oil. When the oil begins to smoke, add the broccoli and the mushrooms. Stir-fry 2 minutes, then pour in the sauce and bring to a boil. Cook 1 minute. While the vegetables are cooking, dissolve the cornstarch in

2 tablespoons of cold water. Pour into the wok and stir constantly until the sauce thickens, about 30 seconds. Serve immediately.

Stir-Fried Spinach with Tofu

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:10

Categories : Chinese Dishes Main Course

Vegetables Vegetarian

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 pound fresh spinach

2 tablespoons peanut oil

1 clove garlic -- minced

1/2 teaspoon salt

1/2 pound firm tofu -- in 1/2" cubes

1 tablespoon rice wine or dry sherry

Wash and thoroughly dry the spinach. Remove any tough stems. Place a wok over medium-high heat. When it begins to smoke, add the peanut oil and the garlic. Stir briefly, then add the spinach and salt. Stir-fry just until the spinach is wilted. about 1 minute. Gently stir in the tofu and sprinkle with rice wine. Cook until the tofu is heated through, about 1 minute. Serve immediately.

Sweet and Sour Dipping Sauce

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:10

Categories : Appetizers Chinese Dishes

Sauces

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1/2 cup bottled Major Grey's Chutney

1/4 cup apricot preserves

1/4 cup crushed pineapple

1/4 cup applesauce

1/2 teaspoon ginger -- minced

1 teaspoon rice vinegar

Combine the ingredients for the sauce in a saucepan and heat just to blend, stirring often. Cool to room temperature and serve. Makes 1 1/4 cups.

Tofu, Cashews, and Vegetables

Serving Size : 4 Preparation Time :0:30

Categories : Chinese Dishes Vegetables

Vegetarian

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 tablespoon light soy sauce

1 tablespoon water

1/2 teaspoon cornstarch

2 teaspoons honey

1 teaspoon hot bean sauce

2 teaspoons sweet bean sauce

3 tablespoons peanut oil

1 carrot -- in 1/2" cubes

1 zucchini -- in 1/2" cubes

2 1/2 ounces bamboo shoots -- in 1/2" cubes

8 ounces tofu -- in 1/2" cubes

1/2 cup frozen green peas

1/2 cup roasted unsalted cashews

Combine the ingredients for the sauce in a small bowl. Stir to dissolve the sugar and cornstarch and set aside.

Place a wok over medium-high heat. When it begins to smoke, add the peanut oil, then the carrot. Stir-fry 30 seconds. Add the zucchini, bamboo shoots, tofu, and peas; stir-fry 30 seconds. Stir in the cashews. Pour in the sauce and stir until it thickens, about 1 minute. Serve immediately.

Vegetable Fried Rice

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:20

Categories : Cereals/Grains Chinese Dishes

Vegetables

Amount	Measure	Ingredient -- Preparation Method
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1/4	cup	light soy sauce
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3	tablespoons	rice wine or dry sherry
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1/2	teaspoon	salt
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6	tablespoons	peanut oil
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1		carrot -- in 1/2" cubes
---	--	-------------------------

1		red bell pepper -- in 1/2" cubes
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1/2	cup	frozen peas
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4	cups	cold cooked rice
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Combine the ingredients for the sauce in a small bowl. Mix to blend well and set aside.

Place a small skillet over medium heat. When it begins to smoke, add 2 tablespoons of peanut oil and the lightly beaten eggs. Stir until the eggs are firm but moist. Transfer the eggs from the skillet to a small bowl and break them into small curds. Set aside.

Bring 1 quart of water to a boil in a small saucepan. Add the carrot and boil 1 minute. Drain and rinse in cold water. Drain again and reserve.

Place a wok over medium-high heat. When it begins to smoke, add the remaining 1/4 cup of peanut oil and the garlic. Stir briefly. Add the carrots, celery, red pepper, and peas. Stir-fry 1 minute. Stir in the rice and stir-fry 1 minute. Pour in the sauce and cook until the rice is heated through, about 5 minutes, stirring frequently. Serve hot.

American Dishes

A Pilgrim's Lentil Pottage

Serving Size : 8 Preparation Time :1:00

Categories : American Legumes

Soups & Stews Vegetables

Healthy And Hearty

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

2 teaspoons olive oil

2 cloves garlic -- finely chopped

1 medium onion -- chopped

8 cups cold water

1 1/2 cups lentils -- rinsed and drained

3 tablespoons ketchup

1/8 teaspoon ground cloves

1 1/2 teaspoons salt and pepper -- or to taste dash freshly ground black pepper

In a large soup kettle, heat oil over medium heat. Stir in garlic, carrots and onion. Cook, stirring constantly, until vegetables wilt but not brown.

Add water, lentils, ketchup, cloves and salt; cover and bring to a boil. Reduce heat to low and cook, stirring occasionally, 45 minutes or until lentils are tender. If soup gets too thick, add more water.

Reheat before serving, adding pepper. Add vinegar, wine or lemon juice for extra flavor. NOTES : For a variation, refrigerate overnight to allow flavors to blend.

Baked French Fries

Serving Size : 8 Preparation Time :0:50

Categories : American Starchy Vegetables

Vegetarian

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

4 baking potatoes -- sliced into strips

pan spray

salt & pepper -- to taste

1. Preheat oven to 450 degrees. Soak potato strips in ice water for 15 minutes.

2. Pan spray two 9x13-inch cookie sheets. Drain potatoes, pat dry, and place on cookie sheets. Bake for 30 minutes, or until golden. Salt and pepper to taste.

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Vegetarian Recipes Collection CanadaOnlineBusiness A feast of delightful vegetarian dishes

Banana Muffins

Categories : American Breads

Breakfast Cereals/Grains

Healthy And Hearty

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

3		very ripe bananas (about 1 1/2 cups puree)
1/2 cup		apple juice, frozen concentrate
2	tablespoons	apple juice, frozen concentrate
1	tablespoon	orange juice, frozen concentrate
2	tablespoons	vegetable oil
1	teaspoon	fresh lemon juice
1 1/4 cups		whole-wheat flour
3/4 cup		wheat germ
1 1/2	teaspoons	ground cinnamon
2	teaspoons	baking powder
3/4 cup		raisins or chopped dates
1/2 cup		walnuts -- coarsely chopped

Preheat oven to 375 degrees.

Process the bananas, juice concentrates, oil, and lemon juice in a blender until smooth. Combine the flour, wheat germ, cinnamon, and baking powder in a mixer bowl.

Stir the banana mixture into the dry ingredients to make a thick batter; then stir in the raisins and walnuts.

Spoon the batter into 18 muffin cups coated with vegetable cooking spray. Bake for 20 to 25 minutes. Remove from the tins immediately.

2 muffins = 1 1/2 Whole-Grain servings; 1 Other Fruit serving.

Classic Black Bean Soup

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :3:30

Categories : American Healthy And Hearty

Legumes Main Course

Soups & Stews Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 3/4 cups black beans -- soaked overnight

12 cups water

2 teaspoons olive oil

1 1/2 cups onion -- diced

2 teaspoons garlic -- minced

1/2 cup green onion -- diced

3/4 cup carrot -- diced

3/4 cup red bell pepper -- diced

2 teaspoons ground sage

1 bay leaf

1 teaspoon ground rock salt or salt-free seasoning

2 teaspoons powdered vegetable broth (1 veg. bullion)

dash freshly ground pepper -- to taste

Discard soaking water from beans. Beans will have swollen to much more than 1 3/4 cups, so do not remeasure the soaked beans.

In large, heavy bottomed soup pot, heat olive oil or water and onion, garlic, green onion, carrot, and red pepper. Add sage and bay leaf and saute for several minutes or until onions begin to wilt. Add soaked and drained beans and fresh water. Bring to a boil and skim off any scum that may form on the top.

Reduce cooking temperature to low, cover soup and allow to cook for 3 hours, stirring occasionally and taking care that heat is low enough so that beans do not stick. At end of cooking time, uncover and allow soup to continue cooking as you stir in salt, if desired, powdered vegetable broth and fresh pepper to taste. Discard bay leaf. Use hand blender to puree soup to desired consistency, breaking down only about half the beans, or transfer half the soup to a blender, puree and return to soup pot. Adjust seasonings.

Corn Berry Muffins

Preparation Time :0:45

Categories : American

Breads Breakfast

Cereals/Grains Healthy And Hearty

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 cup whole-grain cornmeal

1/2 cup whole-wheat flour

1/4 cup wheat germ

1 1/2 teaspoons baking soda

2/3 cup low-fat buttermilk

1/4 cup apple juice, frozen concentrate

3 tablespoons apple juice, frozen concentrate

2 egg whites -- lightly beaten

1/4 cup vegetable oil

1 2/3 cups fresh or frozen blueberries (or raisins)

vegetable cooking spray

Preheat oven to 400 degrees.

Combine the cornmeal, flour, wheat germ, and baking soda in a mixing bowl. Beat the buttermilk, juice concentrate, egg whites, and oil in separate bowl. Add the liquid ingredients to the dry ingredients and blend well with a few strokes.

Fold in the blueberries or raisins until distributed evenly.

Spoon the batter into 12 muffin cups coated with vegetable cooking spray. Bake until lightly browned, about 20 minutes. Remove from the tins immediately.

2 muffins = 1 Whole Grain Serving

Cranberry-Orange Relish

Serving Size : 1 Preparation Time :0:45

Categories : American Fruit

Salsa & Chutneys Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 pound fresh or frozen cranberries

1 thin-skinned organic orange. no seeds -- washed and cut

2 cups sugar

TWO DAYS BEFORE:

Combine cranberries and orange in bowl of food processor. Chop into fine small bits being careful not to over puree. Transfer mixture to a large mixing bowl; add sugar and stir well. Transfer mixture to a jar; cover tightly. Allow to macerate in the refrigerator 2 days before using. Makes about 3 1/2 cups.

NOTES : When using unpeeled oranges or zest in recipes, use organic fruit to avoid possible pesticide residue on the fruit skin. If organic oranges are not available, scrub orange thoroughly before using.

Cranberry-Pineapple Relish

Recipe By : Lillian Kayte, Vegetarian Times, Nov 95, pg 48

Serving Size : 1 Preparation Time :0:45

Categories : American Fruit

Salsa & Chutneys Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 pound fresh or frozen cranberries

1 cup pineapple -- chopped

2 cups sugar

TWO DAYS BEFORE:

Combine cranberries and pineapple in bowl of food processor. Chop into fine small bits being careful not to over puree. Transfer mixture to a large mixing bowl; add sugar and stir well. Transfer mixture to a jar; cover tightly. Allow to macerate in the refrigerator 2 days before using. Makes about 3 1/2 cups.

Crisp Candied Sweet Potatoes

Serving Size : 8 Preparation Time :1:00

Categories : American Starchy Vegetables

Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

6 large sweet potato

2 tablespoons margarine

3/4 cup dark brown sugar

1/2 cup water

pinch salt

pinch ground ginger

Place potatoes in a large pan; cover with cold water. Bring to a boil; cook 10 minutes. Plunge potatoes into cold water to stop cooking. When cool enough to handle, peel and discard skin. Cut potatoes into thick slices or chunks; refrigerate. (If desired, this can be done the day before.)

In a large nonstick skillet, melt margarine. Add brown sugar, water, salt, and ginger. Bring to a simmer; add half of potato slices in one layer. Cook at a slow boil over medium heat until potatoes are brown and crisp around edges. Turn; brown other side. With a slotted spoon, transfer potatoes to a platter; reserve in a warm place near the stove. Add remaining potatoes to skillet; cook as the first batch. Serve immediately.

Double Crust Pie Pastry

Serving Size : 16 Preparation Time :0:20

Categories : American Desserts

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

2 cups flour

1 teaspoon salt

2/3 cup margarine

7 tablespoons cold water

Stir together flour and salt. Cut in margarine till pieces are the size of small peas. Sprinkle 1 tablespoon of the water over part of the mixture; gently toss with a fork. Push to side of bowl. Repeat till all is moistened. Form dough into a ball. On a lightly floured surface, flatten dough with hands. Roll dough from center to edge, forming a circle about 12 inches in diameter. Ease pastry into a 9-inch pie plate, being careful not to stretch pastry. Trim pastry.

Fluffy Garlic Mashed Potatoes

Recipe By : Lillian Kayte, Vegetarian Times, Nov 95, pg 46

Serving Size : 8 Preparation Time :1:40

Categories : American Starchy Vegetables

Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

- 1 large head garlic, split in half horizontally
- 1 teaspoon olive oil
- 3 large baking potatoes -- peeled & quartered
- 3 tablespoons low-fat margarine
- 1 cup low-fat milk or soymilk
- salt -- to taste
- 1/4 teaspoon ground white pepper

Preheat oven to 350 degrees.

Drizzle garlic with oil. Wrap securely in foil; roast 30 to 40 minutes, or until soft. Cool, then squeeze garlic out of skins; refrigerate. Discard skins. (If desired, garlic can be roasted the day before.)

Cover potatoes with water, add salt and bring to a boil. cover; cook 20 to 30 minutes, or until fork-tender. Drain; reserve cooking water. Mash potatoes well. Add garlic, margarine, salt, pepper and milk or soymilk. Whip potatoes, adding reserved cooking liquid 1/4 cup at a time until potatoes are fluffy and light but still hold shape.

Hearty Split Pea Soup with Beans and Barley

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :3:00

Categories : American Cereals/Grains

Healthy And Hearty Legumes

Main Course Soups & Stews

Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

14 cups water

2 cups onions -- diced

1 1/2 cups carrots -- diced

2 cups celery -- diced

2/3 cup fresh parsley -- minced

4 green onion -- thinly sliced

2 cloves garlic -- minced

1 medium zucchini -- quartered & sliced

1/3 cup green split peas

1/3 cup yellow split peas

2 1/2 tablespoons barley

2 tablespoons baby lima beans or other tiny white beans

3 tablespoons ajuki beans

1 tablespoon powdered vegetable broth

dash seasoned salt or any salt-free seasoning

dash freshly ground pepper

Bring water to a boil in a large soup pot. Add the ingredients in the order given, except for the salt and pepper, which can be added at the end of the cooking time. Return soup to a boil, skimming off any foam or scum that comes to the surface with a large spoon. (Repeat this skimming process several times in the first half-hour of cooking, until no more scum forms.) Cover and reduce heat to medium-low. Simmer soup for 2 1/2 hours, stirring periodically to ensure that the barley isn't sticking. At end of cooking time, adjust seasonings to taste.

Single Crust Pie Pastry

Recipe By : Betty Crocker New CookBook, front inside cover

Serving Size : 8 Preparation Time :0:15

Categories : American Desserts

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 1/4 cups flour

1/2 teaspoon salt

1/3 cup margarine

4 tablespoons cold water

Stir together flour and salt. Cut in margarine till pieces are the size of small peas. Sprinkle 1 tablespoon of the water over part of the mixture; gently toss with a fork. Push to side of bowl. Repeat till all is moistened. Form dough into a ball. On a lightly floured surface, flatten dough with hands. Roll dough from center to edge, forming a circle about 12 inches in diameter. Ease pastry into a 9-inch pie plate, being careful not to stretch pastry. Trim pastry.

Banana Rice Pudding

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:40

Categories : Cereals/Grains Desserts

Fruit Breakfast

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 1/2 cups brown rice -- cooked
1 cup nonfat milk
1 medium banana -- cut in slices
1 can fruit (15-ounce can) -- cut in slices
1/4 cup water
2 tablespoons honey
1 teaspoon pure vanilla extract
1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon
1/2 teaspoon ground nutmeg

In a medium-size saucepan, combine the banana and fruit slices, water, honey, vanilla, cinnamon and nutmeg. Bring to a boil, reduce the heat, and simmer for 10 minutes, or until quite tender but not mushy. Add the rice and milk and mix thoroughly. Bring to a boil and simmer 10 more minutes. Serve warm.

Cashew Chili

Recipe By : Paulette Mitchell, Veg. Menu Cookbook, pg 110

Serving Size : 8 Preparation Time :1:30

Categories : Main Course Legumes

Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

3 tablespoons butter

1 medium onion -- chopped

2 stalks celery -- chopped

2 cups cooked kidney beans -- drained

1 1/2 cups tomato sauce (2 8-ounce cans)

2 teaspoons chili powder

3 drops hot pepper sauce

1 teaspoon ground cumin

2 cloves garlic -- minced

1 teaspoon dried basil

1 teaspoon dried oregano

1 bay leaf

1/2 teaspoon pepper

1 cup raisins

1 cup whole raw cashews

Monterey Jack or cheddar cheese -- grated

In a large saucepan or Dutch oven, melt the butter. Saute the onion, green pepper, and celery until crisp-tender, about 10 minutes. Add the beans, tomato sauce, corn, tomatoes, chili powder, pepper sauce, cumin, garlic basil, oregano, bay leaf, and pepper. bring to a boil; reduce heat and simmer 30 minutes to blend flavors. Stir in the raisins and cashews; continue to simmer until the raisins are plump and the cashews are tender, about 20 minutes. To serve, ladle into bowls and top each serving with grated cheese. Serve with additional cheese.

Classic Black Bean Soup

Recipe By : Marilyn Diamond, American Vegetarian Cookbook, pg 207

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :3:30

Categories : American Healthy And Hearty

Legumes Main Course

Soups & Stews Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 3/4 cups black beans -- soaked overnight

12 cups water

2 teaspoons olive oil

1 1/2 cups onion -- diced

2 teaspoons garlic -- minced

1/2 cup green onion -- diced

3/4 cup carrot -- diced

3/4 cup red bell pepper -- diced

2 teaspoons ground sage

1 bay leaf

1 teaspoon ground rock salt or salt-free seasoning

2 teaspoons powdered vegetable broth (1 veg. bullion)

dash freshly ground pepper -- to taste

Discard soaking water from beans. Beans will have swollen to much more than 1 3/4 cups, so do not remeasure the soaked beans. In large, heavy bottomed soup pot, heat olive oil or water and onion, garlic, green onion, carrot, and red pepper. Add sage and bay leaf and saute for several minutes or until onions begin to wilt. Add soaked and drained beans and fresh water. Bring to a boil and skim off any scum that may form on the top. Reduce cooking temperature to low, cover soup and allow to cook for 3 hours, stirring occasionally and taking care that heat is low enough so that beans do not stick. At end of cooking time, uncover and allow soup to continue cooking as you stir in salt, if desired, powdered vegetable broth and fresh pepper to taste. Discard bay leaf. Use hand blender to puree soup to desired consistency, breaking down only about half the beans, or transfer half the soup to a blender, puree and return to soup pot. Adjust seasonings.

Green Pea-Carrot Soup

Recipe By : Paulette Mitchell, Veg. Menu Cookbook, pg 82

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :1:00

Categories : Soups & Stews Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 1/2 cups water

2 pounds peas, shelled or 6 cups frozen peas

1/4 cup onion -- chopped

1/4 teaspoon white pepper

1 tablespoon honey

2 tablespoons whole wheat flour

2 cups milk or light cream

1/4 teaspoon ground nutmeg

2 cups sliced carrots -- steamed lightly

3/4 cup yogurt

In a large saucepan or Dutch oven, bring the water to a boil. Add the peas, onion, pepper, and honey. Return to a boil; reduce heat to low, cover, and cook for 20 minutes. Pour 2 cups of the water-and-pea mixture into a food processor or blender. Process until smooth. Pour into a large bowl or saucepan and set aside. Puree another 2 cups of the mixture. Repeat the steps until all the mixture has been pureed. (The puree may be stored up to 2 days, if desired.)

When ready to serve the soup, pour the pureed mixture into a saucepan and heat slowly over low heat. In a small bowl, mix the flour, milk, and nutmeg; stir until smooth. Add this mixture to the warmed soup. Increase heat to medium and stir constantly until mixture just reaches the boiling point, but be careful not to boil. Stir in the carrot slices and continue to heat the mixture for 5 minutes over low heat. Taste for seasonings and consistency. For a thinner soup, add more milk. Ladle into soup bowls; garnish each serving with a dollop of yogurt; serve immediately.

My Favorite Granola

Recipe By : Debbie Meadows

Serving Size : 1 Preparation Time :0:45

Categories : Breakfast Cereals/Grains

Fruit Healthy And Hearty

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

4	cups	rolled oats
1	cup	wheat germ
1/2	cup	nonfat dry milk
1	cup	nuts -- chopped
3	tablespoons	nutritional yeast
1	cup	hot water
1/3	cup	honey
1/4	cup	molasses
2	teaspoons	vanilla extract
1	cup	dried fruit -- chopped

Preheat oven to 350 degrees. In a large bowl, mix together oats, wheat germ, dry milk, nuts and nutritional yeast. In a small bowl, stir together hot water, honey, molasses, and vanilla. Add to dry mixture, stir thoroughly. Spread mixture evenly on lightly greased baking sheet. Bake,

stirring frequently, until lightly browned, about 30 minutes. Sprinkle with fruit and allow to cool.

When completely cooled, store granola in covered containers. Serving Ideas : Serve with milk or yogurt and fresh fruit.

Spinach-Stuffed Tomatoes

Serving Size : 4 Preparation Time :0:45

Categories : Vegetables

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

10 ounces package frozen spinach
4 medium tomatoes -- firm
1 cup mozzarella cheese -- shredded
1/4 cup onions -- finely minced
1/4 cup grated parmesan cheese
1/2 teaspoon salt
1/8 teaspoon pepper
2 tablespoons parsley -- minced

Cook unopened spinach on high for 4 minutes. Let stand 5 minutes, drain well and squeeze dry. Put in large bowl. Slice and hollow out centers of tomatoes. Discard seeds. Chop pulp finely and add to spinach. Invert tomatoes shells on paper towels to drain. Preheat oven to 350 degrees.

Add 1/2 cup mozzarella cheese, onion, parmesan, salt & pepper to spinach mixture and blend well. Spoon evenly into shells. Sprinkle with remaining mozzarella and parsely. Arrange in 8- inch round glass or ceramic baking dish & cook at 350 degrees for 6 minutes or until heated through.

Vegetarian Sausage

BIONIC BREAKFAST SAUSAGES

Serving Size : 8

Categories : Vegetarian Sausage

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 cup Raw bulgur wheat* -- cooked

1/4 cup Gluten or whole wheat flour

1 1/2 teaspoons Ener-G egg replacer mixed -- well with 2 T. water

1 tablespoon Nutritional yeast

2 tablespoons Tamari

1 teaspoon Dried basil leaves

1/2 teaspoon Poultry seasoning

1/2 teaspoon Paprika

1/2 teaspoon Sage

1/2 teaspoon Garlic powder

1/2 teaspoon Black pepper

1/4 teaspoon Crushed dried red pepper -- flakes

*To cook bulgur wheat: Put one cup bulgur wheat in a saucepan with 2 1/2 cups water and one teaspoon salt. Bring to a boil, then turn down to medium-low and simmer for 20 to 25 minutes. Remove from heat and let stand for 10 minutes before using.

In a bowl, mix cooked bulgur wheat and gluten or whole wheat flour well.

Add nutritional yeast to egg replacer and water; mix into bulgur mixture. Add tamari and the rest of the seasonings, mixing well.

Form into patties and saute in a little vegetable oil in a nonstick skillet on medium-high heat for about 5 minutes on each side. OR bake them on a greased cookie sheet in a 350 degree F. oven for 20 to 25 minutes or until crispy brown on the outside.

BLACK BEAN SAUSAGE WITH TOFU AND FRESH CORN

Serving Size : 8

Categories : Vegetarian Sausage

2 small Shallots

3 large Cloves garlic

1 bn Fresh cilantro

3/4 cup Vegetable stock

1 tablespoon Vegetable oil

2 cups Cooked black beans

1/2 teaspoon Salt

1/2 teaspoon Ground white pepper

1/2 medium Green bell pepper

1 small Carrot -- peeled

1/4 cup Firm tofu

1/4 cup Fresh corn kernels

Mince the shallots and garlic. Chop the cilantro. Set aside.

Heat oil in a heavy saute pan over moderate heat. When oil is hot, add the shallots and garlic.

Saute for 2 to 3 minutes or until tender. Set aside to cool.

Place the beans, salt, and white pepper in a food processor fitted with a metal blade and process

until beans are pureed. Transfer to a large bowl.

To make garnis, remove seeds and membrane from the bell pepper. Cut the pepper and carrot into very small (1/8 in.) dice.

Heat oil in a saute pan over moderate heat. When oil is hot, add pepper and carrots and saute for

2 to 3 minutes or until tender. Cool _completely_.

Drain and towel dry tofu. Cut the tofu into very small (1/8 in.) dice. Add tofu, corn, and cooled sauteed vegetables to bean mixture, stirring to combine. Transfer to a bowl.

Pour stock into a double boiler. Sprinkle the surface with gelatin and allow it to _bloom_ for about 10 minutes. Heat gelatin to a syrupy consistency over water that is 100 to 110 degees F.

Set the bowl of bean/vegetable misture into a large bowl filled with ice and stir occasionally as it

cools. Add the gelatin. folding to combine, and continue stirring until thickened and well chilled.

To assemble sausage, spoon mixture onto a sheet of plastic wrap in a long line. Roll up (like a cigar), twisting the ends closed and securing with butcher's twine, if desired. Chill 3 or 4 hours or overnight.

To serve, remove plastic and cut on the bias into 1/2-inch- thick slices.

HERBAL BEAN SAUSAGES

Serving Size : 12

Categories : Vegetarian Sausage

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

2 cups Cooked pinto beans

1/2 cup Whole wheat breadcrumbs

1/2 cup Onion -- minced

1 Garlic clove -- minced

1/2 cup Tomato sauce

1/8 teaspoon Fennel seed -- crushed

1/8 teaspoon Dried red pepper

1/8 teaspoon Dried basil -- -OR-

1/2 teaspoon -Fresh basil

1 1/2 teaspoons Chopped fresh parsley

Salt -- to taste

-----MUSHROOM-RED PEPPER SAUCE-----

1 Red bell pepper -- minced

1/8 cup Vegetable broth or water -- OR- more as needed

4 large Mushrooms -- minced

1/4 cup Onion -- minced

Salt -- to taste

1/8 teaspoon Celery seed

1/2 teaspoon Chopped fresh oregano

1 dash Black pepper

Whole wheat flour

These plant-based sausages taste great, contain no added fat except the vegetable oil they're fried

in, and are easy to make. These ingredients yield fairly mild sausages; after you've tried them, adjust the seasonings to please your palate.

DIRECTIONS: Combine all ingredients in a mixing bowl, mix thoroughly, and shape into 1- to

2-inch sausages. Saute in a small amount of vegetable oil until crisp, or place in a baking pan and

broil, turning when edges are slightly crisp. Serve with Mushroom-Red Pepper Sauce (below). MUSHROOM-RED PEPPER SAUCE: Cook red pepper in vegetable broth for 5 to 7 minutes until tender. Add mushrooms, onion, salt, celery seed, oregano, and black pepper. Cook 5 minutes longer or until onion is transparent. Quickly whisk in enough flour to just thicken the sauce, about 2 tablespoons at a time. Immediately remove from burner. Do not overcook, or flour will cake. If needed, add more vegetable broth or water. Serve over sausages, whole grains, or vegetables.

SAUSAGE PATTIES

Serving Size : 2

Categories : Vegetarian Sausage

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

8 ounces Tempeh

-----REGULAR SEASONINGS-----

1/2 teaspoon Sage

1/2 teaspoon Marjoram

1/2 teaspoon Thyme

1/2 teaspoon Cumin

2 tablespoons -Warm water

2 tablespoons Soy sauce

2 tablespoons Oil

-----ITALIAN SAUSAGE SEASONINGS-----

2 Garlic cloves -- pressed

1/2 teaspoon Red pepper flakes

1 teaspoon Oregano

1/4 teaspoon Black pepper

2 tablespoons Flour

2 tablespoons Oil

2 tablespoons Soy sauce

Steam tempeh for 15 minutes. Cool, grate on coarse side of grater. Mix together dry seasonings, then stir in water, oil and soy sauce. Press firmly into thin patties. Fry in a little oil until browned on both sides.

Italian Sausage: Grate the steamed tempeh. Mix together dry seasonings.

Combine tempeh, dry seasonings, oil and soy sauce. Press into thin patties or crumble on top of pizza before it is baked.

From The Farm Vegetarian Cookbook. Uploaded by Nan Blanchard

VEGETABLE SAUSAGE (HOY JAW)

Serving Size : 4

Categories : Vegetarian Sausage

1 tablespoon Flour

2 tablespoons -Water

1 teaspoon Coarsely chopped garlic

1 teaspoon Coriander root -- - (coarsely chopped)

1 teaspoon Whole black peppercorns

2 tablespoons Oil

2 ounces Taro -- peeled

and coarsely chopped

1 Carrot (more if desired) -- - coarsely chopped

1/2 cup Water chestnuts -- - coarsely chopped

2 ounces Pre-soaked Chinese mushrooms -- - coarsely chopped

1/2 cup Beansprouts -- coarsly chopped

2 tablespoons Light soy sauce

1 teaspoon Sugar

3 large Beancurd sheets

Oil -- for deep-frying

Lettuce

Mint leaves

Mix the flour and water to form a paste and set aside. In a mortar pound together the garlic, coriander root and peppercorns to form a paste. Heat the oil and briefly fry the garlic paste, then add all the remaining ingredients down to and including the sugar, stirring constantly. Add the flour and water paste and stir to thicken. Remove from the heat and leave to cool.

Drain the beancurd sheets and spread out on a flat surface. Place a line of the cooled filling along one edge of each sheet and roll to form a long sausage. Place the 3 sausages in a steamer and steam for 15 minutes. Remove and leave to cool. When ready to serve, deep-fry the sausages until golden brown, drain and slice into 1/4-inch (6 mm) rounds and serve on a bed of lettuce and mint leaves with Plum Sauce.

Apricot Whip

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:30

Categories : Desserts Fruit

1 1/2 cups dried apricots

1 1/2 cups yogurt

2 tablespoons honey

2 tablespoons chopped pecans

Cover apricots with hot water and soak for 30 minutes. Drain well.

In a food processor or blender, combine the apricots, yogurt, and honey. Process until smooth. Chill.

NOTES : To serve, sprinkle nuts on each portion.

Banana Rice Pudding

Recipe By : Dean Ornish, Eat More, Weigh Less, pg 361

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:40

Categories : Cereals/Grains Desserts

Fruit Breakfast

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 1/2 cups brown rice -- cooked
1 cup nonfat milk
1 medium banana -- cut in slices
1 can fruit (15-ounce can) -- cut in slices
1/4 cup water
2 tablespoons honey
1 teaspoon pure vanilla extract
1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon
1/2 teaspoon ground nutmeg

In a medium-size saucepan, combine the banana and fruit slices, water, honey, vanilla, cinnamon and nutmeg. Bring to a boil, reduce the heat, and simmer for 10 minutes, or until quite tender but not mushy.

Add the rice and milk and mix thoroughly. Bring to a boil and simmer 10 more minutes. Serve warm.

Cantaloupe Melba

Serving Size : 8 Preparation Time :0:00

Categories : Desserts Vegetarian

Fruit

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

2 cups Fresh raspberries*

1/3 cup Sugar

2 tablespoons Orange-flavored liqueur**

2 each Cantaloupes

3 cups Raspberry sherbet

* Or unsweetened frozen raspberries, defrosted **Or raspberry-flavored brandy (optional)

In a blender or food processor, whirl raspberries until pureed. Pour through a sieve to remove seeds. Stir sugar and liqueur (if used) into puree and mix well; cover and chill.

Halve cantaloupes and remove seeds; peel and cut into thin slices.

Line each of 8 small dessert bowls or goblets with 3 or 4 melon slices.

Top melon with a scoop of sherbet and pour 2 tablespoons chilled raspberry sauce over sherbet. Raspberry sherbet in goblets lined with sliced cantaloupe and topped with Melba sauce would make a memorable finale for a menu featuring an egg and cheese dish.

Per Serving (including liqueur): 2 grams protein, 45 grams carbohydrate, no cholesterol, 186 calories.

Double Crust Pie Pastry

Recipe By : Betty Crocker New CookBook, front inside cover

Serving Size : 16 Preparation Time :0:20

Categories : American Desserts

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

2 cups flour

1 teaspoon salt

2/3 cup margarine

7 tablespoons cold water

Stir together flour and salt. Cut in margarine till pieces are the size of small peas. Sprinkle 1 tablespoon of the water over part of the mixture; gently toss with a fork. Push to side of bowl. Repeat till all is moistened. Form dough into a ball. On a lightly floured surface, flatten dough with hands. Roll dough from center to edge, forming a circle about 12 inches in diameter. Ease pastry into a 9-inch pie plate, being careful not to stretch pastry. Trim pastry.

Pecan-Topped Brie

Recipe By : Paulette Mitchell, Veg. Menu Cookbook

Serving Size : 6 Preparation Time :0:30

Categories : Appetizers Desserts

Fruit

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

8 ounces Brie -- whole cheese

2 teaspoons butter -- melted

1/4 cup pecan halves

2 apples -- cut in wedges

2 pears -- cut in wedges

Preheat oven to 350 degrees.

Place Brie in a 6-inch round baking dish; brush with melted butter. Arrange pecan halves decoratively on top. Bake just until cheese begins to melt, 10 to 15 minutes. To serve, scoop up with apple or pear wedges, or spread on slices of bread.

Single Crust Pie Pastry

Recipe By : Betty Crocker New CookBook, front inside cover

Serving Size : 8 Preparation Time :0:15

Categories : American Desserts

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 1/4 cups flour

1/2 teaspoon salt

1/3 cup margarine

4 tablespoons cold water

Stir together flour and salt. Cut in margarine till pieces are the size of small peas. Sprinkle 1 tablespoon of the water over part of the mixture; gently toss with a fork. Push to side of bowl. Repeat till all is moistened. Form dough into a ball. On a lightly floured surface, flatten dough with hands. Roll dough from center to edge, forming a circle about 12 inches in diameter. Ease pastry into a 9-inch pie plate, being careful not to stretch pastry. Trim pastry.

CARROTS (CALIFORNIA ORANGE STYLE)

Serving Size : 6

Categories : Vegetarian Fat-Free Low-Fat

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 pound Carrots -- peel & slice 1/4"

1/2 teaspoon Salt -- optional

3/4 cup Water

1 teaspoon Orange peel -- grated

1 Orange sections -- peeled and -- into bite-size piece

1 tablespoon Green onion; minced -- optiona

Butter buds. -- sprinkle

Preparation Time: 0:45 In lg saucepan, cook carrots, covered in salted water until crisp-tender, about 20 min.

Drain

Add orange peel, orange sections and onion. Sprinkle with Butter Buds.

Heat through.

Serve immediately.

CHOCOLATE GRAND MARNIER SOUFFLE

Serving Size : 8

Categories : Desserts Low-Fat Vegetarian

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 cup Chocolate or carob chips
1 pound Firm tofu (water packed)
1/2 cup Cocoa or carob powder
3/4 cup Honey
3 tablespoons Grand marnier
1 teaspoon Vanilla
1/2 cup Soy milk
1/2 cup Unbleached white flour
1 teaspoon Baking powder`

Preheat oven to 350F. Place chocolate chips or carob in a bowl & place it in hot water to melt stirring with a spoon. Place remaining ingredients in a food processor & blend till smooth & creamy. Add melted chocolate & puree a few moments. Pour into a very lightly oiled 1-quart souffle dish.

Bake for 40 to 45 minutes, or until the souffle has completely puffed up. Cool for 5 minutes.

CHUNKY LEEK AND POTATO SOUP

Serving Size : 2

Categories : Low-Fat Vegetarian

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1/2 pound Potatoes

1 pint Cold water

1 medium Leek

1 Garlic clove

1/2 medium Onion

1/4 tablespoon Oil

1/2 teaspoon Yeast extract

1/2 teaspoon Ground black pepper

1 Bay leaf

1/4 teaspoon Caraway seed

1 Celery stalk

Peel and cube the potatoes Place in a large bowl with the cold water Leave to one side Top and tail the leeks, then slice into chunks Wash in a bowl of cold water, drain and rinse Leave to drain in a colander Finely chop the onion Saute the garlic and onions in a large deep saucepan in the

oil until tender. Add the potatoes and the water they have been sitting in. Increase the heat

bringing the liquid to a rolling boil Add the yeast extract Stir well, reduce heat and add the leeks, black pepper, bay leaves and caraway seed. Stir well for 1-2 minutes Add the celery to the soup and simmer for a further 15 minutes. Serve hot.

ASPARAGUS GUACAMOLE

Serving Size : 1

Categories : Vegetarian Low-Fat

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 pound Asparaus spears (cut into 1 Inch lengths) 2 cups

3/4 cup Water

2 tablespoons Plain nonfat yogurt

1 tablespoon Lemon juice

1 medium Tomato -- seeded and chopped (1 cup)

2 tablespoons Sliced green onion

1 teaspoon Ground cumin

1 Clove garlic minced

1/2 teaspoon Dried oregano

1/4 teaspoon Salt

1/4 teaspoon Cayenne

Combine asparagus and water in a 2-quart saucepan. Bring to a boil over medium-high heat to medium-low. Simmer 8-110 minutes, or until asparagus is tender. Rinse with cold water; drain. Blot asparagus with paper towel to remove excess moisture. Combine asparagus, yogurt and lemon juice in a food processor or blender. Process until smooth. In a medium mixing bowl, combine asparagus mixture and remaining ingredients. Chill, if desired.

Serve with raw veggies or tortilla chips. Makes 12 servings. Per serving:

12 cal.; 1 gm. Fat

BAKED APPLES AND CHESTNUT PUREE

Serving Size : 6

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 pound Fresh chestnuts OR

1 1/2 cups Canned or bottled chestnuts -- -OR

4 ounces Dried chestnuts -- cooked

1/3 cup Soy milk

1/3 cup Apple juice

5 tablespoons Maple syrup

1 teaspoon Cinnamon

1/4 teaspoon Nutmeg

1/3 cup Raisins or currants

6 each Sweet apples

Few tb lemon juice

Additional cinnamon

3/4 cup White wine

3 tablespoons Margarine

1 each Cinnamon stick

Mint leaves & thin orange -- - slices for garnish

Preheat oven to 350F. To prepare fresh chestnuts, cook covered, in water, for 20 minutes till expanded & lighter in colour. To prepare canned chestnuts, cook in their liquid till heated through. To prepare dried chestnuts, cook according to package directions.

Drain & rinse hot chestnuts under cold water. Cut off flat part with a sharp knife & scoop nut meat with a spoon. In a food processor, combine chestnut meat with soy milk, juice, 4 tb maple syrup, 1 ts cinnamon & nutmeg. Fold in raisins or currants.

Peel apples & remove core from top, leaving the bottom intact.

Hollow out the apple leaving a 1/2" shell. Brush shell with lemon juice to prevent discoloration. Sprinkle inside with a little cinnamon. Chop scooped out apple & mix with the chestnut puree.

Fill apple shells with chestnut-apple stuffing. Place in a grease proof dish & pour wine &

remaining syrup around the base of the apples. Add margarine & cinnamon stick to the pan. Bake 30 to 40 minutes, basting occasionally with the wine mixture. Garnish & serve.

BAKED NOODLES WITH SPINACH & YOGURT

Serving Size : 2

Categories : Casseroles Low-Fat Vegetarian

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

4 ounces Noodles

1 1/2 teaspoons Salt

1 1/2 quarts Water -- boiling

8 ounces Yogurt

1/2 cup Cheese -- cottage

10 ounces Spinach; frozen -- thawed

2 tablespoons Onions -- chopped

1/2 cup Cheese, cheddar -- shredded

Gradually add noodles and salt to rapidly boiling water so that water continues to boil; cook, uncovered, stirring occasionally, until tender. Drain noodles in colander. Preheat oven to 400. Combine yogurt and cottage cheese; combine noodles, spinach and onion with cottage cheese mixture. Pour into a 1-quart baking dish; top with Cheddar cheese. Cover and bake 20-25 minutes. Uncover and bake until cheese is melted and brown.

BEAN-AND-CORN CHILI OVER PUFFED TORTILLA Serving Size : 4

Categories : Low-Fat Vegetarian

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

Soft flour tortillas -- 7" dia pkg for ones with -- no lard

1 cup Onion -- chopped

20 milliliters Garlic -- finely chopped

1/2 teaspoon Vegetable oil

14 ounces Italian-style plum tomatoes -- drained

3/4 teaspoon Ground cumin

1/8 teaspoon Fresh ground black pepper

1/8 teaspoon Red pepper flakes

15 1/4 ounces Kidney beans -- (reserve 1/4c liquid)

4 ounces Mild green chilies -- chopped

-- =or=

1/2 teaspoon Fresh jalapeno pepper

1 cup Frozen whole-kernel corn -- thawed

3 ounces Monterey Jack Cheese -- lowfat

Arrange tortillas on foil-lined baking sheet. Watching carefully, bake tortillas at 450F for 4 to 5 minutes until puffed and lightly golden.

Reserve. Saute onion and garlic in oil in a 12-inch nonstick skillet over medium heat for 3 to 4 minutes. Add tomatoes, cumin, black pepper, red pepper, kidney beans and reserved liquid, and

1/2 of the green chilies. Simmer for 5 minutes, stirring often. Add corn and cook 1 minute longer. Place a tortilla on each plate. Mound about 3/4 c of chili over each.

Sprinkle each with 1/4 of the cheese. Serve accompanied by the remaining green chilies.

BEANS 'N RICE SKILLET

Serving Size : 6

Categories : Vegetarian Low-Fat

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

-----SAUCE-----

1 cup Water

1/2 cup Thick and chunky salsa

2 (8 oz) cans no-salt-added

Tomato sauce

1 1/2 cups Uncooked instant white rice

1 cup Frozen whole kernel corn

1 cup Chopped red bell pepper

15 ounces Can black beans -- drained And rinsed

Combine sauce ingredients in large skillet; mix well. Bring to a boil.

Stir in all remaining ingredients. Reduce heat to low; cover and simmer about 10 minutes or until rice is cooked and vegetables are tender.

BLACK BEAN & RICE SALAD Serving Size : 4

Categories : Salads Main Dish Low-Fat Vegetarian Ovo-Lacto

2 cups Cooked rice -- cooled to room temperature

1 cup Cooked black beans

1 cup Chopped fresh tomato

2 ounces Cheddar cheese (optional) -- - shredded

1 tablespoon Snipped fresh parsley

1/4 cup Light Italian dressing

1 tablespoon Fresh lime juice

Lettuce leaves

Combine rice, beans, tomato, cheese (if desired), and parsley in large bowl. Pour dressing and lime juice over rice mixture; toss. Serve on lettuce leaves.

Each serving provides:

* 209 calories * 7.4 g. protein * 0.7 g. fat * 45.1 g. carbohydrate * 3.2 g. dietary fiber * 560 mg. sodium * 0 mg. cholesterol

NOTE: Optional ingredients are omitted from the nutritional analysis.

When ingredient choices appear in a recipe, the first ingredient is used for calculation.

Source: "Light, Lean & Low Fat" booklet Reprinted with permission from USA Rice Council

BLACK BEAN CHILAQUILES Serving Size : 8

Categories : Vegetarian Low-Fat

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

12 Corn Tortillas

1 Onion chopped

10 fluid ounces Stock

3 Cloves garlic crushed

1/2 teaspoon Cayenne pepper

1/2 teaspoon Ground cumin seed

1/2 teaspoon Chilli powder

2 pounds Cooked black beans -- or 3s (14 oz each) kidney -- beans drained

15 fluid ounces Tomato sauce flavoured with -- pinch each of cayenn

8 ounces Mozzarella cheese finely -- shredded

6 tablespoons Parmesan cheese

Chopped fresh coriander

Lime wedges

1. Pre-heat oven to 300 degrees F, 150 degrees C, gas mark 2.

2. Bake the tortillas directly on the oven shelf for 15 to 20 minutes, turning once until crisp right through. They will break with a clean snap. Break into coarse pieces and set aside.

3. Spread onion pieces out in a heavy frying pan. Cook over moderate heat without stirring until the onions are sizzling and beginning to stick to the pan. Stir in the stock and let it bubble up, stirring up the browned deposits in the pan as it bubbles. Stir in the garlic and the spices. Turn the heat down and simmer, stirring frequently until the mixture is thick, not at all soupy, and the

onions and spices are frying in their own juices. Don't rush this step. It is essential that the spices should not have a harsh raw taste.

4. Stir in the black beans and heat gently. Mash roughly while still in the pan, with a potato masher. You want a rough lumpy mixture, not a smooth puree. Set aside.

5. In a gratin dish spread a layer of a third of the tortilla pieces.

Spread a layer of the black beans over the tortillas and spread a third of the tomato sauce over the black beans. Sprinkle with one third of the cheeses. Repeat this, ending with a layer of the beans, sauce and cheeses.

6. Bake for 30 minutes covered. Uncover, and bake for 5 to 10 minutes more. Serve garnished with lime wedges.

BLACK FOREST CAKE

Serving Size : 12

Categories : Desserts Low-Fat Vegetarian

1 cup Water

1 cup Honey

1/2 cup Applesauce

1 teaspoon Vanilla

1 teaspoon Vinegar

2 cups Wholewheat pastry flour or -- - unbleached white flour

3/4 cup Cocoa powder

1 tablespoon Baking powder

1 teaspoon Baking soda

-----SYRUP-----

1/2 cup Water

1/4 cup Honey

2 each Thin lemon or orange slices

1/3 cup Kirsch

-----ICING-----

3/4 cup Raw cashews

3/4 cup Water

2 teaspoons Vanilla

1/2 cup Honey

10 ounces Firm tofu

3 ounces Semi-sweet chocolate -- melted

16 ounces Jar pitted cherries -- drained

CAKE: Preheat oven to 350F. Combine liquid ingredients in a large bowl & whisk well. Sift dry

ingredients together & whisk into liquid mixture.

Pour into greased & floured 9" cake tin & bake for 35 minutes or until springy.

Cool cake completely & remove from pan. With a serrated knife, cut cake horizontally to make 3 thin layers.

SYRUP: Combine first 3 ingredients in a small pot & boil for 3 minutes. Let cool & then add kirsch.

ICING: In a blender, combine cashews, water & vanilla. Blend till smooth & creamy. Add honey

& tofu & blend again. Set aside 2 c for the vanilla icing to go on top & sides of cake. To the rest

of the mixture, add melted chocolate & 3 tb of syrup. Blend till smooth. Chill both icings before using.

TO ASSEMBLE: Carefully remove the top two layers of cake. Brush some syrup onto bottom layer & spread half of chocolate icing over it. Place the middle cake layer on top & brush with syrup & icing. Put down a layer of cherries & dot with a little vanilla icing to help the top layer stick. Place the top layer on the cherries & brush again with syrup. Frost top & sides with vanilla icing. Decorate with cherries & pipe rosettes if desired.

Chill several hours before serving. The cake can be kept covered if not being served till the following day. However, the frosting may discolour after about 3 days.

BLACK-EYED PEAS AND BARLEY PILAF Serving Size : 4

2 cups Frozen peas -- thawed

3/4 cup Quick cooking barley

1/4 cup Parsley -- chopped

1/4 cup Onion -- chopped

1 teaspoon Thyme

1/2 teaspoon Salt

15 ounces Black eyed peas -- cooked

14 1/2 ounces Vegetable broth

Combine all ingredients in large skillet or saucepan. Bring to a boil.

Reduce heat; cover and simmer 15-20 minutes or until barley is tender. (Return to Recipe Index)

BLACK-EYED PEAS WITH SPINACH Serving Size : 1

Categories : Vegetarian Low-Fat

Amount Measure Ingredient -- Preparation Method

1 medium Onion -- chopped

Vegetable broth for Sauteeing

10 ounces Fresh spinach, rinsed Stemmed and coarsely chopped (I think frozen Would be fine)

3 cups Drained black-eyed peas (two 16 ounces Cans)

Ground black pepper to Taste

pn Cayenne or crushed red Pepper flakes (optional)

In a large skillet, saute the onions in the broth for a few minutes, until soft. Add the spinach to the skillet. Stir for a minute or two until it wilts. Add the black-eyed peas, black pepper, and cayenne if desired.

Bring to a simmer on medium heat. Serve right away, or cover and keep warm on low heat.

SPELT BREAD

Servings : 1

Categories : Breads Vegetarian

- 2 cups Spelt flour
- 1 package Quick-rising dry yeast
- 2 tablespoons Sugar or other granular, sweetener of salt
- 2/3 cup Very warm soy milk
- 2 tablespoons Melted margarine

In large bowl, combine flour, yeast, sugar, and salt. Stir in soy milk and 1 Tablespoon melted margarine until dough forms. Turn dough out onto floured board and knead about 3 minutes or until smooth.

Grease mixing bowl and place dough in bowl, turning to coat lightly. Cover and place in warm spot away from drafts. Let rise about 30 minutes.

Heat oven to 350 degrees. Place dough on greased baking sheet, or, if desired, bake in greased 8- x 4-inch loaf pan. Brush with remaining tablespoon of melted margarine and bake about 25 minutes or until golden and loaf sounds hollow when tapped on top.

SPICY BROWN BREAD

Servings : 1

Categories : Breads Quick Vegetarian

- 3/4 cup AM Blue Cornmeal
- 3/4 cup AM Whole Wheat Pastry Flour
- 2 teaspoons Non-alum baking powder
- 1/4 teaspoon Sea salt (optional)
- 2 tablespoons Carob powder
- 1/2 teaspoon Cinnamon
- 1/2 teaspoon Ginger
- 1/2 teaspoon Nutmeg
- 3/4 cup Milk or soymilk
- 1/2 cup Unsulphured molasses
- 1 teaspoon Lemon extract

Combine dry and liquid ingredients in separate bowls, then stir together until smooth. Batter seems thin but it will thicken. Pour batter into oiled pan. Bake at 350 F. for 20 minutes or until knife test proves done.

This recipe will make 6 large cupcakes or one 8 inch square pan.

Source: Arrowhead Mills "Blue Cornmeal Recipes" tri-fold Reprinted by permission of Arrowhead Mills, Inc.

Electronic format courtesy of: Karen Mintzias

SUPER FAST BREAD RECIPE

Servings : 1

Categories : Breads Sandwiches Vegetarian

3 cups Flour *see note below

1 2/3 cups ;water, cold

1 teaspoon Salt

1 tablespoon Yeast, dry

1 tablespoon Honey

: Heat 3 cups of flour for 2 minutes in the microwave.

: While that's happening, measure the water. Add salt, dry yeast and a dollop of honey. It

looks like a mess, but don't worry about it.

: Quickly take the hot flour and mix in the water combo with an electric mixer. It should

be sticky and gooey. If your mixer is having trouble, just add more water. Mix it around as long as you want.

: Now, cover it, put it in a cool place, go away and ignore it. Go to work, take a walk,

go to sleep, whatever. If you happen to pass the poor neglected thing during the day, pound

it around a little with a wet spoon. If you are going to ignore it for more than 8 hours, put it in the refrigerator. If you are in a hurry, ignore the ignoring part and proceed to the

next step.

: Pound your sticky dough around with a wet spoon to pop all the bubbles, then slop it

into a well oiled bread pan (do not whisper sweet nothings in its ear). Set a timer and let the dough rise in a warm spot for 10 minutes. If it was kept in the refrigerator, let it sit

a little longer. Set your timer again for 10 minutes and turn on your oven at 350 degrees. When it's hot, put the bread in and set the timer for 50 minutes.

Crunchy Vegetable Wraps

4 Tbsp. nondairy cream cheese

(try Tofutti brand)

4 10-inch flour tortillas

1 cup shredded spinach

1/4 cup alfalfa sprouts

1/2 cup shredded red cabbage

1/2 cup sliced avocado

1/4 cup chopped tomatoes

1/2 cup diced cucumbers

2 Tbsp. finely diced red onion

Salt and pepper, to taste

Spread 1 tablespoon of cream cheese over each tortilla. Sprinkle an even amount of the remaining ingredients on each wrap and roll up.

Makes 4 servings

Spinach Lasagna

1/2 lb. lasagna noodles

2 10-oz. packages frozen chopped spinach, thawed and drained

1 lb. soft tofu

1 lb. firm tofu

1 Tbsp. sugar

1/4 cup soy milk

1/2 tsp. garlic powder

2 Tbsp. lemon juice

3 tsp. minced fresh basil

2 tsp. salt

4 cups tomato sauce

Cook the lasagna noodles according to the package directions. Drain and set aside.

Preheat the oven to 350° F.

Squeeze the spinach as dry as possible and set aside.

Place the tofu, sugar, soy milk, garlic powder, lemon juice, basil, and salt in a food processor or blender and blend until smooth. Stir in the spinach.

Cover the bottom of a 9-inch-by-13-inch baking dish with a thin layer of tomato sauce, then a layer of noodles (use about one-third of the noodles). Follow with half of the tofu filling. Continue in the same order, using half of the remaining tomato sauce and noodles and all of the remaining tofu filling. End with the remaining noodles, covered by the remaining tomato sauce. Bake for 25 to 30 minutes.

Makes 6 to 8 servings

Fried "Chicken"

1 tsp. salt

1/2 tsp. onion powder

1 tsp. pepper

1 tsp. garlic powder

2 cups unbleached white flour

4 Tbsp. nutritional yeast (optional)

3 Tbsp. yellow mustard

1/2 cup water

2 Tbsp. baking powder

1 lb. mock chicken

(try Worthington Chic-Ketts or White Wave wheat meat)

3 & 1/2 cups vegetable oil

Mix together the salt, onion powder, pepper, garlic powder, flour, and nutritional yeast in a deep bowl. In a separate bowl, dilute the mustard with 1/2 cup water. Add 1/3 cup of the flour mixture to the mustard mixture and stir. Add the baking powder to the dry flour mixture and mix.

Dip chunks of the mock chicken into the mustard batter, then drop each chunk into the flour mixture and coat with the desired amount of "crust." Fry the chunks in hot oil on medium-high heat in a large skillet or deep fryer until crispy and golden brown, turning as needed.

Makes 4 servings

Creamy Potato Salad

6 medium potatoes

1/2 cup eggless mayonnaise

(try Nayonaise or Veganaise)

4 Tbsp. yellow mustard

2 Tbsp. distilled white vinegar

1/2 onion, chopped

1/2 cup chopped celery

Salt and pepper, to taste

Paprika (optional)

Cut the potatoes into cubes and

cook in boiling water for 20 minutes. Drain and let cool completely. In a large bowl, combine the potatoes with the remaining ingredients. Sprinkle paprika on top, if desired.

Makes 4 to 6 servings

Baked Potato Soup

2 large baking potatoes

3 Tbsp. margarine

1 large white onion, finely diced

2 Tbsp. flour

4 cups vegetable or vegetarian chicken-flavored stock

2 cups water

4 Tbsp. cornstarch

1 & 1/2 cups instant mashed potatoes

1 tsp. salt

3/4 tsp. pepper

1/2 tsp. basil

1/8 tsp. thyme

1 cup liquid nondairy creamer or plain soy or rice milk

Fake bacon bits, shredded soy cheese, and chopped green onions

Bake the potatoes at 400° F for

1 hour. Allow to cool.

Melt the margarine in a large saucepan and sauté the onion until translucent. Add the flour and stir to make a roux. Add the stock, water, cornstarch, instant mashed potatoes, and spices and bring to a boil. Reduce the heat and simmer for 5 minutes.

Cut the cooled potatoes in half and scoop out the contents. Discard the skins. Chop the potatoes into bite-size chunks and add them, along with the soy or rice milk or nondairy creamer, to the saucepan. Bring to a boil, then reduce the heat and simmer for 15 minutes, until thickened.

Spoon the soup into bowls and garnish with fake bacon bits, soy cheese, and green onions, if desired. Makes 6 servings

Sweet-and-Sour "Meatballs"

1 lb. ground beef substitute

(try Lightlife Gimme Lean)

1/2 green pepper, finely chopped

1 small onion, finely chopped

1-2 cloves garlic, crushed

2 slices white bread

Salt and pepper, to taste

Oil, for frying

6 oz. chili sauce

5 oz. red currant jelly

Combine all the ingredients, except the oil, chili sauce, and jelly, in a bowl and stir until well mixed. Heat the oil in a skillet, using enough to coat the bottom of the pan. Form the "beef" mixture into 1-inch balls and fry in the oil until browned.

Meanwhile, place the chili sauce and jelly in a saucepan. Heat and stir until smooth. When the mock meatballs are finished cooking, add them to the sauce and stir to coat well. Simmer over low heat for 5 to

10 minutes.

Makes approximately 20 1-inch balls.

Enchilada Bake

1 12-oz. bag Morningstar Farms burger crumbles

(or your favorite brand)

1 packet taco seasoning

2 Tbsp. vegetable oil

1/2 cup minced scallions

2 Tbsp. all-purpose flour

1 cup vegetable stock

2 cans pinto beans, drained

2 cans enchilada sauce

12 corn tortillas

1 bag shredded cheddar soy cheese

1 4.5-oz. can diced green chilies

1 bag Fritos, crushed

In a bowl, mix the burger crumbles with the taco seasoning and toss to coat. Set aside.

Heat the oil in a skillet over medium heat. Add the scallions and cook about 3 minutes or until softened. Stir in the flour and cook 1 minute. Add the stock and cook, stirring, to achieve a smooth consistency, about 1 minute longer. Add the pinto beans and set aside.

Preheat the oven to 375° F.

Spray a 9-inch-by-13-inch baking pan with oil. Cover the bottom of the pan with a layer of enchilada sauce. Layer in 4 corn tortillas and all of the pinto bean mixture. Follow with part of the soy cheese and green chilies, more enchilada sauce, and 4 more tortillas. Add the burger crumbles mixture, more soy cheese, more green chilies, and more enchilada sauce. End with the remaining 4 tortillas, enchilada sauce, and soy cheese. Cover with foil and bake for 30 minutes. Remove the foil, top the entire casserole with crumbled Fritos, and bake another 10 to 15 minutes, until bubbly and browned.

Makes 9 servings.

Shepherd's Pie

4 medium potatoes, diced

2 Tbsp. margarine

1/2 cup soy milk or liquid nondairy creamer

Salt and pepper, to taste

1 12-oz. bag Morningstar Farms burger crumbles (or your favorite brand)

1 can vegetarian mushroom gravy

1 small can mixed peas and carrots, drained

Salt, garlic powder, pepper, and cayenne pepper, to taste

Preheat the oven to 350° F.

Boil the potatoes for 20 minutes, or until tender. Drain and mash with the margarine and soy milk or nondairy creamer. Add salt and pepper, to taste.

In a medium bowl, mix the crumbles, mushroom gravy, peas, carrots, and spices. Pour into a pie pan. Top with the potatoes, spreading the potatoes to the edges of the pan. Bake for 30 to 40 minutes, until the potatoes are browned.

Makes 4 servings.

Ziti with Sun-Dried Tomato Cream

1 lb. ziti

1 cup chopped oil-marinated sun-dried tomatoes

1 cup firm silken tofu, drained and crumbled

3 cloves garlic, chopped

4 Tbsp. chopped fresh basil or

1 Tbsp. dried basil

2 Tbsp. balsamic vinegar

1 tsp. salt

1/8 tsp. pepper

2 Tbsp. olive oil

1 small can marinated artichokes, drained and chopped

2 Tbsp. minced fresh parsley

Soy parmesan (optional)

Cook the ziti al dente. Meanwhile, in a food processor, combine the tomatoes, tofu, garlic, basil, vinegar, salt, pepper, and olive oil. Process to a smooth consistency. Drain the pasta and toss with the sauce and artichokes. Sprinkle with the parsley and soy parmesan, if desired.

Makes 4 servings.

Chocolate Mousse

1 & 1/4 lbs. silken tofu

3/4 cup semisweet chocolate chips, melted

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Vegetarian Recipes Collection CanadaOnlineBusiness A feast of delightful vegetarian dishes

In a blender, purée the tofu to a smooth paste. Add the melted chocolate and blend thoroughly. Pour the mousse into six individual dessert bowls and chill.

Makes 6 servings.

Strawberry Mango Crisp

Fruit mixture:

4 cups quartered strawberries

2 cups mango, diced

4 Tbsp. sugar

4 Tbsp. flour

Topping:

1 cup flour

1/2 cup rolled oats

1 cup brown sugar

1/2 cup (1 stick) margarine

Preheat the oven to 400° F.

Mix the ingredients for the fruit mixture together in a large bowl. Spread evenly into a 2-quart casserole dish. Set aside. Mix the dry ingredients for the topping together in a medium bowl. Cut in the margarine until the mixture resembles small peas. Spread the topping evenly over the fruit mixture. Bake for 35 to 45 minutes, until bubbly. Serve warm with nondairy “ice cream.”

Makes 6 servings.

Chocolate Brazil Nut Squares with truffle topping

Ingredients:

200g/7oz. dark chocolate

250g/8oz. packet of biscuits/cookies (digestive or oat ones work well) - broken down to crumb texture

100g/4oz. brazils nuts crushed or broken down in a processor

2 tablespoons of vegan margarine

2 tablespoons of golden syrup

half a box of vegan cream (about 100ml.)

Melt the chocolate in a bowl over hot water. In a pan, slowly melt together the margarine and syrup and then combine this with HALF the chocolate. Stir in the crushed biscuits and nuts and press this into a greased 9" by 9" tin or something of similar size. Beat the soya cream into the remaining 100g or so of chocolate and spread this on top. Chill in the fridge for a couple of hours until set and cut into squares.

Choc, Fruit and Nut Cookies

This recipe makes about 40 small (2 inch/6cm) cookies

Ingredients:

150g/5oz/three quarter cup caster sugar

150g/5 oz/three quarter cup vegan margarine

5 tablespoons of soya milk

300g/10 oz/1 and a half cups of plain flour

teaspoon vanilla extract (or according to pack instructions)

a handful each of: chocolate chips, chopped nuts and raisins.

Preheat oven to 200C/400F and grease cookie sheets. Cream together the sugar and marg. Mix in the soya milk and vanilla and then the flour. The mixing of the flour is best done with your hands (messy but fun!). Add the choc, nuts and raisins and mix well. You should have a workable dough (add more flour if it's too wet or more soya milk if too dry and doesn't hold together well). Roll out on a floured board (to just under 1 cm thick) and cut into cookies. Lay on cookie sheets and bake for about 10 minutes for soft bake cookies or a little longer for dryer, crunchy ones. Variations: Leave out the choc, nuts and fruit and half dip the cooled cookies in chocolate - choccy biscuits! Crushed Whizzers chocolate beans are a colourful replacement for chocolate chips. They can also be pressed all over the top prior to baking. Plain cookies with a handful of sesame seeds or desiccated coconut added into the dough are delicious. Plain cookies with a square of chocolate pressed onto them before baking work well too.

Peanut Butter Crunch

6 cups of cornflakes or rice crispies

1 cup of golden syrup

1 1/2 cups of peanut butter

8oz of choc chips (or as much chocolate as you want)

Lightly oil a baking tray. Place the cornflakes in a big bowl ready. Then heat the golden syrup in a saucepan until thin and runny. Remove from the heat and beat in the peanut butter until smooth. Pour the mixture over the cornflakes and mix well.

Push the mixture into the baking tray to form a slab (I find pushing it down with a potato masher works). It should be firmly packed. Then melt your chocolate chips and pour over the top. Refrigerate for at least 3 hours then cut into bars or bite size chunks.

MMMmmmm.

CAT'S LUCIOUS TRUFFLES

100 - 200g chocolate

1 pkg silken tofu (blended to a cream)

1/2 cup maple syrup

1 cup almonds/ hazelnuts (whole or pieces)

Put the maple syrup in a pan and bring to a boil. When boiling add the nuts and stir constantly until it is almost dry (ie the nuts are all sticking together and the syrup is not runny) empty out onto some greaseproof paper and allow to cool.

Meanwhile melt the chocolate in a bowl over simmering water. DON'T allow the bowl to touch the water. It should be just above it.

Blend the praline (nut mixture) into either a fine powder or a coarse mixture and stir into the chocolate. Fold in the tofu. When it is all mixed take off the heat allow to cool. The cover and place in the fridge until well chilled.

Work quickly and form into small balls. Roll in cocoa powder or grated chocolate or dip in melted chocolate and allow to set. Eat in moderation, as they are incredibly rich! OTHER VERSIONS

If you don't like nuts or have an allergy they can be left out but add a tablespoon or two of sugar or maple syrup to the tofu while blending it (taste as it may need more or less depending on the brand of chocolate you use.

Either basic truffle mixture can be flavoured with a tbsp of liqueur, or flavoured syrups. Extra nuts, dried fruit, fresh fruits diced up or rice crispies (for crunch!) can all be added to the basic mixture. Experiment...

The basic mixture makes AMAZING chocolate spread or how about cutting out rectangles of vegan puff pastry and spreading a layer of the truffle mixture onto it, fold it over (chocolate side in!) and bake in the oven (follow temperature and times on the packet of pastry) and you have vegan pain au chocolat !!

PLAIN FUDGE

850g/1 3/4 lb sugar

300mls/ 1/2 pint soya milk

120g/ 4oz soya margarine (this is better for a more 'buttery' flavour)

2 tsp vanilla extract

Oil a square tin (about 18cm/7 inch). Pour the soya milk into a pan and slowly bring to the boil. Add the sugar and the soya margarine and heat slowly, stirring constantly until the sugar is dissolved and the margarine has melted. Bring to the boil and cover the pan. Boil for 2 minutes, then uncover and continue to boil stirring occasionally until it reaches soft ball stage (it is sort of essential that you use a sugar thermometer for this...it should read 115-116C/238 to 240F). Take off the heat and stir in the vanilla extract and leave to cool for 5 minutes. Beat until it begins to lose its gloss and is thick. Pour into the tin and allow to cool before cutting into squares. (of course vegan fudge can be bought from both VIVA! And Dr Hadwens Trust)

ARES BARS -Vegan Mars Bars

NOUGAT

2 Cups of Soya Milk

9 oz. Soya Marg.

24 oz. Sugar

2 tblsp. Vanilla Essence

12 oz. dried Soya Milk

Put the milk, marge and sugar into a thick saucepan and heat, without stirring, on a low heat until it bubbles all over and triples in size.

Keep at this heat for 2 min (if you have a sugar thermometer, it should be 235 F./112.8 C.)

Cool.

Add the vanilla essence and the dried soya milk and beat till creamy.

Pour into baking trays roughly the size of 48 mars bars and freeze for an hour.

TOFFEE

12 oz. Sugar 12 oz. Soya Marge 250 ml Soya cream 3 tbsp Golden Syrup

Put everything in a thick bottomed saucepan and heat on a low heat till it bubbles all over and triples in size

Keep at this temperature for 4-5 minutes, stirring constantly. Pour the toffee over the nougat and freeze for another hour.

Cut into mars bar size pieces and re-freeze until the toffee is solid (this can take a couple of days.)

Melt 1200g of vegan chocolate in a microwave if you have one (3 minutes full power per 100g)

or place into a bowl above a saucepan of boiling water till melted.

Coat the bars with chocolate and place onto a greased tray. Re-freeze.

The Marathon Variation (Thermopylae Bars)

Replace vanilla essence with 340g jar of crunchy peanut butter (without the jar) & 20g chopped, unsalted peanuts.

These basic nougat and toffee recipes can be used to make a whole range of vegan versions of chocolate bars.

CRUNCHIES

2lb sugar (brown or white)

1 cup cold water

2 tsps bicarbonate of soda

Boil the sugar and water in a DEEP pan for 20 minutes. Test in cold water until the sugar mixture is crisp and cracks easily. Remove from heat and add the bicarbonate of soda. This will make the mixture puff out and froth up in the pan. Pour into an oiled tin and cut when half cold. When cooled dip in melted chocolate.

Creamy mushroom Puff

A third of a cup/60g/2oz of vegan margarine

4 tablespoons of plain white flour

1 onion

4 cloves of garlic, crushed or very finely chopped (this can be reduced or left out if desired)

3 cups of mushrooms, sliced

half a litre/500ml of soya milk

1 glass of white wine (or stock)

handful of chopped parsley salt and pepper to taste

approx. 500g/18oz of frozen puff pastry (this even comes ready-rolled now for extra laziness!!!) Melt the margarine and cook the onion and garlic in it for a few minutes and then add the sliced

mushrooms and cook for a couple of minutes more. Add the flour and stir well. Gradually add the soya milk stirring all the time and then the wine and keep stirring on a low heat until the

sauce thickens. Once thick remove from the heat and add your seasoning and the parsley. Allow to cool slightly while you prepare the pastry. Roll out into 2 wide rectangular shapes reserving

some pastry for decoration. Place one sheet of pastry on a greased baking tray. Heap the slightly cooled sauce onto it leaving a space round the edges. Place the top sheet on and seal up the edges

with some soya milk or water (fold over if needed). Make some small slits on the top of the puff and let your artistic side shine with the reserved pastry! I usually make holly leaves to place on

the top but do whatever you like. Glaze with soya milk and then bake in a medium hot oven for about half an hour or until the pastry seems cooked (no soggy bits and nicely puffed up!)

Nice served with gravy, roast potatoes, stuffing, vegan sausages, cranberry sauce and vegetables of your choice - a feast!

Ingredients list: Mushroom Risotto

300mls/just over 1 cup rice

approx. 600mls/2 and a quarter cups hot stock (I use Kallo mushroom stock cubes)

1 onion, finely chopped

couple of cloves garlic, crushed or finely chopped

Jar of antipasto mushrooms, minus a tbsp mushrooms (make sure they are vegan), drain and reserve the oil.

big handful of chestnut mushrooms, sliced

a few dried mushrooms, soaked in hot water and then finely chopped

tsp dried oregano (or fresh if you can)

fresh basil, sliced

Soyamince filling

1 cup defrosted vegemince or 1 cup rehydrated soya mince,

remaining tbsp of mushrooms,

enough sundried tomato puree to bind it together and some fresh basil

Stuffing

1 onion finely chopped,

1 cup oats

1/2 cup suet,

1 tsp mixed herbs and some salt and pepper. Aprox. 500g./18oz of frozen, vegan puff pastry

Preparation

Mushroom Risotto

Put some of the reserved mushroom oil in a pan and saute the onions and garlic until soft, add the

rice and mix it all together. Add all the different mushrooms and the oregano if dried. Mix again and then gradually add the stock stirring constantly for that creamy risotto texture. More or less liquid may be needed. Add fresh herbs , mix and set aside.

soyamince filling

In a blender mix together approx. 1 cup defrosted vegemince or 1 cup rehydrated soya mince, remaining tbsp of mushrooms, enough sundried tomato puree to bind it together and some fresh basil

Stuffing

chop an onion finely and mix it with 1 cup oats to 1/2 cup suet, 1 tsp mixed herbs and some salt and pepper. bind with a little water to form a sausage...be careful not to add too much water. Have ready some defrosted vegan puff pastry rolled out into a rectangle.

Assembly

Get the puff pastry and spread it lightly with sundried tomato paste and stick basil leaves on to this. Get the cooled mushroom risotto and spread it onto the pastry leaving room at all ends... you wont need all the risotto. On top of this place the soya mince filling and then place the stuffing sausage along the centre. Fold up the sides until they meet in the middle...hopefully!! If they are reluctant to stick down then brush with a little soya milk. Put on a baking tray. It is advisable, if possible, to raise the pastry parcel off the tray using a rack as I have found the bottom has a tendency to burn. You can now leave it until Christmas Day! To cook follow the temperature guide on the packet of puff pastry. Easy!

Spinach-Tofu Manicotti by Secular Pagan

Not exactly a traditional Yule/Christmas dish, but it's red, white, and green, so it fits.

FILLING:

(stuffs about ten manicotti "tubes")

1 pound/450g firm tofu, drained and rinsed

1 10-oz/300g box frozen spinach, thawed and squeezed dry

1 Tbsp. Italian seasoning (blend of oregano, marjoram, thyme, rosemary, basil, sage)

3 green onions (scallions), including green part, sliced thinly

8 ounces/230g (more or less) white button mushrooms, chopped in big chunks

PASTA:

1 package large manicotti tubes

SAUCE:

About 28 ounces/750g of your favorite pasta sauce, homemade or prepackaged

Plop tofu into a medium-sized mixing bowl and mash/crumble with your hands. Add spinach and fold into tofu with a fork, using fork to break up strands of spinach and mix evenly with the crumbled tofu. Stir in Italian seasoning, onions, and mushrooms.

Boil about 10 manicotti tubes just shy of al dente (they won't fall apart this way when you're stuffing them) and drain. Use your fingers to push clumps of filling into the manicotti tubes till each one is plump and full. Lay them in a covered casserole dish (more than one layer is O.K.) and pour your favorite tomato-based pasta sauce (homemade or bottled) over the whole thing. Cover and bake at 350 degrees Fahrenheit for about an hour, maybe a little less (say, 45 minutes) if you have the manicotti spread out in a single layer. Remove from oven and give it a few minutes to cool off before attempting to eat. Note: I have to keep my sodium intake low, so I don't add salt to anything I make from scratch (except some baked goods), so some of you might prefer to add a 1/2 teaspoon of salt to the filling.

Cranberry, Orange and Ginger sauce

3/4 cup/150g/5oz sugar

1/2 cup/150ml/quarter pint of orange juice zest of 1 lemon

1 teaspoon of fresh grated ginger (or half a teaspoon of dried ginger)

2 cups of fresh cranberries

pinch of salt

Place the cranberries, orange juice and ginger in a pan and simmer for about 10 minutes. Give the berries a mash and add the sugar, zest and salt. Cook gently until all the sugar is completely dissolved. The sauce will thicken up as it cools slightly. Nice served hot or warm with nut roast or mushroom puff and parcel.